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THURSDAY, AUGUST 27, 2026

‘It hit hard, because it just brought back a lot of memories.’

JOHN DOE 1, in a lawsuit filed against the Diocese of Providence

Decades after abuse, altar boys speak out

Priest allegedly brought children to cottage; bounced among parishes for years

By Amanda Milkovits
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The five friends had grown up poor in the brick apartments of the Prospect Heights Housing Projects in Pawtucket, R.I. They all served as altar boys at the project’s church hall. And they all kept silent about the dark secret they shared for more than 50 years.

Sometime in the winter of 1973

and 1974, the Rev. Armand Ventre, the priest from St. Teresa of the Child Jesus who led Mass in Prospect Heights, invited one of the boys to visit his cottage on Lake Washington in northwest Rhode Island. Ventre asked him to invite other boys, and his older brother and three friends soon visited the cabin, which the priest called “Virgin Wood.”

The property in Glocester, R.I.,

with its woods and gentle shore, was like paradise for children from the Pawtucket projects.

For more than 50 years, the five former altar boys didn’t discuss what happened to them at the idyllic cabin. But in March, Attorney General Peter F. Neronha announced the results of an investigation into how the Roman Catholic Diocese of Providence handled complaints of child sexual abuse go-

ing back to 1950. The five read the report, saw the section about Ventre, who died in 1999, and decided to break their silence.

“It hit hard, because it just brought back a lot of memories,” the man identified in a lawsuit as John Doe 1 said in an interview with the Globe. (The Globe does not identify alleged victims of sexual abuse without their permission.)

ABUSE, Page B4

Meta to pay \$18b over teen addiction

Agrees to new limits on Instagram, Facebook use; Mass. will get up to \$516m

By Dana Gerber and Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

Teenage users of Instagram and Facebook will face stringent new limits on when and how they can engage with the popular social media sites, part of a landmark settlement their corporate parent struck with Massachusetts and dozens of other states.

Technology giant Meta also agreed to pay up to \$18 billion to 52 states, territories, and Washington, D.C., the tech giant announced Wednesday.

The deal came after multiple states sued, accusing Meta of designing its platforms to deliberately addict young users so they spend more time online. The agreement comes after some of those states went to trial in federal court in California last week.

The new conditions include a limit of two hours a day for teens up to age 18 on both platforms, which cannot be lifted without a parent’s approval, according to Meta. The company also agreed to block access from midnight to 6 a.m., and silence notifications between the school hours of 8 a.m. to 3 p.m. (Direct messaging is exempt from these limits, “to allow teens to stay connected with friends and family,” Meta said.)

Among other changes: teen users will be pre-

META, Page A7

So far, Markey dodges gotcha moment on age

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

It was a moment that Representative Seth Moulton’s Senate campaign had likely been waiting for. In the last televised debate between Moulton and Senator Ed Markey, the 80-year-old incumbent answered a question about his use of artificial intelligence in a way that felt rather, well, grandfatherly.

“I use whatever is inside my iPhone or my iPad, whatever comes up,” Markey answered.

In the moment, and then the days afterward, Moulton pounced. On stage, he cast Markey’s response as evidence of the need for “a new generation of leaders to regulate these technologies.” His campaign quickly spread the clip on social media and sent out a press release post-debate. Then came a digital ad recapping the moment, titled, “The future is now.”

Perhaps now more than ever, the nation’s aging political class is under renewed scrutiny, and Markey is not immune.

But while Moulton, 47, has made Markey’s age a central part of his “pass the torch” campaign, those potentially viral clips illustrating his argument on the need for generational change have been otherwise rare. Markey, across three debates, regularly jostled with his younger challenger, lobbed well-rehearsed retorts, and, last week,

SENATE, Page A6



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

First-year student Zara Mody was delighted to see the work of Dorm Essentials Co. on her new home at Boston University.

ROOM SERVICE

College students want just the right look, and they’ll pay for help from the pros

By Brooke Hauser
and Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

Most first-year students moving into Boston University’s Sleeper Hall on Monday wrestled large blue rolling bins full of stuff into elevators as a marching band played “I’m Shipping Up to Boston.”

Not Zara Mody, an 18-year-old freshman from San Jose, Calif. She and her parents took a long walk around campus, and when they returned hours later, carrying a new BU sweatshirt and Dunkin’ iced coffee, it was to a dramatic dorm-room reveal.

“I literally don’t even know what to say — this is so perfect!” Mody squealed, taking in the pink-and-white palette that cheered up her side of a double. Her parents filmed her reaction as she hugged Kelly Mahoney and

Kerry Giordano, who run Dorm Essentials Co. and had spent the morning creating Mody’s new home away from home.

Like many of Dorm Essentials’ clients, Mody discovered the Reading-based duo on Instagram, where students across the country show off once-monastic spaces transformed into cozy bedrooms complete with fabric headboards, cloud-like duvets, swag curtains, and their names in fluorescent lights.

Nowhere is the trend of the luxury dorm makeover bigger than in the South, where it has reached debutante heights. It’s a thing in New England, too, just more . . . New Englandy.

Welcome to back-to-school season, when thousands of college students stream back into residence halls around the state. While

many are leaving the look of their rooms to fate by scavenging shelves at Target, others are going all out with a little help from regional businesses like Dorm Essentials, big stores like Pottery Barn Teen, or, in some cases, even their parents’ personal interior decorators.

College students are expected to spend a record \$103.5 billion on back-to-school shopping this year, according to the National Retail Federation. But even those on a shoestring budget can access bespoke dorm designs through artificial intelligence tools like VisualizeAI and RoomsGPT, which allow users to upload photos and reimagine their spaces within seconds. Or they get their ideas from Instagram, TikTok, and YouTube.

DORMS, Page A7

Searching for common ground on vaccines

From an evangelical upbringing, she’s become voice of science — and empathy

This story is republished from STAT, the health and medicine news site that’s a partner to the Globe. It is part of a new STAT initiative to examine the roots and consequences of distrust in science.

By Felice J. Freyer
STAT

At the age of 23, Elisabeth Marnik approached her doctor with an unusual request: Vaccinate me. Against everything. She had never received a single vaccine. But now, angry and defiant, she was turning away from the beliefs of her childhood, instilled by a mother who distrusted science. A doctor for adults doesn’t typically have childhood immunizations on hand, so she made her way to a travel clinic and eventually got all the once-forbidden shots.

A year would pass before she told her mother about the vaccines. And several more years would go by before Marnik came to have sympathy for her mother’s choices.

That happened, as it so often does, when Marnik became a mother herself, in 2019. A harrowing childbirth necessitated several blood transfusions. Overwhelmed and foggy-headed,

VACCINES, Page A10



Elisabeth Marnik, shown as a child, did not receive any vaccinations because her mother didn’t believe in them.



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Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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Jurors in the Lindsay Clancy case are expected to begin deliberations today after hearing instructions on the law related to murder, mental illness, and criminal responsibility. **B1.**

The Postal Service can for now move ahead with plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterm elections, after a federal judge lifted an order. **A2.**



Character actor Tim Curry died at 80. He was best known for his role as Dr. Frank-N-Furter in the cult film “The Rocky Horror Picture Show.” **C9.**

Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China killed at least 160 people and left hundreds missing. **A3.**

The Nation

Judge allows effort to limit mail voting, for now

But predicts foes ‘might persuade’ Supreme Court

By Zach Montague
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Postal Service can for now move ahead with plans to restrict mail-in voting before the midterm elections in November, after a federal judge on Wednesday lifted an order that had blocked it from carrying out Trump administration plans.

The judge, Indira Talwani of US District Court, wrote that she felt compelled to act in response to a ruling from the Supreme Court on Monday that action by the courts was premature.

However, she indicated that she would consider the issue again once groups challenging the policy updated their legal arguments to reflect that the Postal Service has now taken concrete steps to carry out an execu-

tive order from President Trump dealing with the issue. And she predicted that those groups could offer “substantial arguments that might persuade the Supreme Court to reach a different result.”

To that end, a coalition of Democratic-led states filed a new lawsuit Wednesday challenging the Trump administration’s mail-in ballot efforts, arguing that steps the agency took Friday to finalize its plans will harm them and their voters, making the issue now ripe for court action.

The Supreme Court said Monday that it was effectively too early for states and other litigants to challenge the administration, as none had — so far — been hurt by the federal government or faced illegal incursions into their balloting. But the court had not taken account of the recent Postal Service action in its decision.

Under its new plan, the Postal Service would not deliver mail

ballots in states that do not share voter data with the agency and would deliver only ballots that meet certain criteria.

In the new lawsuit, the states argued that the Postal Service’s new plan would result in the federal government tying the delivery of mail-in ballots to states’ willingness to help the federal government scrutinize their voter rolls, meaning they have now been harmed. Under the law, states and Congress set election rules, not the executive branch, they argued.

“Congress has not afforded USPS any authority whatsoever to set rules for federal elections or mail voting, even though Americans have cast ballots by mail for generations,” the lawsuit said.

In the suit, the states described the new Postal Service policy as “part of a broader effort by the president and his administration to rewrite federal election law and usurp the authority of the states and Congress.”



WILLIAM LIANG/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

A worker sorted ballots at a ballot processing center during the California primary election in June.

An executive order Trump signed in March sought to restrict mail ballots and to create state-by-state lists of citizens to help determine voting eligibility.

It instructed the Department of Homeland Security to compile the citizenship lists and then send them to each state.

Under the plan finalized Friday, the Postal Service would also review every envelope for compliance with the new standards before accepting ballots into its system. This review would include checking that the recipient was enrolled with the Postal Service to receive a mail

ballot and that the ballot envelope met certain specifications.

Numerous voting advocacy groups have warned that the lists of eligible voters compiled by the federal government were likely to contain errors based on obsolete data and could conflict with more up-to-date voter registries compiled by the states. In court, the Justice Department also acknowledged that mismatches in the data could lead to certain voters being flagged as noncitizens and having their ballots rejected by the Postal Service.

A coalition of more than 20 state attorneys general and Governor Josh Shapiro, Democrat of Pennsylvania, first challenged the order in Federal District Court in Boston in April, resulting in the Supreme Court’s finding Monday.

The same group filed the new lawsuit Wednesday, also in Boston, where another lawsuit challenging the restrictions on mail-in voting is also pending.

DAILY BRIEFING



GEORGE WALKER IV/ASSOCIATED PRESS

IN HER IMAGE — Mandy Madson, wearing a Dolly Parton-inspired wig, took a selfie at a makeshift memorial outside the home of the late singer in Brentwood, Tenn., on Wednesday.

Felony charges dropped against Golden Gate Bridge protesters

A two-year legal battle over a dramatic protest against the war on Gaza came to an end on Friday as seven protesters who’d blocked traffic on the Golden Gate Bridge received 30-day sentences and \$1,000 fines.

Over two dozen activists halted several lanes of traffic on the bridge on April 15, 2024, six months into Israel’s war in the

Palestinian territory that has been widely recognized as a genocide. San Francisco District Attorney Brooke Jenkins charged 26 of them. Most were offered diversion, in the form of fines and community service, but Jenkins hit seven protesters with a raft of serious charges, including felony conspiracy.

Six of the seven defendants —

Sarah Ferrell, Conrad de Jesus, Em Tillotson, and Bhavika Anandpura of Oakland and Rocky Chau and River Allen of Richmond — had locked themselves together in order to halt commuter traffic coming into the city. A seventh, Sara Cantor, had served as a police liaison.

After a two-and-a-half-week trial, jurors deadlocked in June

over the most serious charges but convicted the protesters on several misdemeanors, including obstructing a thoroughfare, unlawful assembly, and four counts of false imprisonment related to trapped commuters.

Jenkins’s office had considered a new trial on the conspiracy charges.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Minn. bid to extradite officer denied

BROWNSVILLE, Texas — A federal judge on Wednesday refused to order Texas to extradite an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer charged with shooting a man and lying about it during the immigration crackdown in Minneapolis.

Christian Castro is charged in Minnesota with assault and falsely reporting a crime in the Jan. 14 shooting of 24-year-old Julio Cesar Sosa-Celis. Minnesota authorities have sought his extradition since his arrest, but he remains in custody in Brownsville, Texas, a city bordering Mexico.

Under Texas law and barring extradition, Castro must

be released after 90 days of detention, which is Thursday.

Minnesota Attorney General Keith Ellison filed a request for a temporary restraining order last week, asking a federal judge to prevent the sheriff in Cameron County, Texas, from releasing Castro, and to order Texas Governor Greg Abbott to sign his extradition warrant.

Minnesota officials believe Castro could flee the country, citing calls he made from jail to a woman in Mexico, talking “about marrying her and buying a house in Mexico when he is released,” according to the lawsuit.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Father: Pa. student killed by police

A 22-year-old man fatally shot by police in Pennsylvania as they responded to a possible burglary was a kind-hearted college student who mistakenly went to the wrong home after celebrating a friend’s birthday, his father said Wednesday.

Police in Upper Pottsgrove Township, about 45 miles northwest of Philadelphia, responded around 12:30 a.m. Sunday to a 911 call about a possible break-in attempt, according to the Montgomery County district attorney’s office. The office said in a statement that police found Glenwood Pysher IV at the rear of the home and ultimately shot and killed him.

Pysher’s father, Glen Pysher, said his son and his friends had visited several bars earlier in the evening and were splitting up to spend the night in two homes when his son took a wrong turn in the woods. Based on what he has been told by his son’s friends, Pysher believes his son mistakenly tried to enter what he thought was his friend’s house.

“He tried to open the door-knob and obviously startled the homeowner,” he said. “From what we understand, he announced, ‘Hey! Open the door!’ because he thought he was at his friend’s house.”

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Masked man accused of harassing Philadelphians arrested

A man suspected of harassing more than a dozen people in Philadelphia this month while wearing a Chuckie-style mask was arrested in Las Vegas on Tuesday, authorities said.

The man, Zymire Hughes, 22, was apprehended by a US Marshals Service task force in Nevada and was being held in jail while awaiting extradition to Pennsylvania, the service said in a statement.

The Philadelphia Police Department last week identified Hughes as a suspect after a man wearing a Halloween mask was reported to be threatening pedestrians. Many observers compared the mask to one styled after the character Chuckie from the 1988 horror film “Child’s Play.”

“Zymire Hughes, the guy running around with the mask — that one — well, he’s in custody right now,” Larry Krasner, the Philadelphia district attorney, said at a news conference Wednesday morning. Krasner added: “Who’s scared now?”

Hughes was expected to face felony and misdemeanor charges of aggravated assault, possession of an instrument of crime, and terroristic threats, among other charges, Krasner said last week.

NEW YORK TIMES

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NEW YORK TIMES



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A man wearing a Halloween mask was reported to be threatening pedestrians.

Kremlin says CIA chief met Russian counterpart

Trump plays down official’s visit to Moscow

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Kremlin said Wednesday that CIA Director John Ratcliffe held talks in Moscow with his intelligence counterparts, a rare and secretive visit at a time when relations with Washington remain strained over Russia’s war in Ukraine.

Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said Ratcliffe did not meet with Russian President Vladimir Putin, who was informed of the contacts that were “on the intelligence agencies’ level.”

“Of course, President Putin is immediately informed of everything,” Peskov added, refusing to say what was discussed.

Russian state news agencies reported that a US military plane landed in Moscow’s Vnukovo airport on Tuesday and departed later that day.

US President Trump played down the significance of Ratcliffe’s trip, saying it was “sort of semi-routine.”

“I hate to disappoint people,” he said on conservative broadcaster Glenn Beck’s radio show Wednesday.

A senior Ukrainian official told the Associated Press that Washington informed Kyiv a delegation would be traveling to the Russian capital and asked it to suspend strikes until it left. The official said the request did not apply to all Russian territory, but specifically to Moscow, St. Petersburg, and some northern regions. Strikes on other parts of Russia continued, the official said, speaking on condition of anonymity because he is not authorized to talk publicly.

CBS News first reported on the visit.

Peskov said that “contacts between intelligence agencies are, in and of themselves, a positive phenomenon, a positive process,” but he stressed that Russia-US relations remain in a “profound crisis.”

He added that it was “too early to say” what impact Ratcliffe’s visit would have on the ties between the two countries.

Andrei Soldatov, an expert on Russia’s security services, told AP that visits like the one by Ratcliffe do not “happen every year.”

Official channels of communication between Moscow and Washington have been kept alive since the 1980s and exist so both sides can talk if lives are in danger or for other reasons, Soldatov said.

In 2021, Nikolai Patrushev, the secretary of Putin’s Security Council, met CIA Director Wil-

liam Burns in Moscow months before Russian forces invaded Ukraine. Burns later met Sergei Naryshkin, the head of Russia’s foreign intelligence agency, in Turkey in November 2022 to warn Russia not to deploy a nuclear weapon in Ukraine.

Details of Tuesday’s discussions have not been revealed but such meetings normally take place only when there is a matter of pressing national security and when it is in “American national interests,” Soldatov said.

Russia-US relations sank to Cold War lows after Moscow’s full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022, but appeared to warm after Trump returned to office. He had promised to end the war swiftly, holding multiple phone calls with Putin and even hosting him in Alaska a year ago.

In his radio appearance Wednesday, Trump repeated that he wants to see the Russia-Ukraine war end.

Efforts to negotiate a peace deal have largely stalled, with US attention turning to its war with Iran and both Moscow and Kyiv stepping up their long-range attacks on each other. Putin has rejected Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky’s push for an immediate ceasefire, arguing that Russia wants a comprehensive settlement, not a temporary truce.

Russia has proposed to mediate in the United States and Israel’s war with Iran, Moscow’s important ally in the Middle East.

After Putin sent troops into Ukraine in February 2022, Tehran provided Russia with Shahed drones and later licensed their production in Russia. In January 2025, Moscow and Tehran signed a “comprehensive strategic partnership” treaty. But even as it has built ties with Iran, Russia also has remained friendly with Israel, and analysts have described its relations with Iran as complex and challenging.

In March, AP reported that Russia provided Iran with information that could help Tehran strike American warships, aircraft, and other assets in the region, according to two officials familiar with US intelligence on the matter. The officials, who were not authorized to comment publicly on the sensitive matter and spoke on the condition of anonymity, cautioned that the US intelligence has not uncovered that Russia is directing Iran on what to do with the information.

Soldatov said it’s possible Tuesday’s meeting involved protecting US personnel, bases, or facilities in the Middle East.

The World

Floods kill over 160 in Nepal and China

Hundreds still missing; roads, buildings erased

By Niranjan Shrestha and Sibi Arasu
ASSOCIATED PRESS

UDIN DHUNGA, Nepal — Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China on Wednesday killed at least 160 people and left hundreds of tourists, workers, and others missing after sweeping through communities and bringing travel in some areas to a halt. Experts said the collapse of a glacier caused the disaster in the warming Himalayan region.

Police in Nepal reported at least 157 dead. China's state broadcaster CCTV reported at least three dead and 558 missing, including 260 foreigners, in the Tibet region's Gyirong County near the border. Drone footage showed roads destroyed and buildings buried by thundering water the color of wet cement. State news agency Xinhua reported significant casualties.

Officials in Nepal said 403 people, including 341 foreigners, were reported missing. Sunil Sharma, a tourism board spokesperson, said 133 were from India on pilgrimage to Mount Kailash in Tibet, a sacred site for Hindus. Also missing were 47 from the United States, 34 from Australia, 33 from Britain and 24 from Canada, he said. The State Department said it was aware of Americans affected.

The region's steep valleys are economic lifelines and travel corridors but precarious ones when disaster strikes. Images showed what appeared to be the second floors of buildings in Nepal's hard-hit Nuwakot district slathered in mud after the torrent rushed by. Debris hung from trees and wires, vehicles were buried, and some stunned survivors were caked in mud. There was little time for any-



NIRANJAN SHRESTHA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A boy looked at the devastation caused by flash flooding along the Trishuli river in Nepal's Nuwakot district on Wednesday.

one to flee.

"When I reached Dhunge bazaar, in half an hour, the flood came and damaged all the market. People were preparing to go to office then," resident Shoyam Rajbhandari said. "How many people are missing or dead, we don't know."

At least 62 missing Nepali citizens were among hundreds of locals trekking in the Gosaikunda Lake area in hard-hit Rasuwa district bordering Tibet's Gyirong, coinciding with the local festival of Janai Purnima on Friday, Sharma said. Though the current monsoon season is less favorable for trekking in Nepal, it's a major season for Kailash trekking, which follows the route in Nepal's Rasuwa district.

Nepal police spokesperson Abi Narayan Kafle said at least

28 police officials were missing.

Officials warned residents in several districts to stay away from the banks of the Trishuli, Bhotekoshi and Narayani rivers. At least 19 bridges and nearly 25 miles of road were swept away. The Bhotekoshi flooded around 9 a.m. Wednesday, destroying several villages and hydropower projects, officials said.

"We have asked both India and China to help us with the rescue efforts," said government spokesperson Sasmit Pokharel.

The US Geological Survey first reported a magnitude 4.4 earthquake early Wednesday, about 41 miles north of Kathmandu, near the border. The USGS later updated to call the shaking a 5.2 magnitude landslide.

South Korean government

officials said nine citizens working on building a hydropower plant in Nepal were among those reported missing. Malaysia's foreign ministry said its embassy received reports from travel agencies that they had lost contact with 11 Malaysians believed to be in Rasuwa district. Russia's embassy in Nepal said four citizens reportedly in the affected area were missing.

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke with Nepal's Prime Minister Balendra Shah and offered help. "India is prepared to provide Nepal with all possible types of humanitarian assistance. Our teams are closely coordinating on rescue and relief efforts," Modi said on social media.

Some United Nations bodies were deploying "in an effort to meet what will clearly be mas-

sive humanitarian need," UN spokesperson Stephane Dujarric said.

In a joint statement, Australia, Britain, the European Union, Finland, France, Norway, and Switzerland expressed solidarity with people in Nepal, adding: "We encourage all those in affected areas to follow the guidance of local authorities and official safety advisories as the situation continues to evolve."

Climate experts at the Kathmandu-based International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development said an avalanche from a glacier likely caused Wednesday's flash flood.

"Hydrological observations indicate the exceptional speed and magnitude of the flood wave," they said in an emailed statement.

DAILY BRIEFING

14 newborns die in hospital fire in Pakistan

ISLAMABAD — Fourteen newborn babies died Wednesday in Islamabad, Pakistan's capital, after a fire broke out in a nursery of the city's largest hospital, according to officials, making it the deadliest disaster in years at a Pakistani healthcare facility.

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif fired Pakistan's health secretary, Aslam Ghauri, within hours of the fire, as the leading opposition party criticized the government for failing to provide basic safety measures in public hospitals.

The fire spread shortly before 7 a.m. after an air conditioning unit exploded in the maternity ward of the Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences, the local government said in a statement. Rescue teams sent six fire engines and four ambulances, but the fire spread so rapidly that only one baby in the nursery could be saved, according to Tariq Fazal Chaudhry, a government minister elected from Islamabad.

The prime minister ordered an investigation and said in a statement that "the strictest action should be taken."

Health care professionals have long raised alarms about what they say is widespread official neglect of Pakistan's public hospitals and clinics.

"Administrative failure and regulatory oversight lapses have turned these institutions into danger zones," Abdul Ghafoor Shoro, the secretary-general of Pakistan's leading doctors association, said in a statement Wednesday.

NEW YORK TIMES



ALBERTO SAIZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

La Tomatina food fight draws foreigners to paint small Spanish town red

BUÑOL, Spain — Thousands of revelers — including many lured by a Bollywood film — descended on a small Spanish town on Wednesday for the annual La Tomatina food fight, where they painted Buñol red with tons of overripe tomatoes.

Loaded trucks plodded through the crowd with people

in their cargo beds throwing tomatoes at the revelers — who, in turn, hurled them at one another. Their white shirts soon turned pink and red while pop songs blasted from speakers. At one point, police appeared to use pepper spray to disperse an area of the crowd, but a festive vibe quickly resumed.

The messy melee took place for over an hour in the town, where buildings were covered with tarps ahead of the festivities. Held on the last Wednesday of August, the festival traces its origins to a food fight in 1945.

La Tomatina became an annual tradition before Spanish dictator General Francisco Fran-

co banned it in the 1950s. Televised media attention in the 1980s helped turn the festival into a national event, and eventually, an international attraction.

More than 20,000 people had been expected to take part this year.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Inquest into death of ex-professor

LONDON — An inquest opened Wednesday into the sudden death earlier this month of Jason Arday, a Cambridge University professor who faced a storm of plagiarism accusations.

Arday, 41, who became Cambridge's youngest Black professor in 2023, was found dead at an address in south London on Aug. 13, days after he resigned his post as professor of sociology of education following intense media scrutiny of his creden-

tials and many of the other claims he had made about his accomplishments outside of academia.

Any deaths in the UK that are deemed to exhibit uncertainties of one form or another are investigated by a coroner.

"The various reports have given me reason to suspect that Professor Arday died an unnatural death 12 days ago," said senior coroner Dr. Julian Morris.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Oil prices dip on news of Hormuz

Follows standoff between US, Iran

By Lara Jakes
NEW YORK TIMES

Global oil prices dipped Wednesday after top officials from Iran and Oman said they had advanced talks on managing traffic through the Strait of Hormuz by creating a temporary shipping lane and coordinating mine-clearing efforts.

The two countries said they had discussed a "phased framework that could provide a practical and workable basis for moving forward," according to a joint statement released Tuesday.

The slight easing of oil prices offered some respite amid a weekslong standoff between Iran and the United States over control of the strait, through which about a fifth of the world's oil and gas was shipped before the nearly six-month war.

A US naval blockade to stop Iran from shipping out oil remains in place, and only five vessels crossed the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday, according to Kpler, a maritime data firm. It was also not immediately clear how the tentative new agreement — which the Iranian-Omani statement said would lay the groundwork for a permanent navigation corridor and future management of the strait — would work.

It is also unclear how much of the discussions between Iran and Oman have been formally agreed upon.

On Wednesday, a spokesperson for Iran's Revolutionary Guard, Hossein Mohebi, reportedly told the Iranian news agency Tasnim that the two countries have agreed to share revenue in the strait. No details were provided, and the assertion could not be verified with either the Iranian or Omani governments. In June, the countries discussed a proposal to collect payment for ships transiting the strait, despite public US objections.

As Washington tries to tighten sanctions pressure, Iran is seeking to reinforce key alliances despite US threats to punish countries that refuse to isolate Iran's economy.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi spoke on Tuesday with Qatar's prime minister and Pakistan's army chief, according to reports from Iranian state media. Both Qatar and Pakistan have helped steer negotiations toward a cease-fire in the war that the United States and Israel launched against Iran on Feb. 28.

"Iran's commitment to peace and stability is matched by steadfast diplomacy with our neighbors," Araghchi wrote on social media.

On Monday, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced what he has described as an "economic D-Day" against Iran, threatening to impose financial penalties on countries that trade with Iran or help it evade US sanctions. The US strategy aims to weaken Iran so drastically that Tehran is forced to accept Washington's terms in any future negotiations.

But the measures depend largely on cooperation from China, which purchased more than 80 percent of Iran's oil exports in 2025. And Beijing has pushed back against Bessent's campaign, warning Tuesday that China would defend its interests and accusing the United States of disrupting the global financial order.

Iran quickly seized on China's dissent, announcing Tuesday that top diplomats in Tehran, the Iranian capital, were discussing how to deepen and expand cooperation with Beijing, according to Iranian state media.

Ukraine’s most potent weapon is its software

System underpins drone campaign against Russia

By Constant Méheut and Olha Konovalova
NEW YORK TIMES

NEAR THE EASTERN FRONT, Ukraine — The screens, showing live drone footage of the battlefield, flickered with color-coded frames: green for Russian equipment, blue for Ukrainian forces, orange when friend and foe were hard to tell apart. Then, a frame flashed red, indicating a Russian soldier sprinting along a tree line.

The Ukrainian troops watching from an underground command post on the eastern front sprang into action. A duty officer logged the Russian soldier’s coordinates into a computer. This automatically placed a diamond-shaped marker on a digital battlefield map, visible to all units in the vicinity. Within minutes, three attack drones were in the air, closing in.

The first drone missed. But the duty officer, from the Ukrainian First Separate Assault Regiment, fed the strike location and a video of the attack to drone teams from two other units so they could try to kill the Russian soldier.

This chilling sequence — detection, tracking, strike — all depended on powerful software that Ukraine has developed, called Delta.

The software pulls streams of battlefield intelligence, including drone video feeds, radio intercepts, and satellite images, into a single platform that helps detect targets. The system then distributes the targets to thou-



TYLER HICKS/NEW YORK TIMES

A drone was prepared for a strike on a Russian target in the Zaporizhzhia region of Ukraine on July 8.

sands of reconnaissance and attack drones that fly around the clock, helping to create a miles-wide “kill zone” where anything that moves can be spotted and hit within seconds.

Colonel Artem Martynenko, who oversees the development of the software for the Ukrainian Defense Ministry, called Delta the “nervous system” of the army of drones that have brought Russian advances to a near standstill.

Western militaries have begun to take note. Daniel Driscoll, the US Army secretary, has called the software “absolutely incredible” and acknowledged that US forces were playing catch-up.

Delta’s battlefield management system “fully integrates every single drone, every sensor, and every shooting platform into just one single network,” Driscoll told the Senate in May, adding, “Ours does not.”

NATO forces got an appreciation of that gap last year during an exercise in Estonia in which Ukrainian drone units decimat-

ed alliance formations in simulations.

Experts say software like Delta is the next frontier in warfare. With the battlefield already saturated with drones, victory depends less on the sheer number deployed and more on how fast they can be sent to strike. Ukraine and Russia are competing to build the best system, with both turning to artificial intelligence to gain an edge.

Delta’s origins go back more than a decade. In 2014, a group of Ukrainian volunteers battling Russian-backed separatist forces in eastern Ukraine was experimenting with reconnaissance drones. The idea was to improve artillery targeting and replace old-fashioned tools like binoculars.

But the data that the drones collected moved too slowly. Getting the intelligence to artillery units took a chain of radio calls. By the time a target could be fired on, the objective had often vanished, said Yaroslav Honchar, a co-founder of the group, Aerorosvidka.

The group created Delta as a solution. The software began as a shared digital map on which targets could be pinpointed. NATO financed the effort, Honchar said, hoping to steer Ukraine toward the alliance’s own doctrine of rapid force coordination across the battlefield.

Still, Honchar acknowledged, the Ukrainian army for years largely resisted adopting the system, clinging to paper maps and radio transmitters.

Then Russia invaded in early 2022.

As columns of Russian forces raced toward the Ukrainian capital, Kyiv, Honchar was called to help find their weak points. Working from a headquarters inside the nearly encircled city, he used Delta to turn a torrent of intelligence — including tips from civilians watching tanks roll past their houses — into a real-time picture of Moscow’s advance. Within days, Ukrainian counterassault troops were striking the softer spots, forcing the Russian troops to pull back.

Delta showed how a sharper eye on the battlefield could help defeat a much larger force, Honchar said. From there, the system spread across the military, becoming Ukraine’s unified battlefield management system by last summer.

The system was on display one recent morning at the First Separate Assault Regiment’s command post, where dozens of screens gave the underground bunker the feel of an air traffic control center.

Duty officers sat behind the screens, typing data into laptops. One wore three headsets — two over his ears, one around his neck — as he coordinated units on the ground. Half-crushed en-

Zelensky gives Musk award

KYIV — President Volodymyr Zelensky on Wednesday awarded Elon Musk Ukraine’s Order of Freedom, one of its highest state honors, for his “outstanding personal merits” in protecting human life and freedom and strengthening ties with the United States.

Musk, the founder of the aerospace company SpaceX, has become one of the most influential, and contentious, private sector figures in Ukraine’s war effort. His decision to provide access to Starlink, SpaceX’s satellite internet network, was a lifeline for Ukraine after Russia’s full-scale invasion in 2022 and remains critically important.

Starlink has become deeply embedded in Ukraine’s military operations, with commanders and soldiers relying on satellite connectivity to coordinate operations.

Musk’s decision-making could shape Ukraine’s future military capabilities. Starlink doesn’t currently operate over Russian territory, but Zelensky wants Musk to reconsider the policy. That would allow Ukrainian forces to maintain satellite connectivity for longer-range drone attacks.

Musk made no immediate comment on the award, which was announced by presidential decree.

The technology has been integrated into Ukraine’s drone operations, helping operators maintain links with drones over longer distances. Ukraine’s access to Starlink is the main reason for the early successes of its middle-strike drone campaign, which caught Russian forces off guard earlier this year.

The campaign has put pressure on Russian logistics in Crimea, giving Ukrainian forces a degree of battlefield momentum that Kyiv has not enjoyed since successful counteroffensives in late 2022.

Musk has allowed the Ukrainians to use Starlink inside their own territory, including in Russian-occupied regions, but has restricted use of the system inside Russia.

Zelensky has sought US help in persuading Musk to permit Ukraine to expand its ability to use Starlink beyond its borders. Musk has said he believes that would be a significant and dangerous escalation, Zelensky told reporters last week.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Ancient Lebanese treasures find wartime refuge in Paris

Exhibit seen as way to show off historic culture

By Alissa J. Rubin
NEW YORK TIMES

PARIS — More than 1,000 years before Homer wrote of Odysseus’ voyage home across the Aegean, seafaring traders from modern-day Lebanon were ranging even farther, selling their prized cedar wood from the slopes of Mount Lebanon throughout the eastern Mediterranean.

These traders, who would later be known as Phoenicians, came from Byblos, one of the oldest continuously occupied cities in the world. For a time, beginning in 3000 B.C., it was the Mediterranean’s most important timber-shipping center.

This summer, a vast array of artifacts from Byblos have been on display at the Arab World Institute in Paris in cooperation with Lebanon’s Ministry of Culture, which oversees the country’s antiquities and heritage sites. But like Odysseus, the show had an arduous journey that highlights how modern-day conflict in the Middle East is imperiling not just human life but also the art, architecture, and cultural heritage of the region.

At the show’s opening, Anne-Claire Legendre, the president of the institute, said the exhibition was a reminder of “our duty” to preserve the history and heritage of the Middle East from “all forms of erasure.”

The show was conceived of as a way to show off recent important finds in Byblos by Lebanese and French archeologists and to persuade potential tourists that Lebanon was, as Marie-Antoinette Gemayel, a curator at the National Museum of Beirut, put it, “more than a place of war — we have a history, a civilization.”

But by fall of 2024, when the artifacts were scheduled to fly to Paris, open conflict had erupted in Lebanon between Israel and Hezbollah, the Iran-supported militants, who opposed Israel’s war in the Gaza Strip. The ministry decided to postpone the show for fear the convoy ferrying the pieces to the airport could become a target.

But the curators also worried about damage to the site. In just the first few days of the 2024 war, Israeli bombing damaged a half dozen of Lebanon’s heritage sites, sometimes flattening them, according to Lebanon’s Ministry of Culture.

Israel says Hezbollah uses archaeological sites and historic buildings either as hiding places



PHOTOS BY CHRISTOPHE PETIT TESSON/POOL PHOTOS VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Above: French President Emmanuel Macron (second from left) was among officials Monday viewing the exhibition “Byblos, Lebanon’s Millennial City,” at the Arab World Institute in Paris, which includes rough-hewed stone boat anchors (below).

or as cover for tunnels that the group has built to hide arms and operatives. Hezbollah’s media office denied those assertions.

A new date for the show was set for this spring, but in February, Israel and the United States began their war against Iran. Hezbollah then fired on Israel in solidarity with Iran. In turn, Israel unleashed another bombing campaign on Lebanon and sent troops to southern Lebanon.

The culture ministry was reluctant to delay the show a second time. But curators decided to keep back a half dozen of the most valuable objects, including an obelisk, that if damaged could never be replaced.

The Lebanese army and a private security firm accompanied the objects on the short but perilous journey to the airport.

The exhibition’s curators say it spotlights Lebanon’s story as a crossroads of culture enriched and changed by the many peoples who have lived there and who have found a way to exist together despite their different faiths and ethnicities.

“Because Byblos was continuously inhabited, all the civilizations that have succeeded one another have left their mark there,” said Agnès Carayon, an institute curator.

She noted that Byblos had seen Persians, Greeks, and Ro-



mans come and go and then a succession of Umayyad and Abbasid Muslim caliphs, as well as Mamluks, Ottomans, and colonies of Christian crusaders.

The exhibition starts with an arresting display of rough-hewed stone anchors and iron fish hooks, attesting to the Phoenicians’ long reliance on the sea for food, commerce, and transport.

Also on view are miniature anchors that were offered to the gods to grant sailors safe travels.

As commerce across the Mediterranean expanded, Byblos’ boats became large enough to transport heavy loads of wood, including the famous Lebanese cedar that was Byblos’ most prized export.

The trunks of these cedar trees could reach more than 130 feet in height and were especially sought after for shipbuilding and for the inner sanctums of tombs.

“Byblos is an exceptional site, even within Lebanon,” said

Chanteau, who has worked for years on it. He added that although the site encompassed only roughly 15 acres, it contained “the whole history of humanity” within it.

So far Byblos has been relatively unscathed by the violence and destruction that have marked Lebanon’s recent past. In part that is because it is north of Beirut in an area where Hezbollah does not have a significant presence, and is therefore less of a target for Israel.



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Families fear for Americans held in Russia

Health concerns renewed after veteran’s release

By Eric Tucker
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Robert Gilman’s release from Russian custody this month heralded a long-awaited homecoming for the Marine veteran after more than four years behind bars.

But as Harold Jezler followed the media coverage from the United States, he couldn’t help but notice Gilman’s gaunt and sickly appearance and think of the implications for his wife, Olga, who has been detained in Russia since 2022 and faces her own health problems.

“You just look at the pictures and the guy is not in good shape. It’s concerning for me and for all the families, I would imagine,” Jezler said in an interview with the Associated Press. “Is this what it takes for the government to really make a move and prioritize this — that the person is basically in dire straits? It was a very bittersweet thing to see that.”

Gilman is the latest in a succession of prisoners freed by Russia going back years, but his release hardly cleared the decks of Americans held there. Some who remain are grappling with medical problems and receiving what family members and advocates say is below-standard care, adding urgency to the calls for



Harold Jezler held a photo of his wife, Olga Jezler. She has been detained in Russia since 2022.

their release.

Among those jailed are a Navy veteran with gastrointestinal illness, a man with an autoimmune disease, another with severe dental damage, and Olga Jezler, 36, who was diagnosed with endometriosis, a condition involving abnormal tissue growth from the uterus that can

cause severe pain and infertility.

“These are American citizens who are innocent of violations of Russian law. They’re being held in Russia because they are Americans or because they have American status, and we shouldn’t need to wait for their health to be on the brink of death for there to be an urgency

to bring them home,” said Eric Lebson, chief strategy officer for Global Reach, a firm that advocates for hostages and detainees and represents multiple Americans jailed in Russia.

The State Department said it was aware of concerns about medical care and continues to raise the issue with the Russians.

The Russian Federal Penitentiary Service did not respond to a message seeking comment.

The medical care of Russia’s prisoners has long been a source of scrutiny.

Gilman, a Massachusetts teacher, had been detained since 2022 on charges of assaulting a police officer. His family disput-

ed the charges, and the State Department classified him as wrongly detained.

Before Gilman was flown out of Russia, he had been in “a dissociative stupor” for 47 days due to abuse he suffered in prison, Lebson has said. After Gilman was moved to the hospital, he was hooked up to a feeding tube and handcuffed to a bed.

The images of Gilman on the plane ride home raised troubling questions about his condition and the care he received, said Liz Richards, director of hostage advocacy and research at the Foley Foundation, a hostage advocacy organization. “We know he wasn’t getting the medical care and treatment that he needs.”

Olga Jezler, a green card holder, was arrested in 2022 after arriving in Russia to visit a sister grappling with cancer and charged with possessing CBD capsules that her husband and representatives say were legally permissible to carry.

She has been diagnosed with endometriosis, and a growth on her ovary continues to expand. Her husband and supporters are concerned the Russian government approach will be simply to remove the ovary if the cyst keeps growing, as opposed to trying to preserve as much healthy tissue as possible — which they say would be the standard of care in the US

The couple recently marked their seventh anniversary, but “it’s the fifth one we’ve celebrated apart,” Harold Jezler said.

Research on disabled parents loses federal funding

The Trump administration has eliminated a funding stream that for the past 30 years has

POLITICAL NOTEBOOK supported the only US government-backed national research center focused on parents with disabilities.

The National Research Center for Parents with Disabilities will begin to phase out its operations on Monday, when the current five-year grant ends, officials from the center said.

The center, based at Brandeis University’s Heller School for Social Policy and Management, is a multiple university collaboration aimed at improving the lives of the 4.5 million US parents with disabilities and their families. The center, which funds researchers in Boston and around the country, analyzes health care access and economic hardships faced by parents with disabilities and tracks state laws, serving as a clearinghouse for information on the issue.

The government has supported the center for decades through a competitive grant that has provided \$500,000 a year in

recent years and was slated to increase. Monika Mitra, the center’s director, said that an initial notice announcing the grant was posted a year ago, as is usually the case. But the more detailed information required to submit an application, which normally arrives in the grant application portal by February, never appeared. In July, the original link announcing the grant vanished.

“I emailed people at the institute, and I didn’t hear back,” she said, referring to the National Institute on Disability, Independent Living and Rehabilitation Research, the federal government’s primary disability research organization.

Last week, she said, officials from the Administration for Community Living, part of the Department of Health and Human Services, confirmed to her that the funding had been eliminated. She has since been trying to find alternative funding.

The Health Department did not respond to repeated requests for comment on the elimination of the funding. But in a letter reviewed by The New York

Times, Kristi W. Hill, an official at the national disability institute, confirmed that the grant funding for the center had been eliminated, saying it “should not be interpreted as a determination that research concerning parents with disabilities or their families is no longer important.” The person who shared the letter asked not to be identified, fearing retaliation from the administration.

In the letter, Hill wrote, the institute must “periodically assess investments across the full scope of that mission and make difficult funding decisions.”

NEW YORK TIMES

Three at Secret Service put on leave amid investigation

A top spokesperson for the Secret Service and two other agency officials have been placed on leave amid an internal investigation, two senior Trump administration officials said Wednesday.

The Secret Service’s communications director, Anthony Guglielmi, who has worked at the agency since 2022, was placed on administrative leave,

according to the two people, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss the matter publicly.

In a statement, the Secret Service said that “three non-law enforcement personnel” at the agency were on administrative leave “pending an investigation into potential misconduct.” The investigation is being conducted by the Office of Professional Responsibility, the agency said.

The Secret Service declined to provide additional comment. Guglielmi did not immediately respond to a message seeking comment. CNN earlier reported the development.

The agency has been under intense scrutiny for years, particularly after two attempts on Donald Trump’s life in 2024, when he was a candidate for president. The lead agent from Trump’s detail during his four years out of office, Sean Curran, now oversees the agency.

The Secret Service agents who travel with Trump were approached for questioning by the FBI as part of a leak investigation, after The New York Times

and other news outlets reported that the agency had discussed security concerns about the plane the president flew in to a NATO summit in Turkey in July.

The Times reported hours later that a jet donated by Qatar lacked some of the defensive capabilities of the older Air Force One fleet. The president flew it to Turkey and suggested that he would be leaving on one of the older Air Force One models.

The Washington Post later reported, and the Times confirmed, that Trump had fooled the public, making a show of boarding the older Air Force One in Turkey before being secretly whisked off the aircraft using a catering container. That left much of the president’s staff, as well as journalists, to fly out of the country without Trump amid a threat to the plane that officials viewed as credible.

NEW YORK TIMES

Maryland Democrats lose redistricting round

A Maryland court has ruled against a proposed constitutional amendment that could have paved the way for Democrats to

redraw the state” congressional districts.

The ruling Wednesday by a judge in the state’s capital city marks another setback in Democrats’ national attempts to counter a Republican redistricting movement pushed by President Trump ahead of this year’s elections. The judge ruled that the amendment cannot appear on the November ballot, but he paused the effect of that ruling to allow for an appeal to the state Supreme Court.

Democrats already control seven of Maryland’s eight congressional seats. Democratic Governor Wes Moore called lawmakers into a special session in August with a goal of making it easier to claim that final seat.

An amendment referred to the ballot by lawmakers seeks to sidestep a court ruling that struck down a previous Democratic redistricting plan in 2022. It would declare that a constitutional requirement for districts to be compact and take into account “natural boundaries” applies only to state legislative districts, not congressional ones.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

So far, Markey has mostly dodged a gotcha moment on age

►SENATE
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was quick to note his support from even younger representatives.

It’s all left some experts to question: Will the message ultimately break through?

That, they say, depends. Samuel Moyn, a Yale University professor and author of “Gerontocracy in America,” said in an interview that while age matters to many voters, if an older candidate doesn’t risk imminent “cognitive decline or outright death,” they will likely have a leg up in fending off those attacks.

Moulton and Markey are more similar than they are different on paper: They both agree that ICE should be abolished, that there should be better access to health care, and that women should be able to have abortions.

In a recent campaign ad, Moulton even said: “Senator Markey and I want the same things,” though, he argues, “wanting isn’t winning.”

“This is the lesson of this contest,” Moyn speculated. “If you have two people who are ideologically very similar and the older candidate is high functioning enough, he will win.”

Since the beginning of the campaign, Moulton has tried to convince voters that Markey is

too old to serve another six-year term — by its end, he’ll be 86. He has challenged Markey to disclose his health records, called for a “serious conversation about” age limits in Congress, and suggested term limits for committee chairs.

In April, a dark money group led by a Moulton donor ran a 30-second ad titled “Diagnosis,” which featured an actor playing a doctor who warns of a fictional ailment called “Chronic Re-election Disorder.” The PAC ran a similar ad that aired before the August debate, showing a time-lapse of photos of Markey during his 50 years in Congress.

If he wins, Markey wouldn’t be the oldest senator in the chamber. Republican Chuck Grassley is the oldest sitting senator at the age of 92, followed by Vermont Senator Bernie Sanders, who turns 85 next month. Sanders has endorsed Markey and is scheduled to rally with him Saturday in Dorchester. The average age of a senator at the start of last year was just under 64.

In other races, it often was a defining moment — a health scare or public flub — that provided a touchstone for arguments for a younger option. Connecticut voters recently ousted longtime Representative John Larson, who froze mid-



KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Representative Seth Moulton has challenged Senator Ed Markey to disclose his health records.

sentence for nearly 20 seconds during a speech on the House floor in February 2025. Larson, 78, said it was due to a partial seizure.

Perhaps most famous was former President Joe Biden’s debate performance in June 2024. Biden sounded hoarse, frequently lost his train of thought, and made factual errors, all but crippling many Democrats’ confidence in him. Biden ultimately withdrew from the race, and that November, President Trump won a second term over Vice President Kamala Harris.

But this Senate primary has lacked a relative show-me moment, watchers say.

Markey has also proven he

can beat a younger candidate. At 40, Representative Joseph P. Kennedy III lost the Senate primary to Markey, 74 at the time.

While Kennedy was decidedly younger, Markey had successfully rebranded himself as the hip, progressive fighter with endorsements from rising stars like New York Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez and the youth-led Sunrise Movement for climate action. By the time Election Day rolled around, Markey was polling 10 points ahead of Kennedy among voters 35 and younger.

David D’Alessandro, the former chief executive of John Hancock, recently penned an op-ed making a case for younger

leaders on Beacon Hill. But he contends that Moulton is “oversimplifying” the age issue.

“His argument is coming out as, ‘He’s old, I’m young, vote for me,’” D’Alessandro said. “Markey was beatable with the right candidate.”

The age argument is also “a proxy or a straw man” that challenges wield against incumbent politicians instead of focusing on structural issues like campaign finance reform or party recruitment, said Tracey Gendron, chair of Virginia Commonwealth University’s Department of Gerontology.

“Age alone is an insufficient measure of competency,” said Gendron, author of the book “Ageism Unmasked.” “It’s also an insufficient measure of health.”

Gendron said the focus on age has “blown up” since Biden’s failed reelection campaign, and warned that age is used as a political cudgel without regard to a specific diagnosis or condition. Voters, she said, can get distracted by what she called essentially a non-issue.

While there are certain people in office who “won’t let go of power,” she said, blaming a candidate’s age is too simplistic.

“I’m going to vote for somebody based on how well they

ideologically match with my values,” she said. “To take somebody down based on age . . . that is not only a value but an antithesis.”

So far, the odds are in the older candidate’s favor. Recent polling showed Markey leading Moulton by double digits ahead of the Sept. 1 primary. And nearly half of the 500 voters surveyed in a Suffolk University/Boston Globe poll said that all else being equal, Markey’s age “makes no difference” in their choice.

By comparison, 33 percent of voters said the senator’s age would make them less likely to vote for him, while 11 percent said they would not vote for Markey because of his age.

Gendron said this is likely because Democratic primary voters don’t see a problem with Markey’s record or see an urgent need for change. Plus, she said, “there is no typical 80-year-old.”

“We tend to group people into ‘the elderly’ and think that older people are a monolith,” she said. “To think all people of a certain age are just a certain way doesn’t make sense.”

Samantha J. Gross can be reached at samantha.gross@globe.com. Follow her @samanthajgross.

Meta to pay \$18b, work to curb teen addiction

►**META**
Continued from Page A1

sented with “clear options” to remove autoplay and personalized algorithmic feed features; receive pauses and breaks — or “prompts,” as Meta calls them — at 15 minutes of continuous use and after one hour and 1½ hours of cumulative use; have “like counts” for their own posts disabled (Meta said counts would also be hidden for posts from others); and lose access to certain beauty-focused filters.

On its website, Meta said parents would be able to get new controls over teen accounts, such as updates on usage and alerts if their child interacts with “potentially suspicious accounts.”

The rules apply to 13-to-18-year-olds. Those under 13 are not allowed to use Instagram or Facebook.

In a statement, Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell said the settlement was about “changing the way Big Tech does business.” The judge approved the settlement later Wednesday.

C.J. Mahoney, Meta’s chief legal officer, said in a statement that the agreement includes “a new set of rules governing teens’ use of social media.”

“The framework we’ve negotiated will empower parents to easily manage how their children access our platforms,” Mahoney said.

The changes will hit teen users over the next four to six months, according to Campbell’s office. Over the next year, her office added, Meta must also “implement an enhanced age assurance framework designed to identify users under 13 and users ages 13 to 18 with a high level of accuracy.”

Michael Rich, director of the Digital Wellness Lab and codirector of the Clinic for Interactive Media and Internet Disorders at Boston Children’s Hospital, said many of the changes sound “like things we’ve been

AG Andrea Joy Campbell’s office said the agreement is the largest state consumer protection settlement in history outside of Big Tobacco agreements from the 1990s.

recommending for a long time.”

While Rich argued that the settlement does not address some of the big underlying issues of the platforms, he said “if it serves to shift peer norms, then that part of it is a good thing.”

Campbell’s office said the agreement is the largest state consumer protection settlement in history outside of Big Tobacco agreements from the 1990s.

Massachusetts will receive up to \$516 million, according to Campbell’s office. Roughly \$366 million is guaranteed to be paid over the next 10 years, which includes money resolving privacy claims dealing with Facebook data obtained by Cambridge Analytica.

The money will go toward “efforts to remediate the harms caused by social media to Massachusetts young people,” including mental health services, after-school programs, and phone-free school initiatives, Campbell’s office said. An independent auditor will monitor the company’s compliance and whether the measures are having their intended effect, Campbell said at a news conference Wednesday.

Rhode Island will receive up to \$64.5 million, according to



NOAH BERGER/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Colorado Solicitor General Shannon Stevenson hugged a colleague outside of court after tech giant Meta agreed to the landmark settlement concerning teenagers’ addiction to some apps.

the state’s attorney general. Vermont could receive as much as \$127 million, according to its attorney general, Charity Clark. Maine will get no less than \$56 million, and Connecticut will receive up to \$265.4 million, according to their respective attorneys general offices.

New Hampshire wasn’t a plaintiff in the federal litigation, but instead filed a separate lawsuit in 2023 alleging Meta had violated New Hampshire’s consumer protection laws by peddling addictive products to kids. Attorney General John M. Formella said during a press conference Wednesday afternoon that his state will settle its case and receive up to \$224 million.

Meta said states will receive about 70 percent of the payments — to be doled out in annual installments — with the other 30 percent coming only if YouTube and TikTok, which are owned by different companies,

agree to payments and to implement similar age-restrictions.

If TikTok and YouTube agree to these terms, Meta would also further tighten some of the new restrictions; its daily limit would go to one hour per app, and nighttime notification blocks would stretch to 10 p.m.–7 a.m.

“We want to ensure teens benefit from this new industry standard, but we cannot do it alone,” Meta said in its announcement of the settlement.

At her news conference, Campbell said her office intends to use the agreement as leverage in similar litigation it brought against TikTok and to push other tech companies toward similar standards. She stopped short of supporting an outright ban on social media for teenagers, saying the platforms can provide some benefits for young people, including young LGBTQ+ people seeking community.

“What we do need are protections in place in the company to redesign their apps in a way that doesn’t promote harm,” she said.

The changes will take place “in participating US states and territories,” Meta said. It also said “[t]he majority of the terms are required to remain in place for 10 years.”

Rich, the director of the Digital Wellness Lab, said the settlement is missing stronger curbs on “the algorithms that drive these sites.” (Meta said it would maintain its existing content restrictions for teens, designed to filter out sensitive materials.)

“It’s not looking at the actual business model that they have of maximizing engagement at any cost,” Rich said.

Rich also wondered if the deal might backfire, by creating a “forbidden fruit syndrome” that tempts teens to find workarounds, as kids have done in

Australia after a social media ban took effect late last year.

“This just creates more of a divide between the young users and adults,” he said.

Sophie Godley, a clinical associate professor of public health at Boston University, said the new platform limitations “have the potential to be really effective,” even if kids try to find ways around them.

“This gives parents and families and teachers and schools — it gives us the sort of social agreement that’s like, ‘We’ve all talked about it, and we all think this isn’t good for you,’ ” Godley said.

In April, Massachusetts’ highest court ruled that the state could sue Meta over allegations that Facebook and Instagram are too addictive to minors. That came weeks after a separate California jury awarded \$6 million in damages to a 20-year-old woman who said she’d become addicted as a child to Meta’s Instagram and Google’s YouTube.

Earlier this month, a New Mexico court ordered Meta to pay \$567 million to address the harms its platforms cause young people. That sum was in addition to the \$375 million jurors previously ordered against the company.

A number of other lawsuits against Meta are still pending.

“Maybe this generation of teenagers is really going to struggle, because they have had access,” Godley said, “but my hope is that 10 years from now, it would be unheard of for teenagers to have unrestricted access like they do now.”

Matt Stout, Nick Stoico, Paul Heintz, and Steven Porter of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Dana Gerber can be reached at dana.gerber@globe.com. Follow her @danagerber6. Paul Heintz can be reached at paul.heintz@globe.com. Follow him on X @paulheintz.

College students want the right look, and they’ll pay for help

►**DORMS**
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“The feeds that they look at, they see beautiful things all the time, and their access to that stimulation only makes them covet it more,” said interior designer Craig Tevolitz, who owns the boutique design studio Platemark on Newbury Street.

Tevolitz wasn’t trying to custom-design dorm rooms, but fell into it when some of his existing clients asked him to help their college-bound children. For parents, helping set up the room offers the chance for an extended goodbye.

“I’m not going to psychoanalyze it, but you know, it’s holding on,” Tevolitz said. “All of these bonding experiences are moments of holding on, not letting go.”

Mahoney and Giordano know that feeling well. They launched Dorm Essentials in 2024, after moving their oldest kids to college. As best friends who met in a mommy group and now have three daughters each, they’ve personally experienced the stress of buying all the right things to set their kids up for success.

For the most part, students here eschew froofy for functional — “a clean, organized, great look,” Mahoney said. Because most of her clients fly into the Boston area from across the country and abroad, she added, “they kind of show up just with their clothes, and we show up with everything else.”

And she does mean everything: In addition to U-Hauls full of bedding and furnishings, Mahoney and Giordano arrive at campuses around the region equipped with double-sided tape, scissors, and lots of trash bags. They even recruit their own daughters to hang fake plants and fold towels.

But part of their M.O. is helping families decide what not to buy.

“These dorm rooms are small,” Mahoney said.

Forget the couch — it probably won’t fit anyway. Instead, they recommend ottomans along with a rug and curtains. In some dorms, like BU doubles, IKEA shelves can be



PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Kerry Giordano (left) and Kelly Mahoney, owners and cofounders of Dorm Essentials Co., prepared to hang curtains as they set up the room for their client, Zara Mody, at Boston University. Below, Giordano got a hug from Mody.

stacked on each side of a mini fridge with a plank of wood on top for extra storage and a pseudo bedside table. And extra lighting is always needed to create atmosphere around that timeless college staple, the XL twin bed.

“The bottom line is, all the girls and the boys, too, they live in their beds,” Mahoney said. “So our favorite rooms are those where there’s a neutral bedding with a little pop of color to give it a bit of design, but not make it look overly engineered.”

As for everything else, from hangers to surge protectors, it adds up quickly for what’s ultimately a short period of time, so Mahoney and Giordano urge restraint and coordination with roommates. Share the vacuum, rent the fridge, and ditch the coat rack — no college kid is going to use a coat rack.

Mahoney and Giordano now have clients at schools including



Boston College, Northeastern, Suffolk, Emerson, and Tufts. Sometimes 3-D layouts are available online. When they meet with students via Zoom, they also welcome AI suggestions, Pinterest boards, and YouTube tours for inspiration.

“Our clients are particular about what they want,” Giordano said. They have around 40, coming from California, Hawaii, and Texas, and from countries ranging from Singapore to Greece.

Tara Lloyd is a 20-year-old

BU sophomore from Wilshire, England, who hired Dorm Essentials last year. She had never been to the United States and had no idea where to start when it came to decorating her room.

“I’m not gonna be able to Fenway Target this,” she recalled, thinking about all her room needed.

From the UK, she talked with Mahoney and Giordano about her color palette (light blue), looked at websites they sent her, and shared her own ideas sourced from Pinterest and TikTok. When she arrived in Boston, they unboxed her room in an hour.

As an international student, Lloyd can’t help but gawk at room-tour videos of dorms at Southern schools like Ole Miss and the University of Alabama. Her parents, who are “very British,” couldn’t understand why she cared so much about bedskirts and still think “the whole

thing is ludicrous,” she said.

“I had to convince them,” Lloyd said. “But once they saw it all together, they were like, ‘Oh, it makes sense.’ ”

Costs depend on the client and have ranged from \$800 to \$3,000, said Giordano, while budgets often depend on birth order and gender. Parents want their sons to have “places to put things,” Mahoney said. “The ‘girl moms,’ ” meanwhile, “they want the room to be perfect.”

Tevolitz, the Back Bay designer, demurred when asked to provide an estimate for his services. “We’ll say, for the price of your meal plan, you could have your room decorated,” he said and laughed.

But a stylish dorm room doesn’t have to be pricey, said Jena Kim, a 21-year-old rising senior and self-described low-income, first-generation student at Smith College in Northampton. To zhuzh up her room, she’s relied on thrifting, gifting, and creative repurposing.

“I love putting trash on my walls . . . I’ve had movie tickets, cards my friends have written me, the wrapper of my favorite candy,” said Kim, a New Yorker who has shared glimpses of her dorm room on Instagram. “I really love that kind of aesthetic that’s a little chaotic and messy, because I think that’s who I am.”

Plus, there are always the free bins of stuff other students have left behind. “I’ve gotten a Keurig. I’ve gotten a beanbag chair,” said Kim, who now pays that forward. “You really don’t have to spend a lot of money.”

Mahoney agrees that “less is more” and reminds clients in the city that students can always find what they need if something is missing.

“They’re not stranded,” she said. “I mean, they’re in Boston.”

Brooke Hauser can be reached at brooke.hauser@globe.com. Follow her @brookehauser. Michaela Towfighi can be reached at michaela.towfighi@globe.com. Follow her on X @michaelatowfighi.



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A view of White Stadium construction on Aug. 18.

EDITORIAL

Can we please end the rancor over White Stadium now?

At some point the political and legal squabbling over the future of White Stadium needs to end, allowing the constructive job of assuring its use and accessibility to Boston’s student athletes and the community to begin.

Now would be a really good time.

Last week the state’s highest court weighed in on the legal question of whether the city’s deal with the Boston Legacy Football Club to split the costs of a long-overdue reconstruction of the 75-year-old facility violated the state law that protects parklands.

The Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court was as clear as clear could be in a unanimous opinion, written by Justice Gabrielle R. Wolohojian, ruling that the stadium may be located in Franklin Park, but it is not protected parkland — and hasn’t been for 75 years.

“We conclude that the 1947 and 1950 statutes collectively establish the Legislature’s unequivocal intent to extinguish the stadium parcel’s status as parkland,” the court found. “The 1947 statute demonstrated the Legislature’s willingness to divert parkland to the White Fund for nonpark uses, and the 1950 statute showed the Legislature’s recognition and approval of the stadium parcel’s new status as a school ground.”

The court also rejected the opponents’ contention that “the construction and improvement of pedestrian and vehicular pathways and utility lines to the stadium” — everything necessary to make the facility accessible to student athletes and to the fans of the women’s professional soccer team that is footing the lion’s share of the costs — would change the nature of the park and the way it is used.

“But pathways, including vehicular pathways, are ordinary elements of a park landscape,” the court found.

End of story.

But this is Boston, where political battles often take on a life of their own.

Neighborhood groups, including the Emerald Necklace Conservancy and the Roxbury Neighborhood Council, which were filing the lawsuit, are vowing to fight on, insisting they support “a smaller but fully public project that would be better for Boston’s students, the public and local residents.”

But without political support at City Hall for their idea — and there is none in the Wu administration — that fight is dead in the water. The contracts and lease agreements are already signed.

The bulldozers have long since cleared away everything but the art deco clamshell wall, which is to be integrated into the new structure, and construction proceeds apace.

At some point it behooves parties on all sides to set aside the rancor and work to ensure that the facility will provide all that was promised to Boston Public School kids — first-rate playing fields and tracks, good seating for their fans, state-of-the-art locker

rooms, classrooms, and facilities they can be proud of.

Sure, the now \$325 million facility isn’t the bargain-basement price it was when it was first proposed in 2023. Back then city taxpayers were picking up only \$50 million of the total \$100 million project. Now the city is on the hook for \$135 million, with Boston Legacy picking up \$190 million of the new tab.

The team is also expected to pay more than \$62 million in rent, maintenance, and other improvements to the park over the 10-year period of the initial lease.

A community benefits package during and after the construction phase means local businesses will also benefit. The city said some \$52.4 million in contracts have already been awarded to local firms, including women and minority-owned businesses.

The timeline for completion remains something of a mystery — the line on the city’s own website for “Expected year to be completed” still reads “To be determined.” City officials have indicated an updated estimate is just weeks away. And the project is now on a six-day work week schedule.

With construction equipment beeping and clanging in the background during Wu’s post-decision news conference in Franklin Park last week, the mayor noted that the litigation “has been a distraction” and did result in some delays.

But “our Boston kids deserve the very best, and as a city, we can never apologize for fighting to give it to them,” she said, adding, “As a government our job is to take those big swings, even when they’re hard, even when they’re complicated, even when they require really creative partnerships and legal documents and leases.”

The facility itself will be open to the community “every day,” Wu assured.

Meanwhile, City Hall will have a continuing obligation to make sure it keeps costs in check to protect taxpayers.

And there’s still an important role for community groups and parents of BPS students to play in the days ahead. Someone needs to hold the city’s feet to the fire on a workable transportation plan for Legacy game days in what will be an 11,000-seat facility.

Even more importantly, parents and community leaders need to make sure BPS students do indeed get what has been promised to them. City officials say that students will get “first crack” at the stadium as soon as it’s done. And post-season high school football games — which will be possible when the Legacy season ends in mid-November — are guaranteed in the lease agreement.

Making sure those promises are kept is an important role for people who insist they care about the city’s student athletes. Now they need to show they care about those kids more than about carrying on the fight.

KIMBERLY ATKINS STOHR

Trump’s mail-in voting order is sowing chaos. That’s the point.

The legal drama over President Trump’s executive order seeking to limit mail-in voting ahead of the midterm elections — including a preliminary Supreme Court ruling in his favor — has sowed chaos. And that, of course, is part of the plan.

After the justices’ ruling Monday that seemed to clear the way for the order to go in effect, a Massachusetts District Court judge underscored that a separate injunction kept the matter blocked, and even accused the administration of flouting the law by publishing final regulations to implement it. That is, before she lifted that injunction Wednesday, as another challenge to Trump’s order has been filed in a Washington, D.C., federal court, which means more injunctions could soon be issued.

Meanwhile, states are left in limbo as ballots for November’s elections are set to go out as soon as next week.

The Supreme Court could have prevented this mayhem by putting the order on pause while all the litigation proceeds. Unfortunately the court’s ma-

In short, the order would let the administration choose who can and cannot vote by mail.

jority seems either blind or indifferent to the confusion as well as to the autocracy that is taking hold under its watch. The rest of us cannot afford that luxury.

The occasion calls for absolute bluntness: Trump’s executive order seeking to limit mail-in voting, particularly in Democratic-leaning states, is one of the most audacious attacks on American democracy the country has experienced in its 250 years of existence.

It is not, as the court’s six conservatives so benignly described it, “an internal directive from the President to his subordinates mandating that certain agencies pursue certain policies.” Nor is it, as those justices wrote in the unsigned ruling, “designed to maintain public confidence in federal elections.” The fact that they frame it this way, despite the red flags raised by their three Democratic-appointed colleagues in dissent, is, frankly, outrageous.

What Trump’s directive would actually do is empower the US Postal Service to refuse to deliver ballots of voters whose names do not appear on a voter list being compiled by the Department of Homeland Security, in ways that have raised both legal and accuracy concerns. It would also empower the Justice Department to prioritize the prosecution of state and local officials who issue ballots to voters who are not on that list. In short, the order would let the administration choose who can and cannot vote by mail. All this from a president who, despite his repeated false claims of rampant fraud in mail-in balloting, votes by mail himself.

This measure will go a long way to further the United States’ antidemocratic backslide into autocracy, bringing our nation’s system of government closer to those of Russia, Pakistan, India, Hungary, and Venezuela, where elections are held, but the parties in control — not the electorate — determine the outcome.

That threat alone should have been more than enough for the nation’s highest court to temporarily put the brakes on the directive, especially with the midterms just over two months away. I think the nation’s framers would be appalled by Trump’s attempt to rule like a king, and that any originalist view of the executive order would come to the same constitutional conclusion.

Which is just one reason why the justices’ ruling in Trump’s favor is so confounding.

Time is of the essence. The Supreme Court ruled only on the preliminary question of whether states seeking to block Trump’s order had standing, or enough of an actual injury, to sue. The majority essentially found that it was too early in the game to do so: No states had been required to do anything yet to comply with the order.

This is too clever by half. The reason states have not yet been required to begin taking steps like printing ballots with a barcode to allow the Postal Service to check the ballots against the Department of Homeland Security’s voter list is because the administration only just finalized the proposed postal regulation, and it has yet to compile the voter list. By the time it does, it will be all but impossible for states to scramble to adhere to them before the midterms. And state and local officials who opt to stick with their current methods of mail-in voting face the threat of federal prosecution.

As Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson puts it in her dissent: “What makes today’s ruling so off-base is the Court’s lack of situational awareness regarding this equitable judgment.”

“Taking its eye off the ball, the majority misses the Government’s actual objective: to secure our imprimatur for its effort to foment chaos ahead of the November elections,” Jackson wrote.

That imprimatur is a powerful tool for a president that is seeking to put power over the foundational principle of our democracy: that the government belongs to the people, not to him.

Kimberly Atkins Stohr is a columnist for the Globe. She may be reached at kimberly.atkinsstohr@globe.com.

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INBOX

JOAN VENNOCHI

Who’s better on AI, Markey or Moulton? I asked ChatGPT.

Who among us of a certain age could not relate to Senator Ed Markey when he was asked during last week’s Senate debate with Representative Seth Moulton about how he personally uses artificial intelligence.

“I use whatever is inside of my iPhone and my iPad, whatever comes up. And I don’t know what companies my iPad might be using, but if it does, in fact, provide me with the information which I’m asking the device to give them, then of course I’m using it,” Markey replied.

Moulton, who has made the issue of generational change the driving theme of his campaign to defeat the 80-year-old incumbent, was quick to pounce. “With all due respect, Senator, if you don’t even know

knowledgeable about AI policy and technology regulation,” and has spent “decades working on telecommunications, the internet, privacy and technology policy.”

“Bottom line,” said ChatGPT, “I would call Markey an experienced expert on the policy, regulatory, civil rights and societal implications of AI.”

Asked about Moulton, ChatGPT was also complimentary, noting that with a bachelor of science degree in physics from Harvard, “he has a stronger technical/scientific background than many members of Congress.” Moulton’s involvement in defense technology and emerging technologies was also cited by ChatGPT, as well as the fact that his congressional office has “actually integrated AI into its operations.”

The Moulton campaign also forwarded a list of leg-



GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION; KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE; RICHARDSON/ADOBE

what you’re using on your phone or your iPad ... this is why we need a new generation of leaders to regulate these technologies,” responded Moulton, who has since featured Markey’s fumble on TikTok.

As with most sound bites, however, it’s not entirely fair to use the “whatever comes up” snippet against Markey as harshly as Moulton did. Over his 50 years in Congress, Markey, in fact, has been at the forefront of efforts to regulate the new technology of the moment. What might be considered the signature accomplishment of his career, the Telecommunications Act of 1996, regulated how Americans consume news and entertainment — if in hindsight, with mixed results.

Much more recently, in July, Markey released an “AI accountability agenda” that includes nearly a dozen legislative proposals that would curtail the use of AI. Key provisions of legislation that he coauthored to block the use of AI in making nuclear launch decisions were included in legislation signed in 2024 by President Biden. This month, the Senate Commerce, Science, and Transportation Committee he sits on passed his legislation to require AI companies to build safety and privacy safeguards for minors into their chatbots.

Still, it does seem fair to ask whether at this point in his political career, Markey is best-equipped to lead the charge when it comes to drafting complicated legislation to regulate the AI industry. Of course, he will have the benefit of guidance from industry experts, as well as from young, smart, digitally native staff members. But relying on others isn’t the same as innately understanding the nature of the AI beast that threatens to take over our jobs, not to mention the world.

Given that I am someone who looks at “whatever is inside my iPhone,” and does not pretend to understand the difference between AI platforms, who am I to judge Moulton’s criticism of Markey when it comes to his ability to understand it?

So, I asked ChatGPT — the artificial intelligence chatbot — how it would characterize Markey in connection with AI.

The answer that came back: Markey “is very

isolation that it said Moulton authored or cosponsored that relates to AI. It includes a bill that would require manufacturers of Internet-connected smart appliances to disclose to consumers when their product is equipped with a camera or microphone; bipartisan legislation that would grant survivors the right to take civil action against individuals who knowingly produce, distribute, solicit, and receive or possess non-consensual sexually explicit digital forgeries; and an act that would establish a coordinated federal strategy to strengthen US leadership in AI.

Who is more qualified to “talk intelligently about AI?”

According to ChatGPT, Moulton has a stronger background, Markey has deeper experience.

Age did not come up in my ChatGPT analysis and if the polls are right, Moulton’s age argument against Markey isn’t resonating with likely Massachusetts primary voters.

They seem satisfied with Markey’s embrace of progressive slogans like “Green New Deal” and “Medicare for All,” and his name-checking of progressive icons like Senator Bernie Sanders and Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez.

If progressive sloganeering is what Massachusetts primary voters want from their senator, Markey can certainly deliver. But while he has led the way on technology issues in the past, perhaps that time has passed?

That’s a legitimate concern, given that Markey initially stumbled on a basic debate question about AI usage.

In the end, both Markey and Moulton pledged to regulate AI as needed.

Who is best positioned to do that? Like everything else about this race, it’s a matter of weighing past performance against future leadership potential — and in my human assessment, Moulton has the upper hand.

Joan Vennoch is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at joan.vennoch@globe.com. Follow her @joan_vennoch.

On Beacon Hill is it lawmakers’ age or their governance that’s the problem?

It’s past time for elderly members to make way for a new generation

Bravo to David D’Alessandro for calling out the aging of our state Legislature (“Massachusetts has an aging problem. It’s called Beacon Hill,” Opinion, Aug. 17). His comments reflect my thoughts exactly.

As I enter the seventh decade of my life, I feel I am within my rights to criticize the elderly members of the House and Senate. It is a ridiculous double standard that Massachusetts requires judges to retire at 70 while these same lawmakers remain in their vaunted positions well past the time they should leave their seats and open them up to a new generation. I urge lawmakers to look at themselves and their ability to adequately represent the public.

I fully support term limits, and Massachusetts should follow the lead of the 16 states that have already enacted them. I hope the public will pay more attention to whom they elect to office and consider something other than incumbency when they enter the voting booth.

LINDA C. BARTON
Stoughton

Thank you to David D’Alessandro for echoing my thoughts on older lawmakers’ control of both state and federal legislatures.

Succession plans in business call for thoughtful mentoring and planning in order to transfer power and welcome in a new creative generation.

KATHY ARKLE BOROFSKY
Yarmouth Port

Fault lies in perk-hungry leaders and power of lobbies, not ‘gerontocracy’

It’s not “gerontocracy,” as David D’Alessandro suggests, that makes so many on Beacon Hill lazy and corrupt. It’s often the power of lobbies and the structure of governance that pays so many to head do-nothing committees. Who has faith that younger “leaders” won’t crave the same perks?

Meanwhile, Massachusetts is losing one of its best legislators of recent years, the wise and knowledgeable Senator Patricia Jehlen, who, after wrangling the best possible long-term care bill out of the craven fools who for decades have failed to pass a raise in the “personal needs allowance” for the indigent residents of nursing homes, is leaving — at only 82.

We need more people who care — of whatever age — since so much remains to be done in so many areas of state responsibility.

That legislators like Jehlen are reelected year after year is due to the wisdom of voters in their districts. Some blame does fall elsewhere — on the voters sending back legislators who are happy with the sclerotic system.

It’s no surprise that D’Alessandro, a former finance CEO, is mistaking older age for weakness. For decades foolish corporations avoiding seniority raises have rejected their experienced workers, when the truth is that successful businesses keep their “gray hairs” leading an intergenerational workforce.

MARGARET MORGANROTH GULLETTE
Newton

Djuna Perkins is best prepared to lead Norfolk DA’s office

The Globe’s endorsement in the Norfolk district attorney race (“Adam Deitch for Norfolk DA,” Editorial, Aug. 18) overlooks a fundamental question: Who is best prepared to run a troubled Massachusetts DA’s office?

The editorial board acknowledges that Djuna Perkins is “highly qualified.” Indeed, she has spent 34 years as a Massachusetts lawyer, nearly 10 as a prosecutor supervising dozens of attorneys and thousands of cases and 20 more representing crime victims and investigating abuse in schools and workplaces. She has earned the endorsements of former attorney general Scott Harshbarger and former Suffolk district attorney Ralph Martin. Deitch, by contrast, has no experience prosecuting cases in Massachusetts state courts and no comparable supervisory experience.

Those distinctions matter. Deitch himself has described his preferred federal work as “document-heavy ‘paper’ cases” resembling the white-collar matters he handled in private practice. As I know from decades of experience as an attorney in Massachusetts state courts, that is far removed from the daily work of the Norfolk DA’s office and our trial courts.

Norfolk County needs experienced leadership. Based on the qualifications the editorial board details and on her inspiring personal background and passion for this work, Perkins is the stronger choice.

CATHLEEN CAVELL
Brookline

The writer, who has publicly endorsed Perkins, has been an attorney in Massachusetts since 1974.

How about this debate format? Candidates take on the TV ads.

Given the unavoidable flood of television ads that accompany political campaigns, it might be interesting to incorporate them directly into one of the traditional televised debates. Each candidate would select a small set of their opponents’ ads to be replayed during the event, with time allotted for candidates to challenge, clarify, and defend the claims made in those ads.

RON POLITO
Newtonville



ANTHONY BROWN

PATRICK CHAPPATTE



She’s searching for common ground on vaccines

►VACCINES
Continued from Page A1

Marnik balked when a nurse asked to give the baby a hepatitis B shot, saying she'd do it later. A friend gently reminded her why it's important to vaccinate at birth, and the baby did get the shot before leaving the hospital.

But Marnik had hesitated. And she was starting to understand her mother's burdens. "That moment, plus the whole entry into motherhood, really changed my perspective," Marnik said. "You have this immense pressure that if you don't do it right, things could happen. That really gave me more compassion."

Marnik's mother, Teresa Ryan, can still recall the pamphlet she came across decades ago, one of many such tales that she read. It described a healthy child who, after a series of vaccinations, started crying uncontrollably and running a high fever, and then went limp. The family's doctor merely stated that children must follow an immunization schedule. He offered no balm for her worries. Ryan decided her two children would absolutely not get those shots.

Today, Marnik, now 37 and with a PhD in immunology, is striving to counteract the kind of misinformation that ensnared her mother. With 64,000 followers on Instagram as @ScienceWhizLiz and 4,500 subscribers on her Substack, the Science Classroom, she speaks to those who already support vaccines, urging empathy and patience for the doubters. Shaming and excluding people like her mother, she argues, will do nothing to improve vaccine acceptance. Although strong evidence shows that vaccines are safe, facts alone rarely change minds.

Since February, Marnik has been the executive director of The Evidence Collective, a group of clinicians and scientists who are active on social media and pool their efforts in communicating accurate information about public health.

In her writing and public appearances — she once gave a talk in a brewery — Marnik aims to explain science in a way that anyone can understand, through stories, often from her own life.

"Liz is one of the few experts on vaccines who has been telling her own story in the process of coming to be an enthusiast for vaccine technology," said Jennifer Reich, professor of sociology at the University of Colorado, Denver, and author of the book "Calling the Shots: Why Parents Reject Vaccines." "Her willingness to share the journey that she and her family went through and to get to where she is, I think is a really valuable contribution to the conversation."

‘I was all in’ on an evangelical upbringing

That journey began in the small town of Thomaston, Conn., about 50 miles west of Hartford, where Marnik lived with her mother and younger brother.

The family's life revolved around an evangelical church in Waterbury. "Pretty much the only thing we did was go to church," she recalled recently, speaking above the hubbub in a Boston cafe. Her wavy light-brown hair drifts down the sides of her face, and her guileless gray-blue eyes and peaches-and-cream complexion make it easy to envision her teaching Sunday school, which she did.

"I was all in," she said.

A friend from those days, Megan Wolfe-Pelletier, remembers Marnik as a "gung-ho" organizer of church youth activities, baking pies to raise scholarship money for Indian orphans, distributing clothing, hot soup, and cocoa to kids in the poorest parts of Waterbury. "She's very organized and just hardworking," Wolfe-Pelletier said.

But her family struggled. Her parents split when she was a young girl. Her mother didn't work, and while her father paid the rent, he was mostly absent from their lives. Sometimes he delivered a \$20 bill for a day's worth of groceries for the three of them. They ate a lot of boxed macaroni and cheese. Fresh fruits and vegetables cost too much, and Marnik, as she later described it, became "obese."

Marnik and her brother were pulled out of elementary school,



ASHLEY L. CONTI FOR STAT

Liz Marnik, pitching to her son Owen, said she better understood her mother's choices after having her own children.

because students were about to read Harry Potter books, which involve stories of wizardry. They never donned costumes for Halloween. Nor were they allowed to watch Disney movies, which often included magic, and most secular television shows were off-limits. Creation, they were told, literally occurred over seven days; science and scientists contradicted the Bible and could not be trusted.

For three years, Marnik and her brother were homeschooled informally, and for a couple of years she attended a private Christian school until the family could no longer pay for it.

But Marnik had a hunger to learn. She persuaded her grandmother to buy her a homeschooling course, which she followed on her own for a year. "I would do the books, I would take the quizzes, I would then grade my own quizzes," she said.

Eventually she convinced her mother to enroll her in public school, starting with her junior year in high school. There she first encountered science, learning about atoms and calculating chemical reactions. She loved it.

At a teacher's urging, Marnik applied to college and enrolled at Central Connecticut State University. She was so quiet and withdrawn as a freshman that her adviser, chemistry professor Barry Westcott, feared she wouldn't make it to graduation. That all changed, Westcott said, when she started research on genetics in a faculty member's laboratory "and then was suddenly a nearly 4.0 student."

Marnik was "a natural" at science, despite her anti-science upbringing, said James Mulrooney, her biomolecular science professor. As an undergrad, she was among the authors of two published research papers.

In college, for the first time, Marnik had friends who weren't Christians, who held beliefs that were different from hers. Legairre Radden, one of her lab mates at the time, described her as shy, "nerdy, and into science," part of a tight group of four "introverts" who all worked in the laboratory and became like a second family.

But few knew much about what was happening in Marnik's own family back in Thomaston — until one morning near the end of her junior year.

"I remember that day vividly," Mulrooney said. He found her sitting in the lobby of the Nicolaus Copernicus Hall, sobbing. Surprised, he asked what was wrong.

For starters, she had a flat tire. Mulrooney and two other professors headed to the parking garage to try to change the tire.

A shift in perspective

Soon they learned more. "It was the first indication that there was more than just shyness here," Mulrooney said.

She'd been commuting 40 minutes each way to campus in a junk car. In addition to her classes and lab research, Marnik had a job at a dentist's office and was working on grad school applications. Her mother and brother didn't drive and depended on her to take them everywhere, leaving her to study in the car while they ran errands. Her brother was prone to out-

bursts. The previous night he'd been throwing plates.

She couldn't take it anymore. She left the house and called her pastor's wife, begging to come live with them. The wife advised her to stick it out at home. Instead Marnik spent most of the night driving around, thinking about quitting school. And then she pulled into the garage on campus and saw the flat tire.

As she watched three professors hack away at her car's rusted lug nuts, something shifted in her mind. She'd been told that people outside her faith were evil, and yet her pastor's wife had turned her away while these scientists were literally bending over to help her. "It was that moment," she said, "where I saw the contradiction between these two kinds of people."

Her professors urged her to stick with her education and connected her with a school counselor. One professor even invited Marnik to stay in her home near campus. Their support eased her way to graduation in 2011.

And when her grad school asked for proof of vaccination, Liz Marnik was finally ready to defy her upbringing and get the shots.

‘Antivaccine groups are very good at packaging what they’re saying in convincing ways. Often I think that there but for the grace of God go I.’

DORIT REISS, *University of California San Francisco*

To avoid adding to her mother's anxiety over her move to a distant school, and fearing her reaction, Marnik waited a year before revealing her choice. Mother and daughter have differing recollections of that conversation some 14 years ago. Ryan said she was mostly worried about the effect of so many injections at once. Marnik remembers her mother raising her voice in anger.

Marnik enrolled in a PhD program offered by Tufts University but based at the Jackson Laboratory in Bar Harbor, Maine, where she studied autoimmune disease in mice and published three research papers. By the time she started as a postdoctoral researcher at another Bar Harbor institution, the MDI Biological Laboratory, she knew she wouldn't pursue the typical next step — setting up her own lab. Much as she loved doing science, Marnik found herself most drawn to teaching people about it.

She invited fourth-graders to her lab and developed a summer program that brought high school students to Mount Desert Island to learn about research. Eventually, she became the MDI lab's director of science education and outreach.

Her mentors came to accept her decision to abandon re-

search. "I realized at one point that she's doing something a lot bigger than I'm capable of doing and really making the science relevant in ways that most of us scientists can't do," said Dustin Updike, her adviser at MDI.

Breaking the information bubbles

Just how big her new chosen career would be became apparent in 2020, when the pandemic struck. "It was like my two worlds were colliding," Marnik said. "All of the people who were spreading misinformation about COVID-19 were people like my family that I had grown up with. . . . I felt a responsibility to kind of try to help navigate this moment."

She started posting on Facebook and Instagram as "@ScienceWhizLiz" and contributed to Those Nerdy Girls, a group of women and nonbinary people who provide health information online. (Marnik is now their chief scientific officer.) Through that group, she became acquainted with Katelyn Jetelina, who founded the Your Local Epidemiologist newsletter that clarifies the latest health issues for the public.

In 2025, Your Local Epidemiologist spawned The Evidence Collective, and Marnik was hired as executive director this year. The collective produces briefs on current scientific topics — such as the hantavirus and changes to the vaccine schedule — to speed the dissemination of accurate information by science communicators and journalists. It also holds in-person meetings with online content creators who have lay followers, seeking to "break echo chambers" in which scientists are reading each other's posts but not reaching beyond.

In one daylong meeting last year, Marnik convened "mom scientists" with "mom influencers" to teach the influencers how to talk about science and public health and bring those ideas to a wider audience.

In another, she had scientists team up with religious leaders to help them share public health concepts that align with their faith values. They developed a pamphlet on faith-based messaging to encourage measles vaccination.

"People who have faith don't always see that it conflicts with science," Marnik said. "It's scientists who tend to feel like you can't do both." But if science is portrayed as a pursuit only for those who leave their faith, she cautioned, that makes it harder for religious people to engage with it.

For her part, Marnik did leave the faith that was once the mainstay of her life. She considers herself agnostic. But she misses the embrace of a church community, and she and her family have started attending a United Church of Christ congregation.

Recently, Marnik published two op-eds that drew some harsh reactions from people who support vaccines.

In the Globe, she wrote that were it not for the religious exemption to school vaccination requirements (since eliminated in Connecticut), she would never have been able to attend a

public high school and take the chemistry course that sparked her love of science and changed her life. Her experience, she wrote, illustrates the trade-offs inherent in vaccine requirements. She doesn't oppose such mandates but argues that they must be accompanied by the "slower, harder" work of understanding and addressing the reasons people avoid vaccines.

In The New York Times, she described growing up unvaccinated and later coming to understand that her mother only wanted to protect her children.

One commenter in the Times wrote: "I have zero empathy or compassion for those whose myopic worldviews endanger those most vulnerable to communicable diseases." Another declared: "I would have charged your Mom with Child endangerment."

These critiques assume that people rejecting vaccines have access to good information about them, but that's not always the case, Marnik said. "My mom only ever finished eighth grade," she said. "The one person she asked questions to wouldn't answer them, and then we didn't have the privilege to be able to go to another provider."

Being empathetic and talking to people doesn't amount to condoning their behavior, Marnik added. You can have empathy, she said, and still require people to get vaccinated if they want to attend school, work in health care, or join the military.

Marnik's views are widely shared among public health communicators.

"She is a great voice for reason in a space that's very emotionalized," said Stefanie Friedhoff, cofounder and director of Brown University's Information Futures Lab. "She tells her own story. She doesn't claim it's true for everybody. And she brings evidence to the table."

Dorit Reiss, professor of law at the University of California San Francisco, said that reasonable, thoughtful, caring parents can be sucked in by vaccine disinformation. "Antivaccine groups are very good at packaging what they're saying in convincing ways," said Reiss, whose research focuses on vaccine policy. "Often I think that there but for the grace of God go I in the sense that I can see myself falling for it."

Reich, the Colorado sociologist, says that many families "feel alone" in figuring out how to keep their children safe, and very few see the vaccine question as "one and done." Perhaps, she said, some families can be persuaded to accept at least the vaccines for the most dangerous and contagious illnesses.

‘A completely different person’

A couple of years after Marnik graduated college, her undergraduate adviser, Westcott, was visiting Bar Harbor and suggested they get together. "When she showed up, I didn't even recognize her," he recalled. "She was a completely different person."

She had lost 100 pounds. In Maine, where she was surrounded by outdoorsy types jogging and hiking, and had access to a free gym on campus and money

for healthy foods, Marnik had remade herself. She became an avid runner and has since run three marathons. "I couldn't have done those things if the lifestyle or if the situation around me hadn't changed," she said.

Marnik would later write about her physical transformation as another public health lesson drawn from her own life: Merely instructing people to eat good food and exercise won't make them healthy if their environment and finances don't allow such behaviors. Growing up, she wrote, "There was no gym, no running shoes that fit right, no new exercise clothes, no meal plans full of fresh or organic produce."

Now that she's married and living in Ellsworth, Maine, her children — Owen, 7, and Adelaide, 4 — have a better chance at health. They eat berries and apples they pick themselves. Her husband, Isaac Marnik, works with a nonprofit that provides after-school and summer programs for youngsters, and the family enjoys hiking and camping.

Her mother, Teresa Ryan, moved to Ellsworth several years ago. They see each other often, and mother and daughter seem to have buffed the edges of their disagreements. Because, despite all Marnik's work, Ryan hasn't changed her mind about vaccines.

On a recent Zoom call with Marnik at her side, Ryan said she fears the possible side effects more than any illness the vaccines would prevent. "Once you have that in your system, it's hard to do anything about it," she said. "It's just not good for you. It's the way I feel."

Asked how she felt when her grandson Owen received the full slate of childhood vaccines, Ryan said, "I was concerned maybe a little bit."

At those words Marnik broke into a knowing smile. "You were very concerned," she said, touching her mother's shoulder affectionately. "You've come a long way since then, but you definitely expressed some disagreement at the time."

When Marnik had her second child, she insisted that her mother either get vaccinated or wear a mask while holding the baby, who was too young for some of the childhood vaccines. Ryan chose the mask.

Ryan doesn't get the seasonal flu shot and has never been immunized against COVID-19. But she said she would take a shot if she were bit by a rabid animal or stepped on a rusty nail, and she has acknowledged the value of the measles vaccine, given the severity of the illness.

Marnik calls this "progress," the result of an ongoing conversation that she urges others to pursue.

At a panel discussion in June at the Huntington Theatre in Boston, Marnik explained that her own change of heart about vaccination occurred only after many talks with kind, attentive friends and professors over four years of college. "People tell me, 'I'm not going to engage with people that I disagree with because it's a waste of time,'" Marnik told the audience. "And then I ask them, 'Well, what did you do?' And they told me they had a 5- to 10-minute conversation, and they didn't change the person's mind. I'm like, 'It's not going to happen in a 5- to 10-minute conversation.'"

The theater had invited Marnik to moderate the event after a play about a school vaccine controversy. Striding across the stage, microphone in hand, she engaged the panelists, fielded questions from the audience, and told her personal story.

Marnik's lab mate from college, Radden, had joined her at an event at Yale earlier this year. He marvels that the person he knew as a shy science nerd today has the poise and nerve to navigate these public appearances. He used the same words as her former professor — she's "completely different."

But is she truly? What does it mean to become someone new?

Marnik took a moment to consider the question. "In some ways it feels like another life," she said of her upbringing. But then she added, "If it wasn't for that prior version of me, I wouldn't be the me that I am now, right? I wouldn't be doing the work that I am doing."

Start of deliberations expected today in Clancy murder trial

By Shelley Murphy,
Lea Skene,
and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

PLYMOUTH — Lindsay Clancy’s high-profile trial for the slayings of her three children will enter its final phase Thursday, as jurors are expected to begin deliberations after hearing closing arguments and instructions on the law related to murder, mental illness, and criminal responsibility.

“Rest up and be ready for tomorrow,” Plymouth Superior Judge William F. Sullivan told jurors Wednesday before excusing them for the day. They have now heard all of the evidence — 84 witnesses over 21 days of testimony — but must “keep an open mind” and not discuss the case, he told them, until they hear final arguments and his legal instructions.

During a conference Wednesday after jurors were

excused, Sullivan said he will allow an hour each for prosecutors and Clancy’s attorney to make their final pitch to the jury. Then he’ll instruct jurors on the law that applies in Clancy’s case and potential verdicts they may consider: guilty of first-degree murder, second-degree murder, or manslaughter for the slaying of each child; or not guilty by reason of a lack of criminal responsibility due to a mental disease that made her

incapable of appreciating the wrongfulness of her actions or obeying the law.

Six members of the 18-member panel will be randomly selected as alternates, then the remaining 12 will begin deliberations and decide Clancy’s fate.

Clancy, 36, has admitted that she strangled 5-year-old Cora, 3-year-old Dawson, and 8-month-old Callan with exercise bands in the basement of their Duxbury home on Jan. 24,

2023. But she has pleaded not guilty to three counts of first-degree murder, asserting an insanity defense. She alleges that she suffered a postpartum psychotic break and heard a man’s voice telling her to kill the children and herself.

She slashed her wrists and neck, then jumped out a second-story window after the slayings, damaging her spinal cord. She is paralyzed from the waist down and appears in

court each day in a wheelchair.

Prosecutors allege the slayings were premeditated by Clancy, who was depressed and overwhelmed after the birth of her third child. They assert that she was tired of her life, and decided to kill herself and take the children with her because she didn’t trust anyone else to care for them.

The last two weeks of the trial have focused on Clancy’s de-
CLANCY, Page B4



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

At Salemwood School in Malden, students, parents, and teachers lined up early Wednesday morning to return and kick off the new school year.

Slipping on backpacks, as summer slips away

Calendar quirk makes the first wave of students returning to school feel especially early

By Marcela Rodrigues and John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF
and Audrey Tomlin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

MALDEN — Children clutching bright lunch boxes swarmed Salemwood School for the return to classes Wednesday, marking the end of summer with goodbyes to parents as they snaked into the building wearing crisp new sneakers and glittering backpacks.

Parents remained outside, catching up with each other and balancing younger siblings on their hips who were not old enough for school.

“Yes, a little strict,” one teacher reassured a parent about another school employee, “but she’s also very nice.”

A yellow school bus stopped at the curb, and a girl pressed her face up against the window, peering out at the scene.

“I’m a bit excited, but also nervous at the same time,” said Leanne Cooper, 10. “I’m excited to learn about my teachers and make some new friends, maybe. But nervous cause I don’t know the people, and it’s a bigger place, I think.”

Cooper is entering fifth grade, which at Salemwood is considered the first year of middle school, explained her mother, Erin Manley, 40.

“Last year, she was the big fish of the school,” Manley said. “Now, she’s back to being the small fish.”

From Holyoke to Plymouth, the back-to-school season kicked off this week as thousands of Bay State students returned to classes. Massachusetts does not dictate when schools must return to session, so thou-



Phuong Le adjusted the ponytail of her daughter, Lydia Tran, before she walked into school.

sands of children still have a week or two left of summer.

A calendar quirk has made this first wave feel especially early. With Labor Day falling on its latest possible date, Sept. 7, the return to school Wednesday in towns such as Milton and Amherst came nearly two weeks before the three-day weekend that marks summer’s psychological end.

Despite grumbles, students still arrived full of excitement and nervousness as they entered new grades and met their new teachers in scores of schools across

CLASSES, Page B3

Healey slams Trump’s proposed Head Start changes

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey criticized the Trump administration’s proposal to scale back regulations for the federally funded Head Start child-care program, calling it “reckless and wrong-headed” on Wednesday.

The rollback would result in more children being turned away from free child care, she said, as well as less well-trained teachers and a reduction in medical screenings, mental health services, and other support for low-income families.

“This is an attack on families and kids,” she said during a press conference after touring the ABCD Head Start center in Malden Wednesday with other elected officials and early education advocates. “This seems to be all part of Donald Trump’s plan to destroy education in this country.”

The proposed changes would do away with previous requirements on class size, health and developmental screenings, and home visits. Bilingual instruction would be eliminated outside

HEAD START, Page B3

Lawmaker arrested on relief fraud

Accused of taking federal funds

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

For the second time this month, a public official representing Lawrence strode out of federal court after an arrest for pandemic relief fraud.

On Wednesday, it was state Representative Francisco Paulino, a Democrat whose district includes parts of Lawrence and Methuen. He had been arrested that morning after a grand jury indicted him on charges that he used an assortment of schemes

to steal more than \$700,000 in federal funds, which he spent on his campaign and real estate.

Two weeks earlier, Lawrence Mayor Brian A. DePeña was accused of stealing more than \$1.5 million for campaign purposes, as well as for clearing personal and tax debts. On Wednesday, his case advanced after the grand jury indicted him, though he did not have a court date that day.

It’s not exactly clear how the two cases are directly connected, if at all. US Attorney Leah Foley said the arrests are not part of an enforcement effort specifically targeting the Merrimack Valley — which has had major corrup-

tion cases over the years — but rather part of the office’s push to catch fraudsters using pandemic relief dollars.

“They’ve stolen from all of us,” she said in a press conference Wednesday morning. The connective tissue, she said, is that these are “two greedy individuals who lied and stole for their own personal benefit.”

Paulino, 46, of Methuen, is charged with eight counts of aiding and abetting wire fraud and three counts of aiding and abetting money laundering. The government is seeking to seize some of his assets.

PAULINO, Page B5



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

AN OFFICER’S FAREWELL —

Pallbearers carried the casket of Worcester police officer Kurt Solomon into Our Lady of the Angels Church. Solomon was found dead last week; police suspect his wife killed him before taking her own life. **B2.**

Calendar wrinkle brings early school start

►CLASSES
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Chelsea, Bellingham, and Berlin-Boylston.

Many schools start classes before Labor Day to ensure students have enough days, accounting for potential weather or health emergencies. By starting in late August, they can often wrap up the academic year by early June.

“New England winters are unpredictable, and having extra days built into the schedule helps prevent snow cancellations from pushing the end of the school year into late June,” said Plymouth Public Schools Superintendent Christopher Campbell.

Another wave of districts start classes on Aug. 31, while the vast majority start in September. Boston Public School students will not return to classrooms until Sept. 8.

No matter when students start, all Massachusetts districts are mandated to have at least 180 days of school. Each district has control over its own calendar and can make its own decisions regarding the first day of school, as long as they include the mandated number of days in the district calendar.

During those 180 days, elementary school students must have at least 900 hours of structured learning time, which the state defines as classroom time with a teacher present. High schoolers must learn for at least 990 hours.

Like a new school calendar, this year will bring changes. Some districts have updated and established new technology policies, including cell phone bans and guidance on artificial intelligence.

“We plan on being very intentional about our use of technology this year,” said Steven C. Meyer.



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Linh Tran stood with his daughter, Lydia Tran, as student Marlie Guerrier (below, in pink) was joined by her sister, Isabelle Paul-Malique, and mother, Natalie Clerger-Guerrier.

er, Clinton Public Schools superintendent. “We are implementing a bell-to-bell cell phone ban.”

Clinton schools are adopting a new software that blocks social media and gaming applications on all student devices during class, while allowing access to school-approved sites. Other districts using the same software include Watertown and Fitchburg.

Most districts across the state are facing fiscal concerns, following drops in enrollment, reduced federal aid, and other financial pressures.

“With extraordinary budget cuts last year coupled with a sharp decline in student enrollment, we are focused on doubling down on our instructional goals,” said Robert Tremblay, Framingham Public Schools superintendent.

Many school districts, including Chelsea and Natick, held professional development days Monday and Tuesday as teachers prepared to welcome students early Wednesday.

“Our staff have spent these opening days preparing their classrooms, reconnecting as teams, learning together, and thinking carefully about the experiences we want our students to have this year,” said Melissa Spash, Natick Public Schools superintendent.



ties this year is fostering feelings of belonging and well-being.”

In Malden, Superintendent Timothy Sippel said the city is in the first year of a new strategic plan, which focuses on professional development for educators to help meet students’ needs, particularly children who are learning English as a second language, and those with disabilities.

Outside Salemwood School, Natalie Clerger-Guerrier clutched an iPad as her daughter, sixth-grader Isabelle Paul-Malique, 11, peered at the screen and waved. On the iPad, Paul-Malique’s father waved back.

Clerger-Guerrier’s greatest concern as a parent is whether her daughters will be safe at school.

“There’s a lot of stuff happening,” Clerger-Guerrier said. “People are going through a lot of mental health crises. So I hope they’re protected and safe.”

*Audrey Tomlin can be reached at audrey.tomlin@globe.com.
Marcela Rodrigues can be reached at marcela.rodrigues@globe.com.
John Hilliard can be reached at john.hilliard@globe.com or on Signal at [john_hilliard.70](tel:708.708.708).
Follow him on Bluesky at [iamjohnhilliard.bsky.social](https://bsky.app/profile/iamjohnhilliard.bsky.social).*

Watchdog alleges Boston’s schools wasted \$900k

►AUDIT
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of sole-source contracts,” the statement said.

The goal, according to the statement, is, “ensure that our students and schools are getting what they need at the best value for families and taxpayers.” The Wu administration will review the report’s findings and will develop a plan “to fully implement the recommendations,” the statement said.

Boston Public Schools is the city’s largest department with 11,000 workers and \$1.6 billion budget. The schools allocated more than \$81 million to “contracts & other non personnel” expenses that year, according to the report.

The inspector general began its investigation after receiving multiple complaints about how vendors were paid and excessive shipping charges on a sole-source contract for books.

From 2018 to 2024, Boston paid additional fees to five contractors to serve as a “passthrough” to other vendors for unrelated services, rather than paying them directly, the report said.

Those costs added up. The city paid nearly \$620,000 worth of invoices this way, and paid more than \$77,000 in markup costs to facilitate the payments, the report said.

Officials used this system to pay vendors who didn’t have a written agreements with the city. In other cases, vendors had already been paid the maximum agreed-to amount under their contract, but had performed more work at the city’s request.

Former Boston schools employees told the inspector general they felt they had little choice but to use “passthrough” invoices in order to make the payments.

“The resulting conduct was, at minimum, an improper use of public contracts and in some instances was likely a violation of municipal finance law,” the inspector general said.

Boston also failed to follow state law by entering into written contracts with some vendors for services in excess of \$10,000, the report said.

In one case, Boston issued a “sham” procurement order in 2023 for water quality testing kits to pay money due to a contractor. The company, Envirotrac, was owed \$31,000, which included \$11,000 intended as a passthrough payment to another vendor, Helco, according to the report. Envirotrac was awarded the contract after submitting a \$38,000 bid.

The procurement order, which was created by a Boston employee and workers from Envirotrac and Helco, did not mention that the city already had the water testing kits, the report said.

Creating the bogus procurement order violated state law, according to the inspector general.

Boston also ignored its own residency requirement for employees by arranging for a worker who moved out of state to serve as a contractor for an existing vendor, the report said. The former Boston worker then took on duties consistent with their previous job with the school department.

In exchange, the vendor received a \$13,000 payment for the arrangement, which may have violated state labor and tax laws, the inspector general said.

John R. Element of the Globe staff contributed to this report. John Hilliard can be reached at john.hilliard@globe.com or on Signal at [john_hilliard.70](tel:708.708.708).

Healey: Head Start plan ‘an attack on families and kids’

►HEAD START
Continued from Page B1

of Indigenous communities, program hours could be shortened, and teaching standards for literacy, math, and social and emotional development would be dropped.

Head Start facilities would have to comply with state rules, but there are few comparable state-level requirements, raising concerns that quality will suffer and fewer services will be offered to some of the country’s most vulnerable families.

The federal Administration for Children and Families said the proposed rule changes would remove regulations that go beyond what the Head Start Act requires and give local providers more latitude.

The program would continue to require hearing and vision screenings, family support for health, nutrition, and English proficiency, and other federally mandated provisions.

“By removing hyper-specific directives on how to meet these requirements gives recipients more flexibility to design comprehensive services best suited to their community’s needs,” the agency said in a statement.

Eliminating “one-sized-fits-all federal mandates” could save as much as \$2.2 billion a year and create 236,000 new slots, it said.

“They are willing to risk our kids in order to continue to fund the very wealthiest Americans,” said Representative Katherine Clark, who was also at the Malden Head Start Wednesday. “This is about weakening and watering down a program that serves hundreds of thousands of families across the country every day . . . to free up money for billionaires.”

The administration had previously tried to freeze funding for Head Start, noting in a White House budget document reviewed by The New York Times that it would help end the “radical indoctrination of our children” in a program “rid-

dled with social-emotional learning.”

In June, a report by the Heritage Foundation, a conservative think tank that has advised the Trump administration on past policies, called for the administration to “sunset Head Start and deregulate the program until officials end it.”

Massachusetts receives \$190 million a year to serve about 10,000 children, in addition to \$20 million supplemented by the state each year to boost worker wages, said Michelle

‘They are willing to risk our kids in order to continue to fund the very wealthiest Americans.’

REPRESENTATIVE KATHERINE CLARK, about President Trump’s proposed changes to the Head Start program

Haimowitz, executive director of the Massachusetts Head Start Association.

This would have a definite impact at the Head Start program in Malden, which has 13 teachers and 10 support staff serving 110 children, said director Georgette Chiasson. The state’s strict student-teacher ratios would protect instructors, she said, but the number of support staff who meet with families and provide health support and other services would have to be cut.

Massachusetts has some of the highest standards for health and safety, said Amy Kershaw, the state’s Early Education and Care commissioner, but Head Start regulations go beyond what the state requires.

“Our health and safety standards can’t replace what the federal government is trying to

take away,” she said.

The state has tried to make up for previous federal cuts to food programs and health care, but it can’t cover everything, Healey said.

“It’s hard with the mounting challenges and the cuts coming out of the Trump administration and Republicans in Congress,” she said.

The comment period for the proposed changes to Head Start lasts until Oct. 6, and Healey urged community members to reach out to the White House to advocate for the program.

Carmen Rondash, a single parent with four children, relied on the Head Start program in Charlestown for help with child care, early-intervention checks, and other resources his family needed.

“It’s a really important tool for people like me to change our lives, to empower us, and to let us build ourselves,” said Rondash, who is now on the board of directors for ABCD, one of 28 organizations in the state that administers Head Start programs.

Research has shown that Head Start increases the likelihood that children will graduate from high school and attend college, but it provides much more than early childhood education, said Sharon Scott-Chandler, president of ABCD.

“A child cannot learn when they are hungry,” she said.

“A parent cannot always focus on their child’s education when they are worried about health care, housing, food, and their child’s development.”

“The education and wellbeing of our most vulnerable children are key to the success of Massachusetts.”

This story was produced by the Globe’s Money, Power, Inequality team, which covers the racial wealth gap in Greater Boston.

Katie Johnston can be reached at katie.johnston@globe.com. Follow her @[ktkjohnston](https://twitter.com/ktkjohnston).

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Deliberations expected to begin in Clancy trial

►CLANCY
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teriorating postpartum mental health in the months before the slayings and whether she suffered a psychotic break. Jurors heard from prosecution and defense experts who offered different opinions about her claim that she had a “command hallucination,” a male voice telling her to kill her children and herself, and was unable to control her actions.

On Wednesday, the prosecution’s final witness, forensic psychologist Gregory Saathoff, testified during his second day on the stand that in his opinion Clancy suffered from Bipolar II disorder, but “did have the capacity to appreciate right from wrong” and should be held criminally responsible for killing her children.

Throughout the day of the slayings, Clancy was “methodical and quite controlled,” said Saathoff, noting that she took her daughter for a checkup with her pediatrician, built a snowman with her children, and texted photos of the children to her husband and mother.

Saathoff, a senior psychiatrist for the FBI’s behavioral analysis unit, said a significant amount of planning went into the killings.

Clancy strangled the children after sending her then-husband, Patrick, out to pick up medicine at a nearby pharmacy for their daughter and takeout for dinner at a restaurant in neighboring Plymouth.

And when Lindsay Clancy missed a phone call from her husband while he was at the pharmacy, she “had the presence of mind” to call him back and conceal from him what she was doing, Saathoff told jurors.

“She did not report to him that she was in distress, that she was having hallucinations, that she needed help,” Saathoff said.

Clancy’s attorney, Kevin Reddington, challenged Saathoff’s findings during cross-examination, focusing on the fact that he didn’t evaluate Clancy until May and June of this year and never met her in person at Tewksbury Hospital, where she has been receiving treatment for more than three years for bipolar disorder. Saathoff acknowledged his interviews with Clancy were conducted via Zoom.

Saathoff acknowledged that part of his evaluation was trying to determine whether Clancy



POOL PHOTOS BY GREG DERR/ THE PATRIOT LEDGER



Defense attorney Kevin Reddington (top) questioned Dr. Gregory Saathoff, a witness for the prosecution, in the Lindsay Clancy murder trial at Plymouth Superior Court Wednesday. (Above), courtroom observers followed the proceedings, as did Clancy (right).

cy was lying about experiencing “command hallucinations,” a male voice that was telling her to kill her children and herself. He testified earlier that Clancy’s claim that she only heard the voice once during the 18 minutes she was killing her children was highly unusual.

But when pressed by Reddington, he acknowledged that Dr. Phillip Resnick, a forensic psychiatrist with expertise in

postpartum conditions who testified for the defense, is a renowned expert on malingering, or faking.

He said Resnick’s opinion was that Clancy was not lying in any way.

Reddington asked Saathoff if he believes Clancy manipulated providers while seeking treatment for her mental health issues and “made the selfish choice” to kill her children be-



fore taking her own life, reading a transcript from a prosecutor’s opening statement at the trial.

“I think that statement . . . really minimizes what she was going through,” Saathoff said.

Shelley Murphy can be reached at shelley.murphy@globe.com. Follow her @shelleymurph. Lea Skene can be reached at lea.skene@globe.com. Follow her on X @lea_skene. Travis Andersen can be reached at travis.andersen@globe.com.

Decades after abuse, R.I. altar boys speak out

►ABUSE
Continued from Page A1

He was around 10 years old, his brother was 13, and their friends were between 9 and 11 when the abuse began. They remembered how, at the cabin, the priest insisted on giving each of them sponge baths, during which he fondled their genitals, they said in a newly filed lawsuit against the diocese. How he crawled into bed with them at night and felt their bodies.

The report made them realize that other boys had similar experiences at Virgin Wood. They also realized the diocese had known for years that Ventre was dangerous.

The five men, now in their 60s, allege in their lawsuit, filed in Providence County Superior Court, that the diocese and the parish violated their trust, “robbed [them] of their childhood and left them with a lifetime of struggle.”

They are among 70 alleged survivors of clergy sexual abuse in Rhode Island being represented by the Grant & Eisenhower law firm in lawsuits being filed in Rhode Island state court and federal court, said lawyer Steven Kelly.

“There’s a degree of shame. There’s a degree of fear that they’re going to be alienated from family members. They all feel guilty. They all feel like that they let these other boys down, because this continued for a long time,” Kelly said.

Their lawsuit is one of dozens that have been filed since July 1 under Rhode Island’s new law granting a two-year window for alleged victims of child sexual abuse to sue the institutions

that enabled the abuse years ago. The diocese has not yet responded to any of the lawsuits.

Neronha has said the true scope of abuse was likely greater than the investigators knew, and there were probably survivors who had never come forward. That was the case with these five men from Prospect Heights.

According to the attorney general’s report, Ventre was re-

The report made them realize that other boys had similar experiences at Virgin Wood and that the diocese knew Ventre was dangerous.

ported to have sexually abused six boys and a man with mental disabilities, including some at the Virgin Wood cottage, going back to 1973.

The diocese was alerted repeatedly about Ventre, including in a psychological assessment from the St. Luke Institute, in Silver Spring, Md., where he was sent for “rehabilitation.” But the attorney general’s report said neither Bishop Louis Gelineau nor his successor, Bishop Robert Mulvee, did anything to prevent Ventre’s access to children.

Ventre spent 40 years as a priest, bouncing from parish to parish until 1985, when he was charged with molesting three boys he’d met at Our Lady of

Good Help in Burrillville, R.I. But during a bench trial, a judge dismissed two of the charges and found Ventre not guilty of molesting the third boy, who was mentally disabled.

Gelineau assigned Ventre to the VA hospital in Providence and the Fatima Unit at St. Joseph’s Hospital in North Providence. Soon, there were more complaints about his behavior with boys.

In 1994, according to the attorney general’s report, the vicar for social ministry reported to Gelineau that Ventre “has obvious problems.”

“He does not think it unusual or problematical [sic] to bathe youths [sic] and young adults, nor to share his bed with two persons (youthes and young adults) when another bed is available,” the vicar wrote to the bishop, according to the attorney general’s report. “He never admits having a proclivity for men and boys. Activities to date are not criminal, but close to it (possible 2nd degree sexual assault). His victims are all somewhat emotionally deprived. He is manipulative of them.”

The vicar was concerned the diocese could be sued for damages. Two diocesan advisory boards unanimously found Ventre posed an “extreme risk and public relations nightmare.” The director of the Diocese Office of Education and Compliance wrote that Ventre had crossed professional boundaries numerous times.

Yet, Ventre continued to work at the hospitals and have access to children.

When Ventre retired in December 1999, then-Bishop Mulvee sent him a letter, expressing

“our sense of indebtedness to you for the wonderful work you have done.” Ventre died later that month.

Eight years later, in 2007, a former student from St. Raphael Academy in Pawtucket told the diocese that he’d been abused by Ventre at the cottage in 1977, according to the attorney general’s report. The diocese had been told about the abuse at the time by the boy’s uncle, a Jesuit priest, to no avail.

The diocese’s compliance director told the former student that the sponge baths and sleeping arrangements didn’t sound like abuse to him.

But after an arbitration session in August 2008 with three of Ventre’s alleged victims, the diocese was ordered to pay \$50,000 to one of the victims, a man who said Ventre had molested him at the cabin, starting in 1973 when he was 8, according to the attorney general’s report. The outcome of the other two cases was unknown.

Of the five former altar boys who filed the lawsuit against the diocese, John Doe 1 spent the most time at Ventre’s cabin.

“For a kid in the projects, it was golden. It had everything,” the man said. “A log cabin on the lake, fishing, boating, swimming, ice skating, basketball, fire pit — it was a kid’s dream.”

But the long-term effects of the abuse have been devastating. He started using drugs and alcohol at a young age. He joined the military at 17, getting far away from Pawtucket, but struggled with authority. His wife threw him out in 2007, he said in an interview, sick of his drug and alcohol abuse and instability.

He sought counseling and rehabilitation, and came to realize he’d been trying to bury the memories of abuse. He got sober. He and his wife reconciled. He kept a steady job, joined a nondenominational church, became a mentor in a ministry program for boys, and, eventually, reunited with his old friends from Prospect Heights.

He still feels guilty for the abuse his brother and their friends endured. “If I had not invited them, nothing would have happened to them,” he said.

Patrick Wall, a former Benedictine priest and canon lawyer at the law firm, said Ventre’s abuse affected the five altar boys differently.

“It can be the same perpetrator. They were sometimes accessed in a similar way, but . . . how it affected them was completely different,” Wall said. “The other thing is, perpetrators change what I call their perversity level over time. If as long as they don’t rise to that scandal level where they’re publicly known, they just kept on rolling.”

In an interview, John Doe 1 urged others to speak up.

“If something happened to you that you didn’t think was right as a kid, it’s not your fault. You’re innocent. They were supposed to be trustworthy, especially as supposedly God’s representative,” he said. “You need to come forward and say something to help prevent other kids from going through this in the future.”

Amanda Milkovits can be reached at amanda.milkovits@globe.com. Follow her @AmandaMilkovits.

Man pleads not guilty in boat crash case

Faces charges for woman’s death

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF
and Ariela Lopez
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The parents of an Andover woman killed in a boat crash in Boston Harbor were in court Wednesday as the man charged in her death pleaded not guilty to involuntary manslaughter.

Nancy and Peter Dankert, whose daughter, Elizabeth A. Dankert, was killed in the May crash, sat quietly when Lawrence Shieh, 41, rose from the back of a Boston courtroom and walked to a microphone, where the list of charges he now faces were read aloud.

Shieh, who lives in Boston, stood looking downward with a stricken expression, his hands clasped in front of him. He leaned over to reach the microphone when asked to enter his plea.

“Not guilty,” he said each time in a barely audible voice.

The charges also include other offenses involving operating under the influence.

Shieh was allegedly drunk on May 13 when the boat he was operating struck a pier at Logan International Airport at 36 miles per hour, killing Dankert, 24, and injuring two of her friends.

Shieh, whose blood alcohol level registered at .20 after the crash, was also seriously injured.

He was handcuffed by court officers after bail was set at \$25,000 cash. His defense attorney, Nicholas Pisegna, said the one-time private equity executive would post bail.

His next court date is Oct. 8.

“This case is a tragedy,” Pisegna told reporters after the arraignment. “I think it would be insensitive to say anything other than our hearts go out to the family, the friends, and the three women that were involved in this accident.”

Before the crash, Shieh and two friends went to a series of restaurants and bars in the Seaport, Suffolk Assistant District Attorney Ashlee R. Mastrangelo said in court. Shieh drank “a combination of martinis, beers, and Mezcal” drinks at each stop, she said.

Around 9 p.m., Shieh left his friends and went to ReelHouse restaurant, where he kept drinking, Mastrangelo said. After about an hour, he approached Dankert and two of her college friends — women in their early 20s whom Shieh did not know — and offered to take them out on a boat.

Shieh did not own a boat but belonged to the Freedom Boat Club, prosecutors said. The club prohibits boating at night and has said it is cooperating with the investigation.

After leaving the bar, Shieh went to the nearby Fan Pier Marina, where the club’s vessels were docked, officials said. Using a key card prosecutors said he was not authorized to have, Shieh and the women entered the marina and boarded a Key West twin-engine boat belonging to the club.

Aboard the boat, Shieh gave each woman a turn to try steering the boat with him, Mastrangelo said. A video taken six seconds before the crash showed Shieh at the helm, his hands off the steering column, the prosecutor said.

Just after 11 p.m., GPS data from the vessel showed it was heading toward Logan Airport, Mastrangelo said. Shortly after, it struck a runway approach pier, causing the boat’s canopy to snap nearly in half, she said.

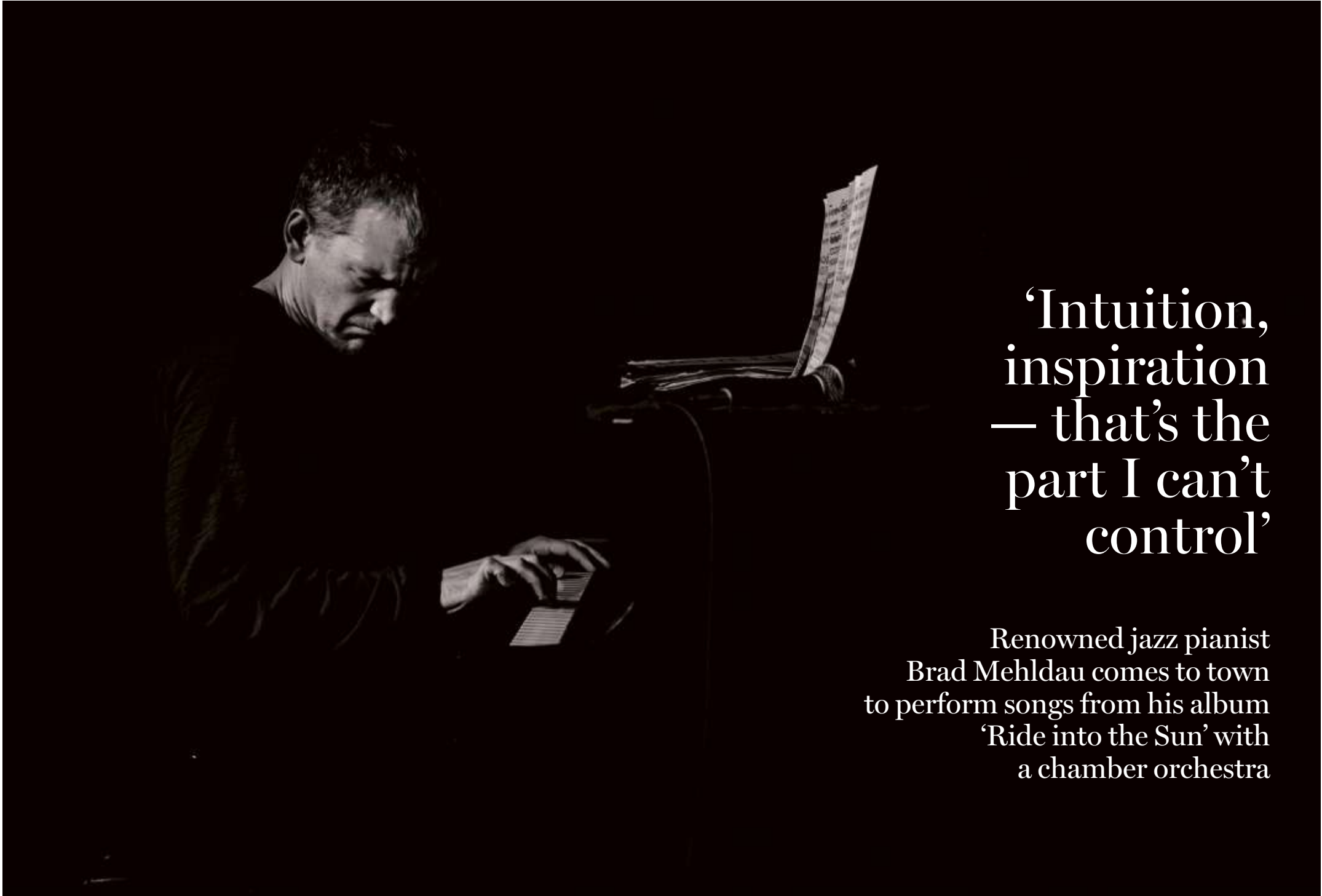
Dankert fell, hit her head on the back of the boat, and sustained a fracture to her skull. The other two women suffered multiple serious injuries, Mastrangelo said.

Michelle Menken, a lawyer for the Dankert family, confirmed that Dankert’s parents were in court but declined further comment.

The family members declined to speak to reporters and left the courtroom immediately after the hearing ended.

John R. Ellement can be reached at john.ellement@globe.com. Follow him @JREbosglobe. Ariela Lopez can be reached at ariela.lopez@globe.com. Follow her on X @ariela_lopez.

LivingArts



MICHAEL WILSON

Brad Mehldau is bringing a hand-picked band, including drummer Matt Chamberlain and mandolinist Chris Thile, to Groton. They will be joined by chamber orchestra A Far Cry.

By David Weininger
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The pianist Brad Mehldau has always been a musician of omnivorous tastes. Jazz and its various traditions are at the center of his artistry, but he long ago showed how innovative he can be in a wide swath of pop music. He’s taken songs by the Beach Boys, Radiohead, Massive Attack, the Beatles, and Sufjan Stevens (to name just a few) and cloaked them in luxurious, strange harmonies, teasing out their inner connections until they become something wholly new, and distinctly Mehldau’s.

His latest visit to this broad repertoire — which he’ll briefly bring to Boston — is with “Ride into the Sun” (Nonesuch), an album centered on Elliott Smith, the singer-songwriter whose beautifully haunted songs formed an essential strand of indie music from the mid-’90s through the early 2000s. Smith’s oeuvre has been enormously influential, especially in the years following his death in 2003.

Released last year, “Ride into the Sun” contains arrangements of 10 of Smith’s songs, along with four Mehldau originals and songs by Nick Drake and Big Star. While a few are

BRAD MEHLDAU
With A Far Cry
At Groton Hill Music Center,
Groton, Sept. 2, 8 p.m. Tickets: \$69.
grotonhill.org

played solo, most are arranged for a hand-picked band that includes drummer Matt Chamberlain and mandolinist Chris Thile. Some of Mehldau’s arrangements call for a chamber orchestra, giving the songs a fresh sense of light and energy.

Mehldau is taking the album on a brief tour, mostly in California. But he is making one stop in Boston, on Sept. 2 at the Groton Hill Music Center, for which he and the band will be joined by the Boston chamber orchestra A Far Cry, whose intrepid spirit aligns well with the project.

“Mehldau represents so much of the omnivorosity that we love to embed in our programming,” said Michael Unterman, a cellist in the A Far Cry ensemble. “His versatility with genre, the ability to span everything from baroque to rock music, being able to blend styles and make them his own — he shows us that we don’t have to stay in one lane but can

use the whole freeway.”

The origins of “Ride into the Sun” lie in Mehldau’s move in the mid-’90s from New York to Los Angeles, where he played with Smith a few times. “When I met Elliott, he was gentle, had a quiet sense of humor, and was a little shy,” Mehldau wrote in response to emailed questions. “His songwriting moved me right away because of the beautiful harmony and the way it linked with his melodies.”

Smith’s songs made an immediate impression. Mehldau began playing “Bottle Up and Explode!” soon after meeting him, and he’s incorporated others into his solo repertoire. But the catalyst for this record was more immediate and more personal. He said he felt ready to do the project only after emerging from what he called “a big depressive episode I had 5 years ago.”

Mehldau wrote an elaborate (and often harrowing) blog post on this episode and its links to Smith’s music on “Watching Rome Burn,” his Substack newsletter. In that post, he cited lyrics from Smith’s song “Tomorrow Tomorrow” that poignantly captured his own condition: “I got static in my head/ The reflected sound of

everything/ Tried to go to where it led/ But it didn’t lead to anything.”

The relentlessness of the “static” in Mehldau’s head led him through a journey of deep darkness, sadness, and even, for a time, hallucinations. “Like death over and over again,” as he put it.

While working — slowly, painfully — toward healing, Mehldau found in Smith’s songs a mixture of shadow and hope that showed a way out of darkness without denying its power. “The powerful, concentrated experience [Smith] found in his music transcended his depression, even as it included its dark hue,” Mehldau wrote on Substack.

In his email, Mehldau added that, when he had gotten beyond his depressive episode, “I found that there was a way I could fold my own experience into [Smith’s] music, and also make a testament to how Elliott’s music can be a healing force for people who suffer from that malady and other mental challenges.”

Asked about why he chose to add chamber orchestra to some of the arrangements, he pointed to Smith’s use of harmony, which he called “rich, and I would say, ‘righteous’ — it has a deeper kind of logic and

voice-leading that we get in a lot of rock’n’roll music, no matter how great that music is. It really invites you to flesh it out in a larger ensemble, because it has those ‘bones,’ so to speak.”

A listener familiar with Smith’s oeuvre might wonder about Mehldau’s choices. He includes “Between the Bars,” probably his best-known song, but omits familiar entries such as “Waltz No. 2 (XO)” and “Miss Misery” (the latter made famous in “Good Will Hunting”).

“Ultimately it comes down to whether I can find something to do with the songs,” he replied to a question about his selection of songs. “It’s not a reflection of the quality, or even the universality of Elliott’s music from song to song, but more if I find a way in that is not merely a cover and not much more.

“As to why and how some songs take hold into an arrangement and others don’t,” he continued, “that’s a mystery. Intuition, inspiration — that’s the part I can’t control.”

David Weininger can be reached at globeclassicalnotes@gmail.com. Follow him on Twitter @davidgweininger.

Hollywood Vampires to rock the Hub with documentary premiere

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

Hollywood Vampires will rock the Hub next month when a new documentary about the supergroup debuts at the 42nd annual Boston Film Festival.

Composed of Alice Cooper, Johnny Depp, Joe Perry, and Tommy Henriksen, the band is the subject of “Unleashed Spirits: The Rise of the Hollywood Vampires,” the latest music doc from Emmy-winning director and producer Daniel E. Catullo III. Medford native and former Extreme drummer turned artist manager Paul Geary also serves as an executive producer on the project, as does Ernie Boch Jr., the car magnate, philanthropist, and musician who’s a friend of the band. “Unleashed Spirits” will open the fest with its world premiere on Sept. 18 at the Boch Center Wang Theatre.

“This film documents a group of artists who are deep rooted in film and rock ‘n’ roll. It’s a peek behind a curtain that has never been opened,” Boch told the Globe in a statement. “The audience will feel like they’re sitting in their living room with Alice, Johnny, Joe, and Tommy. It’s an extraordinary cinematic experience.”

The festivities will include a red carpet prior to the film’s screening, with a Q&A session scheduled for afterward with Cooper, Perry, Henriksen, and Catullo. An opening night after-party is planned as well.

Robin Dawson, executive director of



HOLLYWOOD VAMPIRES

the Boston Film Festival, described “Unleashed Spirits” as “a great and outstanding piece” that she immediately knew “was the right film” for the coveted opening night slot following her first phone call with the team behind the documentary.

“I couldn’t be more excited about the kickoff of this year’s festival,” Dawson told the Globe in a phone interview on Monday.

The film chronicles the origins of Hollywood Vampires, which draws its name from a drinking club that Cooper and other big rock stars of that era would frequent in Hollywood. Paying

tribute to those days, Cooper, along with Depp and Aerosmith guitarist Joe Perry, formed the supergroup, which released its first album in 2015 and has gone on to become a popular touring act, and is currently playing shows across Europe. According to a press release, “Unleashed Spirits” explores “the band’s transformation from an improbable gathering of famous friends into a formidable live act capable of commanding some of the world’s biggest stages.”

Dawson praised the film for how it “captures the essence” of its stars, as well as for showcasing their vulnerabil-

ities, such as Perry’s recent health challenges.

“It’s not easy to let people see the inside vulnerabilities of each person, or just the inside of somebody’s personality and story,” Dawson said of Perry, adding that she’s excited to meet the legendary Boston rocker “and bring his story to his hometown.”

In addition to “Unleashed Spirits,” this year’s Boston Film Festival, which runs Sept. 17-21, will include a number of other star-studded events and special premieres with Q&A sessions.

A “Next Gen” panel will take place on Sept. 17 at Emerson College hosted

From left: Joe Perry, Alice Cooper, Johnny Depp, and Tommy Henriksen of Hollywood Vampires. Perry, Cooper, and Henriksen are scheduled to take part in a Q&A session after a screening of “Unleashed Spirits: The Rise of the Hollywood Vampires,” which opens the Boston Film Festival. An opening night after-party is planned as well.

by Warner Bros. Television Group, including a recording of the podcast “A Lot More” with Jonathon Buckley. The event is followed by a panel with “The Voice” showrunner/executive producer Audrey Morrissey and season 29 winner Alexia Jay. Prior to the fest’s start, Emerson will host a screening of the children’s movie “Bobo Saves Christmas” on Sept. 16, which stars Emerson alum and Medford native Maria Menounos.

Fans of “Adventure Time: Side Quests” will get to hear from creatives from the show, including Nate Cash, Victor Courtright, Keith Pakiz, and Matthew Yang, during a screening and discussion on Sept. 19 at the Massachusetts College of Art and Design.

Other notable screenings include the world premiere of the comedy “Bolio” on Sept. 19, featuring appearances by director Jim Issa and stars Gabriel Hogan and Emily Tarver. Also making its world premiere on Sept. 19 is “A Minor Time,” with the drama bringing director, writer, and star Tina Alexis Allen to town, along with cast members William Sadler, Chloe Guidry, and Judee Wales.

The closing night film is the religious mystery “Little Audrey” on Sept. 21, with director Michael Mailer and star Robert Wahlberg set to attend.

“There’s something for everybody,” said Dawson.

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Golf: LPGA FM Championship, 9 a.m., Golf
Golf: PGA Tour Championship, 11 a.m., ESPN; 1 p.m., Golf
Baseball: Dodgers-Braves, 7:15 p.m., FS1
NFL exhibition: Patriots-Browns, 8 p.m., Ch. 5, Amazon
Listings, C7

Sports

C

THE BOSTON GLOBE THURSDAY, AUGUST 27, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS



EXHIBITION GAME 3
PATRIOTS AT BROWNS

Thursday, 8 p.m., Ch. 5, Amazon

BEN VOLIN

ON FOOTBALL

Boutte
the latest
example
of a purge

FOXBOROUGH — The Patriots had legitimate reasons for trading Kayshon Boutte to the Texans on Monday, even though he was one of the Patriots’ best receivers this training camp, and they didn’t get much in return — just backup safety Jaylen Reed and a seventh-round pick in 2028.

Among them:

■ They had seven roster-quality receivers but could only keep six, and even that is stretching other positions thin.

■ Boutte is in the final year of his contract, and they determined that he wasn’t in their long-term plans.

■ Boutte’s career highs are 43 catches, 589 yards, and 6 touchdowns, and they view newcomers A.J. Brown and Romeo Doubs as upgrades.

■ Boutte doesn’t have Mack Hollins’s physicality, Kyle Williams’s speed, doesn’t play special teams, and isn’t a traditional slot receiver like DeMario Douglas and Efton Chism, a position that Josh McDaniels has always valued for his offense.

“Obviously, when we acquired Romeo and A.J., something had to give,” said Eliot Wolf, the Patriots’ executive vice president of player personnel. “And as you look to the game-day roster, there are maybe some situations where the opportunities for certain players wouldn’t be there.”

So they got something — a hard-hitting safety who at minimum can contribute on special teams — instead of having to release Boutte for nothing at Sunday’s roster deadline. The meager return is a reflection that the rest of the NFL knew Boutte was the Patriots’ odd man out, and he’s only a one-year rental for the Texans, who merely needed a replacement for the injured Jayden Higgins.

ON FOOTBALL, Page C2



LYNNE SLADKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Anthony Seigler tosses his bat after being called out on strikes and losing a challenge to end the sixth inning, stranding runners at the corners.

Miami finale is sloppy snoozer

By Peter Abraham

GLOBE STAFF

Marlins 4
Red Sox 0

MIAMI — The Red Sox have been a dynamic team for much of the summer. They looked like a sleepy one against the Marlins on Wednesday night.

Four Miami pitchers held the Sox

to five hits, all singles, in a 4-0 loss before a crowd of 17,472 at loanDepot Park.

By any measure, it was one of their worst games of the season on both sides of the ball.

The Sox committed a season-worst four errors, leading to two unearned runs. At the plate, they grounded into

18 outs, and Miami pitchers retired nine of the final 10 batters.

It was the first time the Sox were shut out since they were one-hit by Blue Jays All-Star Dylan Cease on July 25, and the first time they committed four errors since June 3, 2025, against the Angels.

“We had some sloppy play, obvi-

ously,” interim manager Chad Tracy said. “We didn’t score either, so that’s part of it as well.”

The Sox now trail the Yankees by 2½ games in the chase for the top wild card in the American League and home-field advantage in the first round of the postseason.

RED SOX, Page C4

Specter of
brain injuries
looms over
HS football

By Matt Porter

GLOBE STAFF

Football’s inherent danger was no small factor in making it America’s most beloved sport. It also threatens its future, particularly in the grassroots division.

As they return to the practice field this week after a sobering new report on football head trauma, Massachusetts’ high school coaches are trying to teach the game as safely as possible: by limiting contact in practices, teaching proper tackling fundamentals, and trying to ensure that teenage boys with potential brain injuries don’t try to tough it out.

“Most coaches understand, if you want to have a team left at the end of the year, you have to do the right things,” said Xaverian coach Al Fornaro, whose team is hoping to win its fourth consecutive Division 1 championship.

“Everybody likes to win football games. But if we’re not protecting young people and helping them in other avenues in life, what are we doing?”

In Massachusetts, football signups are down 17 percent in the last 15 years, compared to 7 percent nationally. Coaches point to parental fear of injury, competition from prep and private schools, and single-sport specialization as major factors.

Nearly every football play begins with a violent confrontation at the line of scrimmage and ends

CONCUSSIONS, Page C7



CALEB BOWLIN/GETTY IMAGES

Roger Federer’s Hall of Fame résumé includes 20 major titles and a career Grand Slam.

Federer’s elegant game
truly carried tennis forward

TARA SULLIVAN



To watch a great tennis match is to put your head on a swivel. To best appreciate the action, you have to track the ball, and that requires perpetually swinging your head from one side of the court to the other. To that end, television commentators routinely situate themselves smack in the center of the court. It’s the best and fairest way to call a match.

Once upon a time in Miami, Patrick McEnroe

decided to do something different. ESPN’s leading tennis voice had been in the booth for countless matches involving Roger Federer, but with time slowly creeping up on Federer’s career, McEnroe wanted to see the all-time great from a different angle. So he headed down to the court, took a seat, and turned his eyes one way only.

“I’ll never forget watching him that way,” McEnroe said in a recent telephone call. “Right after he served, his movement would be so quick and so aggressive. But then, he was completely calm. I just watched him, I didn’t even watch the ball, you know, like you normally do, going back and forth. It was just amazing to see his incredible speed and quickness.”

SULLIVAN, Page C4

LPGA’S FM CHAMPIONSHIP
AT TPC BOSTON IN NORTON

Round 1, Thursday, first tee time 7 a.m.

Big purse
available
to a field
full of stars

By Emma Healy

GLOBE STAFF

NORTON — Some of the world’s best golfers are in Massachusetts this week, drawn by one of the premier non-major events on the LPGA calendar.

With unrivaled player perks and the second-largest purse of any event outside the majors, the FM Championship sets the example of what it means to be a player-first tournament, resulting in the deepest field in the event’s three-year history.

This year’s FM Championship features 23 of the top 25-ranked players in the world — including No. 1 Nelly Korda — and 13 of this year’s 14 LPGA Tour winners.

The tournament runs Thursday through Sunday at TPC Boston, and the high level of competition is brought on by its sparkling reputation.

“The girls love coming to this event,” said Rockland native Megan Khang, who is an FM ambassador and is playing in her third FM Championship. “It’s a tournament that you don’t want to miss, so it’s really cool to see that a lot of the top players are coming.”

The purse of \$4.4 million — up from \$3.8 million in the tournament’s inaugural year in 2024 — is the sixth largest on this year’s LPGA Tour schedule, trailing only the JM Eagle LA Championship (\$4.75 million) among non-majors.

Players receive significant perks for their participation, including complimentary hotel rooms, flight vouchers,

FM CHAMPIONSHIP, Page C6

INSIDE

The long road home

Staring down four straight away from Gillette, Revolution must keep Gil and Harrison sharp. C6

Scheffler’s spotlight

World No. 1 is the center of attention as Tour Championship, and its monster purse, loom. C6

Pro football

What to watch vs. Browns

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — Ahead of the Patriots’ pre-season finale, let’s take a look at who’s up, who’s down, and whom to watch Thursday night at Huntington Bank Field in Cleveland . . .

Three up

Quarterback Behren Morton: The 24-year-old stole the show during the second preseason game, leading the offense on a game-winning drive and also moonlighting as the emergency punter. It seems plausible that Morton could serve as an emergency punter (and kicker) or factor as an option in trick-play scenarios. The Patriots still have to decide whether they want to dedicate a roster spot to a third-string quarterback — they didn’t last year — or risk exposing Morton to waivers.

Cornerback Kindle Vildor: When discussing players who stepped up Saturday night, Patriots coach Mike Vrabel started with the 28-year-old. On the Eagles’ first possession of the second quarter, Vildor made a diving interception of Andy Dalton, but a roughing-the-passer penalty on rookie edge rusher Gabe Jacas negated the play. Vildor remained active for the rest of the possession, breaking up two passes in the next three plays to help force a punt. The performance is the latest impressive showing from Vildor, whose aggressive and competitive style has popped in practice. He likely earned a spot on the roster.

Defensive tackle Leonard Taylor: One of the other players Vrabel mentioned was Taylor, who was able to pressure Tanner McKee and break up a fourth-down pass in the third quarter. Said Vrabel, “I thought Lenny T played well and factored and showed up.” The Patriots have Milton Williams, Christian Barmore, and Cory Durden as their interior core. At least two of Taylor, Joshua Farmer, Eric Gregory, Isaiah Iton, Jeremiah Pharms, and Casey Rogers will join them, plus DaQuan Jones made a recent visit. Taylor seems to have a strong chance. The run defense as a whole was an area of concern in Saturday’s game, so it will be worth watching how the unit responds.

Three down

Linebacker Chad Muma: It looked earlier this summer as though Muma had a chance of earn-



Wide receiver Efton Chism’s chances of sticking on the roster were vastly improved by the Patriots trading Kayshon Boutte.

ing the third spot in the linebacker rotation. Once preseason games started, however, he fell down the depth chart. Muma has struggled in both, missing four tackles, according to Pro Football Focus. He was on the field deep into the fourth quarter on Saturday, which doesn’t bode well for a more veteran player. K.J. Britt has taken better advantage of his opportunities, as have rookies Namdi Obiazor and Khalil Jacobs.

Offensive lineman James Hudson: Saturday was a poor outing from Hudson, who was flagged twice for holding and also allowed a sack of Tommy DeVito. The Patriots are dealing with depleted depth along the interior, but it doesn’t appear that Hudson is part of the solution. Now that they also are dealing with tackle Marcus Bryant’s ankle injury, do they consider kicking Hudson back outside to his natural position? (Hudson played tackle on both sides in college and has 19 NFL starts there.) It seems more likely he is released.

Running back TreVeyon Henderson: Henderson exited Monday’s practice early with an apparent ankle/foot injury and remained sidelined Tuesday. Its severity bears watching, but even if the injury is not serious, Henderson has rarely wowed during practice. Rhamondre Stevenson appears to be the top back in almost every situation. Henderson hasn’t played in any of the pre-season games, as expected, so Week 1 will be the first real opportunity to see how much his pass protection and field vision have improved.

Three to watch

Wide receiver Efton Chism: With Kayshon Boutte traded to the Texans, it looks as though Chism will stick around. Although the biggest beneficiary of the trade should be Kyle Williams, it also may have saved Chism’s roster spot. Chism was last year’s training camp darling but has had a quieter summer this time. Is there a bigger role in store this season? He often was a healthy scratch as a rookie last season, playing just 92 snaps on offense and 59 on special teams.

Edge rusher Gabe Jacas: After a month of practice, it’s clear why the Patriots drafted Jacas. He plays with power and tenacity. He approaches practice with the right attitude, expressing a willingness to learn. It’s also clear, though, that Jacas missed the spring program. He’s sometimes out of position and struggles to diagnose certain plays, particularly those involving the run. It will be interesting to see how he is used to start the season, given the need on the edge, and whether he can evolve beyond a situational pass rusher. Said outside linebackers coach Mike Smith, “You got a kid that’s big like him, that’s athletic like him, that’s meaner than a wet mule. And he loves football. I’m not going to say he’s going to be Jason Taylor or [Lawrence Taylor] or any of that stuff, but it’s going to be very hard for him to fail.”

Running back Lan Larison: The Patriots still have a decision to make for their third running back spot. Larison earned praise from Vrabel for his “gritty, tough performance” on Saturday, when he rushed for 33 yards on nine carries and caught three passes for 41 yards. Vrabel shouted out his fourth-down conversion in the third quarter, when Larison got hit behind the line of scrimmage and fought through contact to get the first down. Larison’s pass-catching and kickoff-returning ability are the crux of his case for a roster spot. His availability for Thursday’s game may be in jeopardy after he practiced Tuesday in a red, noncontact jersey. The other candidates include seventh-round pick Jam Miller, more of a between-the-tackles rusher; and Hassan Haskins, more of a veteran presence with special teams ability.

Nicole Yang can be reached at nicole.yang@globe.com. Follow her on X @nicolecyang.



Kayshon Boutte (right) was among a dwindling number of pre-Mike Vrabel players still here.

Boutte joins pre-Vrabel crew purged from team

►ON FOOTBALL
Continued from Page C1

In the bigger picture, though, Boutte’s unceremonious departure is part of a trend with the Mike Vrabel regime, which doesn’t seem to place much value on players drafted by Bill Belichick and Jerod Mayo.

It’s certainly common for new front offices to bring in familiar faces and turn over the roster, but Vrabel and Co. seem to have an outsized focus on “their guys” and not on those who predated them in Foxborough.

The Patriots have had an open checkbook for Vrabel’s former Titans — Harold Landry, Kevin Byard, Robert Spillane, and Brown, in addition to practically half the coaching staff. And they have had no problem awarding big money to total strangers Milton Williams, Carlton Davis, Alijah Vera-Tucker, Dre’Mont Jones, and Doubs in free agency.

But Vrabel doesn’t seem to have much use for the holdovers. The Patriots released or traded almost every captain last year, most of whom continued their careers with other teams. They dumped players

left and right, got rid of practically the entire 2024 draft class, and swapped out their kicker and long snapper just because.

We’re seeing it again this training camp. The negotiation with Christian Gonzalez, drafted in 2023 by Belichick, seems to be more arduous and stressful than it should be for a player considered the best cornerback in the NFL. The longer it drags on, the louder the message to Gonzalez: “*We don’t think you’re as good as you or the rest of the league thinks you are.*”

Now the Patriots have decided they are done with Boutte, a great find from the 2023 sixth round. Boutte should be the kind of player a team wants to extend — a late-round pick who blossoms into a legitimate playmaker and fan favorite. Not only was he the Patriots’ best deep threat the last two years, but receivers coach Todd Downing raved about Boutte’s professionalism, calling him “an example I will use for the rest of my career.”

Boutte certainly was not seventh on the wide receiver depth chart. In a vacuum, Williams should have been the one to go. But Vrabel’s front office drafted

Williams in the third round a year ago, so he stays, even though he often looks lost on the field. Boutte, drafted by Belichick, goes.

There are only a handful of holdovers they seem to value. One is Drake Maye — duh, Vrabel isn’t a dummy. Hunter Henry and Rhamondre Stevenson are two classic Patriots — steady, reliable veterans who don’t break the bank (and are probably still here because of McDaniels, not Vrabel). The Patriots are keeping Douglas, another Belichick pick from 2023, but he’s in the last year of his deal, and it seems only a matter of time before Chism (a Vrabel guy) passes Douglas on the depth chart. Vrabel also loves Marcus Jones and his reasonable contract, and has stuck with Christian Barmore, but probably only because his contract was fully guaranteed through this season.

Otherwise, for the few remaining players drafted by Belichick and Mayo, Vrabel has made it clear, regardless of skill level — don’t get too comfortable in Foxborough.

Ben Volin can be reached at ben.volin@globe.com.

Patriots in 2026

SEPT. 9 @SEA 8:20 p.m. NBC, Peacock	SEPT. 20 PIT 1 p.m. CBS	SEPT. 27 @JAX 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 4 @BUF 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 11 LV 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 18 NYJ 1 p.m. CBS	OCT. 22 @CHI 8:15 p.m. Ch. 5, Amazon	NOV. 1 @MIA 4:25 p.m. CBS	NOV. 8 GB 4:25 p.m. Fox	NOV. 15 @DET 9:30 a.m. Fox, Fox One	NOV. 29 @LAC 8:20 p.m. NBC, Peacock	DEC. 6 BUF 4:25 p.m. CBS	DEC. 10 MIN 8:15 p.m. Ch. 5, Amazon	DEC. 21 @KC 8:15 p.m. ABC, ESPN	DEC. 27 @NYJ 1 p.m. CBS	JAN. 3 DEN TBA	JAN. 10 MIA TBA
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NFL NOTEBOOK

League reiterates college returners ineligible this season

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Players who leave the NFL to return to college won’t be allowed to come back to the league this season. NFL executive **Troy Vincent** reiterated the longstanding policy at the league’s meetings Wednesday, saying players who go back to college will be ineligible to play in 2026 and would instead become a free agent for the 2027 season.

The Big 12 Conference on Wednesday followed the Southeastern and Big Ten conferences in banning players who were on NFL rosters from returning to college. Atlantic Coast conference leaders were also discussing the topic.

At least two players who signed with NFL teams as undrafted free agents this offseason were hoping to return to college and play at No. 11 LSU.

Tight end **Dae’Quan Wright** originally signed with Philadelphia as an undrafted free agent out of Mississippi following the draft. He was waived by the Eagles on Aug. 10 and claimed by Cleveland the following day. He spent about two weeks with the Browns without playing in an exhibition game before being waived on Monday. He cleared waivers Tuesday and now wants to go to LSU to play for his former Ole Miss coach **Lane Kiffin**.

Defensive lineman **Zxavian Harris**

signed with New Orleans in May as an undrafted free agent out of Ole Miss and participated in the offseason program. He was placed on the non-football injury list at the start of training camp in July and was waived Aug. 8.

Both players entered the NFL Draft because they had used up their four years of eligibility. The NCAA announced a rule change in June allowing players who began college in 2023 or later to have five years to play five years of sports in college.

That rule didn’t apply to Wright and Harris, who entered college in 2022, but they are among the players who have sued the NCAA, arguing they’re being deprived of education and potential NIL financial benefits by being excluded from the rule.

Pro Bowl officially history

Declaring “it’s OK to be the first league to walk away from a competitive all-star game,” the NFL announced the Pro Bowl is no more, ending an exhibition of the league’s top players that was held in some form almost every non-pandemic year since 1951.

The league said 88 players will still be named as Pro Bowlers and honored in Los Angeles after this season. Several flag football events also will take place



Dae’Quan Wright spent time this summer with both the Eagles and Browns, but was waived by both.

at that time.

“The Pro Bowl has always been about recognizing the players who distinguish themselves as the very best in the NFL,” NFL executive vice president **Peter O’Reilly** said in a statement. “A Pro Bowl selection will return to its original purpose, honoring the best of the best. We want that distinction to carry even greater meaning for the

players, their families, their clubs and our fans.”

Vincent said he heard from players that they “don’t want competitive play” after the playoffs.

Penalties emphasized

Players will face a one-game suspension this season if they accumulate three penalties in certain designated categories. The NFL and the NFLPA said in a statement that they have agreed to place a greater emphasis on five health and safety rules violations: the hip drop tackle, horse collar tackle, launching, hit on a defenseless player, and blindside block. NFL players voted on the changes at a Board of Player Representatives meeting Tuesday. Violations in those categories will carry forward into subsequent seasons but the league and union said all players will start the upcoming season with a clean slate . . . Also Wednesday, owners unanimously approved the \$9.612 billion sale of the Seahawks to **Vinod Khosla** and his family, and commissioner **Roger Goodell** said the league is looking into whether 49ers owner **Jed York** will be punished for violating the league’s personal conduct policy after he was caught in a prostitution sting in Ohio.

Report: Giants’ Austin out

Giants receiver **Calvin Austin** has a torn ACL in his right knee and is expected to miss the season, a person with knowledge of the injury told The Associated Press. **Darnell Mooney**, also signed as a free agent in March, took Austin’s spot with the first-team offense. No. 1 receiver **Malik Nabers**, who is coming off his own torn ACL and is trending toward playing Sept. 13 against Dallas, walked off the field before the final set of team drills Wednesday. Coach **John Harbaugh** said that “wasn’t part of the plan,” adding he would find out what happened . . . Chiefs quarterback **Patrick Mahomes** will not play in Kansas City’s preseason finale against the Seahawks on Friday night, the first time that the two-time MVP has gone through a full scheduled preseason without appearing in a game. Mahomes is making his comeback after tearing ligaments in his knee in December . . . Similarly, Broncos coach **Sean Payton** suggested **Bo Nix** will sit out Denver’s preseason finale Friday against the Vikings — Nix is coming off two surgeries on his right ankle. Falcons coach **Kevin Stefanski** said quarterback **Michael Penix Jr.**, who joined team drills for the first time on Monday, will not play at Miami.

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Baseball



LYNNE SLADKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Sonny Gray battled to allow just two runs on seven hits in five innings, but got zero support.

Red Sox go quietly in shutout loss to Miami

► **RED SOX**
Continued from Page C1

After a day off on Thursday in New York, the rivals start a four-game series on Friday night. The Sox left Miami happy to have won the series at least.

“They just beat us. No way around that,” said Sonny Gray, who allowed two runs over five innings to take the loss. “Hate to sound like [this] but to take two of three; Miami is a good team at home. They are. I think it was a good series for us overall.”

Righthander Ryan Gusto had been 0-6 with a 5.52 ERA in 20 games for Miami over the last two seasons. He pitched 5% scoreless innings for the long-awaited victory.

The Sox had their chances. They loaded the bases with two outs in the second inning, but Nick Sogard grounded back to the pitcher. Andruw Monasterio then grounded into a force with two runners on to end the third inning.

Gusto hit Monasterio with a pitch with two outs in the sixth. Jarren Duran followed with a single up the middle that sent



LYNNE SLADKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A Red Sox fan cheers Caleb Durbin for making a backhanded grab on Griffin Conine’s foul popup in the seventh inning.

AL wild card

	W	L	Pct.	GB
New York.....	75	57	.568	—
Boston	73	60	.549	—
Cleveland	68	66	.507	—
Texas	66	68	.493	2
Baltimore	65	68	.489	2½
Toronto	65	69	.485	3
Seattle	64	70	.478	4
Minnesota	64	70	.478	4
Detroit	62	71	.466	5½
Kansas City.....	59	75	.440	9
Athletics	53	81	.396	15
Los Angeles	52	82	.388	16

Monasterio to third.

Victor Vodnik, a name right out of a Tom Clancy novel, replaced Gusto and struck out Anthony Seigler looking at a slider.

Gray faced 11 batters, threw 42 pitches, and allowed two runs during a laborious first two innings.

Kyle Stowers led off the bottom of the first with a single. Griffin Conine followed with a grounder to first base for what should have been a double play.

Sogard, playing first base in place of a resting Willson Contreras, stepped on the bag for

one out, but his throw to second deflected off Stowers’s helmet and went into left field.

Stowers advanced to third and scored when Heriberto Hernández singled to left.

Otto Lopez singled to start the second inning and stole second. The throw from Connor Wong deflected off Lopez’s helmet into left-center. Ceddanne Rafaela made a strong throw to the plate, but Lopez was able to score.

Gray walked Joe Mack and allowed a single by Javier Sanoja with one out, but he struck out Stowers and Conine to end the inning.

Gray put eight runners on base over five innings and had two errors behind him. But he allowed only the two runs.

“I did OK,” Gray said. “It was just sloppy.”

The eighth inning was particularly ugly as errors by Wong and Sogard turned a potentially winnable game into a bigger mess.

Rookie Wyatt Olds got an out before Lopez singled. He stole second and went to third on another wild throw from Wong, who started his second consecutive game with Adley Rutschman out with a hyperextended right elbow.

Owen Caissie’s routine ground ball got through Sogard; Lopez scored, and Caissie hustled to second. Pinch runner Est-eury Ruiz scored on a single by Sanoja.

The Sox were 0 for 4 with runners in scoring position and left nine on base.

“We needed a two-out hit, and we couldn’t get it,” Tracy said.

Peter Abraham can be reached at peter.abraham@globe.com. Follow him on Bluesky at peteabeglobe.bsky.social.

RED SOX NOTEBOOK

‘Mickey Jones’ combo has provided some pop

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

MIAMI — The Red Sox have a new player on the roster who has been extraordinarily productive as the designated hitter since **Masataka Yoshida** went on the injured list on Aug. 16.

“Mickey Jones, he can really hit,” infielder **Nick Sogard** said.

Mickey Jones is Sogard’s amalgamation of **Mickey Gasper** and **Jahmai Jones**. And he’s right, that dude can really hit.

Gasper is a switch-hitter who is more productive against righthanders. Jones is a right-handed hitter who has crushed lefthanders since joining the Red Sox on July 14.

With Gasper doing the heavy lifting, they are 12 for 27 with nine extra-base hits and 12 RBIs in nine games since Yoshida strained his left hamstring on Aug. 15.

“The combo of that has been awesome,” interim manager **Chad Tracy** said Wednesday before a 4-0 loss to the Marlins.

Tuesday night’s 7-3, 11-inning victory was a great example of just how disciplined Tracy has been in exploiting matchups with his DHs.

Gasper was 2 for 2 with two home runs and two walks through eight innings, but Tracy pinch hit for him with Jones in the 11th inning against lefthander **Cade Gibson**. Jones drew a walk. Two batters later, **Jarren Duran** belted a grand slam, and the Sox were on their way to a fifth straight win.

“You have a good idea of what your players are, what they’re best at,” Tracy said. “As a manager, you’re trying to put players in the best possible situations to succeed.”

Gasper credited his surge to being more aggressive. He has tended to take too many pitches in his career and now goes to the plate using a two-strike approach.

“I just feel like I hunt the

Marlins 4, Red Sox 0

At loanDepot park, Miami										
	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
BOSTON										
Sogard 1b	4	0	0	0	0	1	.267			
Rafaela cf	4	0	0	0	0	1	.285			
Abreu rf	3	0	0	0	1	0	.252			
Durbin 3b	4	0	2	0	0	0	.256			
Gasper dh	3	0	0	0	1	0	.275			
Monasterio ss	2	0	1	0	1	0	.255			
Duran lf	3	0	1	0	0	0	.210			
EWhite ph	1	0	0	0	0	1	.240			
Seigler 2b	3	0	1	0	0	1	.252			
Jones ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.215			
Wong c	3	0	0	0	0	0	.246			
Totals	31	0	5	0	3	4				
MIAMI										
Stowers dh	3	1	1	0	2	2	.242			
Conine 1b	5	0	0	0	0	2	.253			
Hernández lf	4	0	2	1	0	1	.234			
Edwards 2b	4	0	1	0	0	0	.286			
Marsee cf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.211			
Lopez ss	4	2	2	0	0	0	.308			
Caissie rf	4	0	0	0	0	0	.225			
Ruiz pr-rf	0	1	0	0	0	0	.241			
Mack c	3	0	0	0	1	2	.233			
Sanoja 3b	4	0	3	1	0	0	.280			
Totals	35	4	10	2	3	8				

Boston.....000 000 000 — 0 5 4
Miami.....110 000 02x — 4 10 0

E—Sogard 2 (3), Wong 2 (4). LOB—Boston 9, Miami 10. 2B—Marsee (15). SB—Hernández (9), Lopez 2 (29). Sanoja 3 (9). Runners left in scoring position—Boston 5 (Sogard 2, Monasterio, Seigler, Wong), Miami 7 (Conine 3, Edwards, Marsee 2, Caissie). RISP—Boston 0 for 4, Miami 2 for 14. Runners moved up—Jones, Conine, Edwards, Mack. GDP—Gasper. DP—Miami 1.

Boston	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Gray L 16-4	5	7	2	2	1	5	93	2.82
Moran	2	1	0	0	1	2	33	2.89
Olds	1	2	2	0	1	1	25	0.00

Miami	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	NP	ERA
Gusto W 1-3	5½	4	0	0	3	2	89	3.98
Vodnik	1½	0	0	0	0	1	13	4.84
Junk	1	0	0	0	0	0	8	4.21
Fulton	1	1	0	0	0	1	10	4.20

Inherited runners-scored—Vodnik 2-0. HBP—by Gusto (Monasterio, Wong). Umpires—Home, Manny Gonzalez; First, Tom Hanahan; Second, Ron Kulp; Third, David Rackley. T—2:38. A—17,472 (37,446).

HOW THE RUNS SCORED

FIRST INNING
MARLINS — Stowers singled to right. Conine grounded out to first unassisted. Stowers to third on throwing error. H.Hernández singled to center, Stowers scored. Edwards grounded out to pitcher. H.Hernández to second. Marsee lined out to center.

SECOND INNING
MARLINS — Lopez singled to left. Caissie lined out to center. Lopez stole second and scored on catcher’s throwing error. Mack walked. Sanoja singled to left, Mack to third. Stowers struck out. Sanoja stole second. Conine struck out.

EIGHTH INNING
MARLINS — Marsee flied out to center. Lopez singled to center. Lopez stole second and advanced to third on catcher’s throwing error. Caissie safe at second on fielding error by first. Lopez scored. Ruiz pinch-running for Caissie. Mack grounded out to first unassisted. Ruiz to third. Sanoja singled to center, Ruiz scored. Sanoja stole second. Stowers walked. Conine struck out.

[strike] zone better when I’m in that mind-set,” he said.

Down on the farm

Isiah Kiner-Falefa walked twice, stole a base, and drove in a run for Triple-A Worcester in his sixth minor league rehabilitation game.

But **Roman Anthony** was 0 for 4 with a strikeout and three ground outs. **Trevor Story** was 0 for 4 and struck out three



CARMEN MANDATO/GETTY IMAGES

Otto Lopez stole second and scored on Connor Wong’s throwing error in the second inning.

Federer’s elegant game worthy of Tennis Hall of Fame

► **SULLIVAN**
Continued from Page C1

That’s the thing about Federer. He changed our perspective. He did it on the court, with a fluidity of movement unlike anything the game had ever seen and a level of graciousness rarely found at his height of professional achievement. He did it off the court, with outside interests from fashion to footwear that made him a billionaire. He’s still doing it since walking away from the court, with an eponymous foundation continuing its impactful charitable work for children worldwide.

As Federer gets inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame in Newport, R.I., on Saturday, there is no doubt of the indelible footprint he left along the way. He took us out of the Pete Sampras era, when it seemed Sampras’s 14 Grand Slams would never be touched, into the Big Three era, when Federer, alongside Rafael Nadal and Novak Djokovic, rewrote those record books. Yet in what feels like a fi-

nal lesson in humility and perspective from the 45-year-old, 20-time Grand Slam champ, he never saw himself that way.

“I think when you retire, there was a lot of talk also about my personality and what I brought to the game overall when I wasn’t on court, which, I was a little surprised,” he said this week before playing an exhibition match at the US Open. “I thought it was about in the moment, forehands and backhands and saving break points and victories and all that stuff. But actually, it becomes a little bit, not irrelevant, but about ‘what were you remembered for, how did you behave in the locker rooms or in the corridors or maybe with the media, or with the tournament directors, the ball kids.’

“For me, if I look back, that’s what I’m very happy about, that I went through 25 years on tour, and actually felt like I made a lot of friends and a lot of people miss me. Same with fans. They come up to me and say, ‘What a

shame you’re not playing anymore.’”

It’s the lament of every aging sports fan. Yet much the way Federer took that baton from Sampras and set a new bar for Nadal, Djokovic, Andy Murray, Stan Wawrinka et al, today’s standouts Carlos Alcaraz and Jannik Sinner continue to raise the game. The sports stage demands as much, constantly resetting and revolving to welcome new stars. The beauty is in the way those stars continue to glow in our memories.

Close your eyes and see Federer’s beautiful one-handed backhand, or his lightning-quick approach to the net, or his artful drop shots or down-the-line winners. Dare yourself to imagine any player doing it all with any of the elegance and gracefulness that set him apart. Federer somehow managed to hide the endless hours in the gym and countless strokes on the practice court behind an aura of effortlessness. It was a sight to behold.

As McEnroe described it, “He had

this incredible gift where he almost looked like he was playing in slow motion, with his backswings and everything he did. Elegance is a great word for a way to look at it. I would call it balletic, almost balletic. With the way he moved, like when you look at ballet dancers, they don’t look like they’ve been lifting weights, but they’re so strong. So supple, yet so strong. I think he had that same type of quality that he brought to the tennis court.”

Strength plus elegance equaled greatness. The 20 major titles, including a men’s record eight at Wimbledon. Five consecutive US Open wins from 2004-08, still the last man to defend that hardcourt. Six wins in Australia. And finally, an elusive French Open championship, the 2009 breakthrough that earned him the career Grand Slam. A record 237 consecutive weeks as world No. 1. A staggering 103 ATP titles from 2001-19. A 2014 Davis Cup victory and 2008 gold medal with doubles partner Wawrinka.

“The way he played was wondrous,” said Mary Carillo, the former player turned commentator who is being inducted into the Hall of Fame as a contributor.

“You don’t expect somebody to have that kind of decision-making ability in a fraction of a moment, to be able to toss up a lob over somebody’s head that hits the baseline. I know that when I called his matches, a lot of times you could hear me laughing. Instead of explaining analytically what just happened, I would be laughing. Someone else would explain it, because you would watch something and just think, ‘How did he even see that winner? How did he look at the court in that fraction of a moment and see that winner?’ It didn’t exist until he saw it and made it happen.”

Tara Sullivan is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at tara.sullivan@globe.com. Follow her @Globe_Tara.

Baseball

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Tampa Bay	79	54	.594	—	—	5-5	W 1
New York	75	57	.568	3½	—	7-3	W 1
Boston	73	60	.549	6	—	7-3	L 1
Baltimore	65	68	.489	14	2½	5-5	W 2
Toronto	65	69	.485	14½	3	5-5	W 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Chicago	70	63	.526	—	—	5-5	W 2
Cleveland	68	66	.507	2½	—	8-2	W 7
Minnesota	64	70	.478	6½	4	4-6	L 2
Detroit	62	71	.466	8	5½	2-8	L 1
Kansas City	59	75	.440	11½	9	9-1	L 1
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Houston	66	67	.496	—	—	3-7	L 1
Texas	66	68	.493	½	2	5-5	L 2
Seattle	64	70	.478	2½	4	6-4	L 1
Athletics	53	81	.396	13½	15	4-6	W 2
Los Angeles	52	82	.388	14½	16	3-7	L 4

EAST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Atlanta	78	55	.586	—	—	5-5	W 3
Philadelphia	74	60	.552	4½	—	8-2	W 1
Miami	68	66	.507	10½	4	5-5	W 1
Washington	62	73	.459	17	10½	2-8	L 2
New York	60	73	.451	18	11½	6-4	L 1
CENTRAL	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Milwaukee	82	51	.617	—	—	7-3	W 1
Chicago	76	58	.567	6½	—	4-6	L 2
St. Louis	66	68	.493	16½	6	3-7	L 5
Pittsburgh	65	70	.481	18	7½	5-5	L 1
Cincinnati	63	71	.470	19½	9	4-6	W 1
WEST	W	L	Pct.	GB	WCGB	Last 10	Streak
Los Angeles	80	53	.602	—	—	6-4	L 2
San Diego	72	62	.537	8½	—	6-4	W 1
Arizona	71	63	.530	9½	1	5-5	W 2
San Francisco	54	79	.406	26	17½	3-7	L 1
Colorado	52	81	.391	28	19½	3-7	W 2

RESULTS									
WEDNESDAY									
At Miami 4		Boston 0		At NY Yankees 9		Houston 3			
Tampa Bay 3		at Detroit 0		At Toronto 3		Kansas City 0			
At Arizona 2		Chi. Cubs 0		Milwaukee 8		at NY Mets 1			
Cincinnati 10		at San Francisco 9		At Atlanta 6		LA Dodgers 5			
Cleveland 4		at LA Angels 3		At Chi. White Sox 10		Texas 4			
Philadelphia 6		at Seattle 0		Baltimore 8		at St. Louis 7			
At San Diego 3		Pittsburgh 0		At Athletics 7		Minnesota 4			
Colorado 13		at Washington 1							
TUESDAY									
Boston 7 (11 inn.)		at Miami 3		Baltimore 13		at St. Louis 1			
At Detroit 4		Tampa Bay 1		Cleveland 8 (10 inn.)		at LA Angels 6			
Colorado 3		at Washington 1		At Arizona 5		Chi. Cubs 4			
Houston 9		at NY Yankees 7		At Athletics 4		Minnesota 2			
Kansas City 5		at Toronto 3		At Seattle 4		Philadelphia 1			
At NY Mets 3 (10 inn.)		Milwaukee 2		Pittsburgh 1		at San Diego 0			
At Atlanta 4		LA Dodgers 3		At San Francisco 3		Cincinnati 1			
At Chi. White Sox 11		Texas 7							



JACK COMPTON/GETTY IMAGES

Kyle Schwarber hit his MLB-leading 40th home run of the season Wednesday in Seattle, giving him 380 regular-season HRs, 227 with Philadelphia.

THURSDAY'S GAMES									
	2026.....	Team		2026 vs. opp.....		Last 3 starts.....			
Odds	W-L	ERA	rec.	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA
COLORADO AT WASHINGTON, 1:05 p.m.									
Hughes (R)	-105	0-5	6.54	7-7	0-1	5.0	1.80	0-2	13.0
Irvin (R)	-115	2-8	5.82	1-9	0-0	0.0	0.0	0-3	15.1
BALTIMORE AT ST. LOUIS, 2:15 p.m.									
Rogers (L)	Off	9-8	4.14	13-11	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	17.0
TBA	Off	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0
HOUSTON AT NY YANKEES, 7:05 p.m.									
Wesneski (R)	+130	3-1	4.23	4-1	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-1	16.0
Cole (R)	-150	7-6	3.11	8-8	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-1	19.0
KANSAS CITY AT TORONTO, 7:07 p.m.									
Cameron (R)	-115	8-8	4.02	8-16	0-0	0.0	0.00	2-0	19.2
Arrighetti (R)	-105	7-6	4.73	10-7	0-1	6.0	6.00	0-1	10.0
MILWAUKEE AT NY METS, 7:10 p.m.									
Misiorowski (R)	-220	13-5	1.68	16-8	0-0	4.0	0.00	2-0	18.0
Manaea (L)	+180	4-5	4.31	6-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	19.1
LA DODGERS AT ATLANTA, 7:15 p.m.									
Yamamoto (R)	-105	12-7	2.61	16-7	0-0	0.0	0.00	1-0	18.0
Sale (L)	-115	12-9	2.20	13-10	0-1	7.0	2.57	0-3	18.0
ARIZONA AT SAN FRANCISCO, 9:45 p.m.									
TBA	Off	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0
Roupp (R)	Off	7-13	4.34	7-18	0-2	13.2	5.93	0-3	16.1
Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season.									

LEADERS

AMERICAN LEAGUE

Through Tuesday's games

BATTING	AB	R	H	Avg.
Alvarez, Hou.	468	88	151	.323
Simpson, TB.	465	50	143	.308
Diaz, TB.	501	76	152	.303
Rafaela, Bos.	504	67	145	.288
Witt, KC.	445	72	128	.288
DeLauter, Cle.	414	52	119	.287
Clement, Tor.	494	54	140	.283
Contreras, Bos.	420	66	118	.281
McGonigle, Det.	492	84	138	.280
Caminero, TB.	503	81	140	.278

HOME RUNS

Alvarez, Hou.	36
Caminero, TB.	35
Rice, NYY.	34
Alonso, Bal.	31
Vargas, CWS.	29
Murakami, CWS.	29
Montgomery, CWS.	27
Dingler, Det.	26
Okamoto, Tor.	26
Contreras, Bos.	26

RUNS BATTED IN

Alvarez, Hou.	91
Alonso, Bal.	89
Caminero, TB.	84
Dingler, Det.	82
Rice, NYY.	82
Bell, Min.	80
Adell, Cle.	80
Aranda, TB.	78
Contreras, Bos.	78
Burger, Tex.	76

NATIONAL LEAGUE

Through Tuesday's games

BATTING	AB	R	H	Avg.
Arraez, Phi.	502	63	161	.321
Gonzales, Pit.	472	66	145	.307
Lopez, Mia.	516	77	158	.306
Morano, Ari.	373	56	113	.303
Freeman, LAD.	485	63	145	.299
Harris, Atl.	481	62	141	.293
McCarthy, Col.	424	63	124	.292
Burleson, StL.	501	75	146	.291
Lee, SF.	461	58	133	.289
Tatis, SD.	512	75	147	.287

HOME RUNS

Schwarber, Phi.	39
Olson, Atl.	36
Goodman, Col.	35
Armstrong, CHC.	33
Ohtani, LAD.	30
Wood, Wash.	30
Abrams, Wsh.	29
Devers, SF.	28
Stewart, Cin.	28
Lowie, Pit.	26
Walker, StL.	27

RUNS BATTED IN

Stewart, Cin.	99
Walker, StL.	96
Burleson, StL.	92
Abrams, Wsh.	92
Armstrong, CHC.	83
Pages, LAD.	80
Lowie, Pit.	78
Ohtani, LAD.	78
Schwarber, Phi.	78

NOTEBOOK

Yankees rip Astros, eye huge series vs. Red Sox

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Cody Bellinger hit a go-ahead double with the bases loaded in the seventh inning and the Yankees pulled away for a 9-3 victory over the Astros on Wednesday in New York.

The Yankees (75-57) won for the 11th time in 17 games and remained 3½ games behind the first-place Rays (79-54) in the AL East and 2½ ahead of the Red Sox (73-60) for the league's top wild card.

The Yankees open a four-game series over three days against the visiting Red Sox on Friday.

Bellinger snapped a 3-3 tie when he drove a 1-and-1 fastball from **Bennett Sousa** (1-3) off the top of the center-field fence to score **Trent Grisham** and **Ben Rice**. The clutch swing came after **Luis García Jr.** reached on an infield single when Sousa didn't cover first base in time on a grounder to the right side.

Spencer Jones added an RBI single in the seventh and **Jazz Chisholm Jr.** had a run-scoring double. Chisholm singled twice and finished with his third three-hit game this year.

Rice, of Cohasset, launched his 35th homer in the first inning and García tacked on a two-run shot in the eighth. García had three more hits after going 4 for 5 in Tuesday night's defeat.

Rice's homer pulled him within one of Astros slugger **Yordan Alvarez** for the American League lead and marked the first time in 24 games the Yankees scored in an opening inning.

Yankees righthanded rookie **Elmer Rodríguez** allowed three runs and three hits over six-plus innings in his first major league start since June 21. He was lifted after walking **Jose Altuve**, and the Astros tied it against **Paul Blackburn** when **Christian Walker's** grounder caromed off **George Lombard Jr.'s** glove for the rookie shortstop's sixth error in 19 career games.

Blackburn (6-2) struck out **Jeremy Peña** with the bases loaded to keep it tied. **Michael Fulmer** struck out Alvarez to start a 1-2-3 eighth in his Yankees debut.

Before the game, the Yankees placed slumping reliever **Fernando Cruz** on the 15-day injured list with right elbow discomfort, a day after the righthander allowed his fifth homer since the All-Star break.

Suarez, Reds shock Giants

Eugenio Suárez hit a grand slam as part of Cincinnati's seven-run ninth inning as the Reds overcame a six-run deficit and beat the Giants, 10-9.

The Reds have a record of 3-1,917 when trailing by six or more runs in the ninth inning. The six-run lead was the largest ever squandered in the ninth inning by the Giants since at least 1901, according to Sportradar.

Cincinnati's comeback prevented the Giants from completing their first three-game sweep of the season. San Francisco is the only MLB team that has not swept a three-game set this season.

Schwarber hits 40th homer

Phillies designated hitter **Kyle Schwarber** hit his MLB-leading 40th home run in a 6-0 victory over the Mariners.

Schwarber drove a 98-mile-per-hour fastball off Mariners starter **Bryan Woo** approximately 425 feet into right-center field, a three-run shot in the second inning to seal his fourth 40-homer season.

The 33-year-old Schwarber, who hit 56 last season, is tied for the most 40-plus homer seasons among active players with the Dodgers' **Shohei Ohtani** and the Yankees' **Aaron Judge**.

Peters extends deep streak

Tristan Peters homered for the fifth consecutive game to match the franchise record and MLB rookie mark, **Brenton Doyle** hit a three-run shot, and the White Sox beat the Rangers, 10-4 . . . **Christian Encarnacion-Strand** hit a tiebreaking RBI double, **Leody Taveras** and **Pete Alonso** homered, and the Orioles beat the Cardinals, 8-7, after squandering a five-run, first-inning lead . . . Pinch hitter **Ha-Seong Kim** singled home **Lane Thomas** with two outs in the ninth inning, lifting the Braves to a 6-5 win over the Dodgers . . . **Freddy Peralta** (6-11) pitched six scoreless innings and picked up his first win with his new team as the Rays beat the Tigers, 3-0, in Detroit . . . **Eduardo Rodríguez** (14-4) struck out nine in seven innings, **Jordan Lawlar** homered, and the Diamondbacks beat the Cubs, 2-0 . . . Seven Toronto pitchers combined on a six-hitter, **Nathan Lutes** hit a three-run homer, and the Blue Jays beat the visiting Royals, 3-0, to end Kansas City's nine-game winning streak . . . **Connor Norby** hit a grand slam, **Troy Johnston**, **Cole Carrigg** and **Hunter Goodman** had two-run homers, and the Rockies beat the host Nationals, 13-1 . . . Brewers righty **Dustin May** left his start against the Mets after one pitch with a bruised right scapula, hit in the upper back by an **A.J. Ewing's** line drive. Milwaukee (82-50) won, 8-1, to clinch a sixth straight winning season and ninth in 10 years.

RAYS 3, TIGERS 0

TAMPA BAY	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avq.
Y Diaz dh	4	0	0	0	0	0	.380
Aranda 1b	3	1	2	0	0	0	.280
Caminero 3b	4	2	0	0	1	2	.280
Hicks c	3	0	1	1	0	1	.309
Piper pr	0	0	0	0	0	0	.250
Fortes c	0	0	0	0	0	0	.263
Simpson 1b	3	1	1	0	0	0	.308
DeLuca rf	4	1	1	0	0	1	.280
Palacios 2b	3	0	0	0	0	0	.228
Mateo ss	3	0	0	0	0	1	.167
Mullins cf	3	0	1	1	0	0	.205
Totals	30	3	8	3	0	4	

It only gets tougher for the Revolution

FRANK DELL'APA
ON SOCCER

FOXBOROUGH — The Revolution's Jack Harrison has seemed nearly unstoppable on the right wing since arriving early this month. He seemed on track again as he extended his assist streak to three games during a 1-1 tie with New York City FC on Sunday.

Despite a strong start, the Revolution did not score until a Harrison cross set up Dor Turgeman via Peyton Miller at the back post in the 36th minute. That could have been enough to send the Revolution on the way to victory, but they had squandered chances, as Carles Gil had a penalty kick saved and a Miller breakaway was cleared off the line.

And soon, Harrison and the Revolution seemed to fade in the heat and humidity. NYCFC equalized as James Sands finished off a corner kick in first-half added time and, by the second half, nearly everyone seemed a step slower.

The 18-year-old Miller, the Revolu-

tion's youngest starter, proved the exception, threatening on the left wing, and on a breakaway, saved by Matt Freeze in the 51st minute.

As for Harrison, he was replaced by Diego Fagundez in the 81st minute.

"We have to understand that Jack played three games in one week and without a preseason," Revolution coach Marko Mitrovic said. "So just to push for the amount of minutes that he had in those three games, it's amazing.

"When you don't have fresh legs, obviously it's very difficult to be clean on the ball and then be productive. I also think that they created a lot in the first half and it's not easy to create for 90 minutes, every game after game. I think they created enough in today's game."

The lack of training camp, and the fact Harrison had not played since a Serie A game for Fiorentina in May, finally caught up with him.

So, as Fagundez said: The result "could have seemed like a loss, tying at home. We had a chance to go ahead, 2-0, but we got unlucky."

The Revolution (10-7-4, 34 points) moved within 2 points of third place in the Eastern Conference. But they are facing four straight road games — against the Columbus Crew, the LA Galaxy, NYCFC again, and the Chicago Fire. This is about the time when the season seems like an endurance contest, and these could prove among the toughest tests the Revolution will face.

Though they are on track to return to the playoffs after a two-season absence, their resilience will be tested. Lacking depth, and having key players injured, means they will have to prioritize preserving Gil and Harrison.

Opponents have found they can defend either aggressively or passively against the skilled pair, and aggression seems to work better. D.C. United basically backed off both last Wednesday, and the Revolution took a 3-0 victory as Harrison produced three assists on crosses. NYCFC took a physical approach, fouling Gil five times and slowing the Revolution attack. It meant free kicks, but the Revolution were unable to capitalize.

"Our mind-set has to be that we have to be ready to play three games in a week, and that cannot be our excuse," Mitrovic said. "I said to the guys that sometimes being tired ... yes, it's the body, but it's also how you can push mentally, really. Our togetherness was present all the time, and you saw that guys were pushing to win the game through the last moment of the game. That's the mentality that we have to go into every game.

"If you talk about our last three games, we were on the front foot in all three. We created so much and had full control of the game. We got rewarded with 4 points; we could have easily walked away with 9 points from those three games.

"Can we have a better record? One hundred percent. We have to improve our record. But again, for us, these next four games ... or actually the first game ahead of us ... our whole focus is going to be there. We'll do our best not just to perform, but also to get a result."

Frank Dell'Apa can be reached at frankdellapa@gmail.com.

GOLF NOTEBOOK

Scheffler can win big at Tour Championship

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Scottie Scheffler is having another big season going into the final tournament of the year at the Tour Championship. He picked up a \$23 million bonus last week as the leading player in the FedEx Cup. His PGA Tour earnings are over \$20 million for the fourth consecutive year.

And that's not the full measure. Scheffler loves to play when he's at home in Dallas, whether that's at Royal Oaks or any other course in town. That often involves Si Woo Kim, who said earlier this year of their one-sided money matches, "He calls me ATM."

Kim isn't alone. "Si Woo's getting a lot of hard grief losing to Scottie. I've never beaten Scottie in Dallas," Gary Woodland said Wednesday. "He asked me if I hand him money every time he sees me. Fortunately, that's been the case."

Woodland now lives in South Florida but has returned to working with Randy Smith, the Hall of Fame teacher who has taught Scheffler since he was a boy. He occasionally goes to Dallas for what Woodland calls "training camp." The last such trip was right before Scheffler ended a seven-month drought by winning the FedEx Cup playoffs opener by eight shots.

The winner of the 30-man field at East Lake claims a \$10 million prize in official money from a \$40 million purse.

For now, it's up for grabs. Tommy Fleetwood had never won on the PGA Tour until capturing his first title on US soil at just the right time — last year's Tour Championship, making him the FedEx Cup champion.

That could fall to someone like Patrick Cantlay, whose runner-up finish got him into East Lake, or a dozen others yet to win this week. It's a 72-hole shootout for a big prize.

But there's more at stake for Scheffler this week than just more money, and it's not his chance to end the 26-year reign of Tiger Woods atop the PGA Tour's career earnings list. He is in a tight race with US Open champion Wyndham Clark for PGA Tour player of the year.

Scheffler has won the award the last four years, and while his consistency is the standard in today's game — five runner-up finishes to go with two victories — Clark already has three wins, including the major and last week's BMW Championship.

Layoffs coming to LIV

LIV Golf has informed employees their jobs will end next week as the league begins life without Saudi funding, downsizing operations as it pursues an agreement with a lead investor to reshape the league for next year. The staff reduction was not a surprise. LIV Golf learned in April the Public Investment Fund of Saudi Arabia would end financial backing after this season. LIV in July filed a notice under the Worker Adjustment and Retraining Notification Act that indicated layoffs were likely. CEO Scott O'Neil announced earlier this month that he had come to terms with a lead investor, which multiple reports have indicated was BC Partners, and they were hopeful of finalizing the deal in September. Still to be determined are the futures of its biggest names, starting with Jon Rahm and Bryson DeChambeau. Rahm still is under contract while DeChambeau started the year negotiating for a renewal. O'Neil has not ruled out filing for bankruptcy as part of the restructuring. LIV already faces two lawsuits for not paying vendors for services ... The PGA Tour released its 2027 schedule and the Travelers Championship at TPC River Highlands in Cromwell, Conn., will be contested June 24-27, the week following the US Open at Pebble Beach.

Thursday's Tour tee times

11 a.m.: Ryan Fox, Tom Kim; **11:12 a.m.:** Justin Rose, Adam Scott; **11:24 a.m.:** Viktor Hovland, Robert MacIntyre; **11:36 a.m.:** Alex Fitzpatrick, Alex Smalley; **11:48 a.m.:** Min Woo Lee, J.J. Spaun; **12:06 p.m.:** Patrick Cantlay, Kristoffer Reitan; **12:18 p.m.:** Ryan Gerard, Gary Woodland; **12:30 p.m.:** Akshay Bhatia, Hideki Matsuyama; **12:42 p.m.:** Jacob Bridgeman, Russell Henley; **12:54 p.m.:** Rory McIlroy, Xander Schauffele; **1:12 p.m.:** Ludvig Aberg, Tommy Fleetwood; **1:24 p.m.:** Sam Burns, Collin Morikawa; **1:36 p.m.:** Chris Gotterup, Si Woo Kim; **1:48 p.m.:** Wyndham Clark, Cameron Young; **2 p.m.:** Matt Fitzpatrick, Scottie Scheffler.



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE GLOBE

Three-time major winner Anna Nordqvist said she will retire after the FM Championship.

Big purse available to field of LPGA stars in Norton

►FM CHAMPIONSHIP
Continued from Page C1

courtesy cars, and Uber gift cards. FM provides a \$1,000 stipend to golfers who miss the cut, helping to offset some of the upfront costs golfers face.

It's all part of FM's effort to make New England's LPGA Tour stop one that players "will come back to year after year," said Dave Johnson, FM's senior vice president and chief client experience officer.

"FM elevates the game, right?" Korda said. "They elevate the player experience. When you talk about [the] purse, too, it's one of our larger purses, as well. That usually always draws a bigger field.

"But it's also about the way that they treat their players. And we know that FM has invested a lot into the LPGA, and we want to show up for them as they've shown up for us."

Korda is the marquee star. Her four wins this season, including two majors, are more than any other player, and she has 10 top-10 finishes in 14 starts.

All that winning has earned her \$6.2 million this year, bringing her career total to \$22.3 million — just \$269,328 from passing Annika Sorenstam to become the career leader on the LPGA Tour.

Korda could break that record, one Sorenstam has held for more than 25 years, with a third-place finish or better this week — an attainable result given her history of dominance.

Korda is joined in the field by other big names, including world No. 2 Jeeno Thitikul, No. 3 Haeran Ryu, young superstar Lottie Woad, and 11 of the 12 players on the United States Solheim Cup team.

Two Massachusetts natives — Khang and Alexa Pano of Westborough — are in as well.



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE GLOBE

LPGA Tour player Chizuya Iwai shakes hands with her teammates following Wednesday's FM Championship pro-am at TPC Boston.

Khang, who on Monday was named a captain's pick for the Solheim Cup, has made the cut in both previous FM Championship appearances, finishing tied for 35th in 2024 and tied for 24th in 2025.

While she has only played TPC Boston a handful of times outside her FM Championship appearances, Khang is relishing the opportunity to compete in her home state. She chose to stay at her house — adding a few minutes to her commute to the course — rather than accepting the free hotel room FM offered.

"It's always considered a home game if you can sleep in your own bed," Khang said.

Khang, 28 and in her 11th year on Tour, has struggled this season, making just nine cuts in 17 starts. Her best finish was tied for 12th at the Mizuho Americas Open in May.

So if sleeping in her own bed gives her a leg up against one of the toughest non-major fields this season, she'll take it.

Emma Healy can be reached at emma.healy@globe.com or on X @ByEmmaHealy.

Thursday's FM tee times

1ST HOLE
7 a.m.: Robyn Choi, Pornanong Phatlum, Gabriela Ruffels; 7:11 a.m.: Melanie Green, Mary Liu, Carolina Melgrati; 7:22 a.m.: Hailee Cooper, Gemma Dryburgh, a-Paula Martin Sampeiro; 7:33 a.m.: Charley Hull, Jeeno Thitikul, Lottie Woad; 7:44 a.m.: Brooke Henderson, Auston Kim, Hae-Ran Ryu; 7:55 a.m.: Esther Hensleleit, A Lim Kim, Miyu Yamashita; 8:06 a.m.: Ingrid Lindblad, Yana Wilson, Ina Yoon; 8:17 a.m.: Chisato Iwai, Minjee Lee, Yuri Yoshida; 8:28 a.m.: Daniela Darquea, Hinako Shibuno, a-Michelle Zhang; 8:39 a.m.: Soo Bin Joo, Andrea Lee, a-Klara Romero; 8:50 a.m.: Manon De Roey, Perrine Delacour, Katie Lu; 9:01 a.m.: Natasha Andrea Oon, Ana Belac, Alexa Pano; 12:10 p.m.: Laney Frye, a-Anna Huang, Rose Zhang; 12:21 p.m.: Georgja Hall, Emily Pedersen, Dewi Weber; 12:32 p.m.: Riley Smyth, Linnea Strom, Chiara Tamburlini; 12:43 p.m.: Jenny Shin, Patty Tavatanakit, Weiwei Zhang; 12:54 p.m.: Ariya Jutanugarn, Mao Saigo, Arpichaya Yubol; 1:05 p.m.: Carlota Ciganda, Chanettee Wannasena, Amy Yang; 1:16 p.m.: Jin Young Ko, Yan Liu, Rio Takeda; 1:27 p.m.: Jin Hee Im, Minami Katsu, Hyo Joo Kim; 1:38 p.m.: Megan Khang, Paula Reto, Mimi Rhodes; 1:49 p.m.: Lucy Li, Polly Mack, Julia Lopez Ramirez; 2 p.m.: Nataliya Guseva, Gurleen Kaur, Sophia Schubert; 2:11 p.m.: Laetitia Beck, a-Helen Briem, Chella Choi.

10TH HOLE
7 a.m.: Nicole Broch Estrup, Briana Chacon, Karis Davidson; 7:11 a.m.: Olivia Cowan, Moriya Jutanugarn, Lizette Salas; 7:22 a.m.: a-Aphrodite Deng, Carolina Lopez-Chacarra, Jessica Porvasnik; 7:33 a.m.: Linn Grant, Grace Kim, Yu Liu; 7:44 a.m.: Allisen Corpuz, Erika Hara, Sei Young Kim; 7:55 a.m.: Hannah Green, So-Mi Lee, Gabby Lopez; 8:06 a.m.: Pajaree Anannarukarn, Ayaka Furue, Cassie Porter; 8:17 a.m.: Jenny Bae, Celine Boutier, Gina Kim; 8:28 a.m.: Lindy Duncan, a-Zoe Jiamanukoonkit, Brooke Matthews; 8:39 a.m.: Celine Borge, Jiwon Jeon, Yuna Nishimura; 8:50 a.m.: Brianna Do, Maude-Aimee Leblanc, Jing Yan; 9:01 a.m.: Ashleigh Buhai, Sofia Garcia, Frida Kinhuil; 12:10 p.m.: Minji Kang, Stephanie Kyriacou, Ryann O'Toole; 12:21 p.m.: Carla Tejedo Mulet, Suvichaya Vinijchaitham, Lilia Vu; 12:32 p.m.: Megan Khang, Pauline Roussin-Bouchard, Yuka Saso; 12:43 p.m.: Akie Iwai, Nelly Korda, Ruoning Yin; 12:54 p.m.: Lauren Coughlin, Lydia Ko, Anna Nordqvist; 1:05 p.m.: Nasa Hataoka, Lexi Thompson, Angel Yin; 1:16 p.m.: Jennifer Kupcho, Mi Hyang Lee, Yealimi Noh; 1:27 p.m.: Hye-Jin Choi, Wei-Ling Hsu, Youmin Hwang; 1:38 p.m.: Morgane Mettraux, Benedetta Morresco, Nastasia Nadaud; 1:49 p.m.: Nanna Koerstz Madsen, Dongeun Lee, Jeongeun Lees; 2 p.m.: Amanda Doherty, Jodi Ewart Shadoff, Isi Gausa; 2:11 p.m.: Na Rin An, Aditi Ashok, Saki Baba.
a — amateur

SportsLog

NESN extends fan fave Caron

NESN announced Wednesday that it extended its contract with longtime studio and play-by-play voice **Tom Caron**. Caron, a 13-time New England Emmy Award winner, has been with the network since 1995. His current duties include hosting Red Sox pre- and postgame programming, NESN's baseball podcast "310 to Left," and calling Beanpot and Hockey East championship broadcasts. NESN exercised an option to pick up an additional year on his current deal, which assures that he will remain under contract in case there is an MLB work stoppage following this season.

CHAD FINN

BASKETBALL

Mathurin to Pelicans

The Pelicans and high-scoring wing player **Bennedict Mathurin** have reportedly agreed to a two-year, \$16 million contract. The 24-year-old Mathurin was traded from Indiana to the Clippers last season, where he averaged 17.6 points per game ... Free-agent guard **Brandon Williams** inked a one-year, \$2.6 million deal with Golden State. The 26-year-old averaged bests of 13.0 points, 3.9 assists, and 2.9 rebounds for Dallas last season ... The Timberwolves reportedly agreed to terms with power forward **Jonathan Kuminga** on a two-year, \$12.4 million pact.

Sun shredded at home

Rookie **Charlisse Leger-Walker** scored a season-high 17 points and **Nell Angloma** added 11, but the host Sun (10-28) shot only 31 percent from the floor as the Valkyries (27-11) ran away to a 89-64 blowout win in Uncasville, Conn. Newton's **Veronica Burton** had 12 points and seven assists for Golden State ... Former Sun forward **DeWanna Bonner** will join the Atlanta Dream after accepting a buyout from the Phoenix Mercury and clearing waivers.

TENNIS

Williams sisters return

Serena and **Venus Williams** are teaming up again at the US Open, as the sisters will play in the doubles tournament after receiving a wild card into the event they won in 1999 and 2009. They just played in the Cincinnati Open, losing in the first round. They last played in Flushing in 2022, losing in the first round. The 44-year-old Serena played with men's No. 2 **Carlos Alcaraz** in US Open mixed doubles Tuesday, winning one match before losing in the quarterfinals. Venus, 46, also is entered in the women's singles event ... Another US Open champion is being welcomed back to the men's singles field, as 2016 titlist **Stan Wawrinka** was given a wild card after **Patrick Kypson** withdrew ... **Belinda Bencic** and **Flavio Cobolli** advanced to the US Open mixed doubles final by rallying past spouses **Elina Svitolina** and **Gael Monfils**, 4-5 (9-7), 4-1 (10-5). They will face **Karolina Muchova** and **Jakub Mensik**, who beat **Mirra Andreeva** and **Andrey Rublev**, 5-4 (8-6), 3-5 (11-9).

COLLEGES

Castellanos picks spot

Former Boston College quarterback **Tommy Castellanos** plans to play this season for No. 12 Texas Tech. His decision came after he was among 10 athletes granted a temporary restraining order by a Kentucky judge last week to get a fifth season of eligibility. Castellanos went undrafted by the NFL four months ago before a tryout as a receiver with the Dolphins. Castellanos, who transferred to Florida State following two seasons at BC, was 180 of 309 for 2,760 yards, 15 TDs, and 9 INTs last year in his 12 games for the Seminoles ... Arizona State hockey defenseman **Matthew Mayich**, a Blues sixth-round draft pick in 2023, remained hospitalized after collapsing during an offseason outdoor workout in what paramedics called a "heat-related illness."

MISCELLANY

Liu decides rest is better

Olympic figure skating champion **Alysa Liu** is taking the season off after her triumph in Milan, she announced on social media. The 21-year-old from California was scheduled to compete at Skate America in November in Everett, Wash.

Revolution game change

The Revolution's MLS match at Columbus, originally scheduled for Saturday night, has been moved to Sunday and a 4:30 p.m. kickoff ... NASCAR will return to Naval Base Coronado in San Diego next Aug. 1, as the racing series revealed its 2027 schedule. As always, the slate begins at Daytona International Speedway for the Daytona 500 on Feb. 21, and wraps up back in the Sunshine State at Homestead-Miami Speedway for the second straight year. New Hampshire Motor Speedway will host the third of 10 Chase races on Sept. 26, 2027 ... **Alli Schroder** was 3 for 3 with an RBI and run scored, while **Molly Paddison** and **Raine Padgham** each knocked in two, but the Boston Hunters (4-6) saw a one-run lead evaporate as Los Angeles (5-5) scored three times in the bottom of the sixth to take an 8-6 win in WP-BL play in Springfield, Ill.

HIGH SCHOOL CROSS-COUNTRY

Lexington girls race toward a historic two-year sweep

By **Matty Wasserman**
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

LEXINGTON — The Lexington girls’ running program has reached heights rarely equaled in state history.

The Minutemen have won five consecutive Division 1 titles across the cross-country, indoor track, and outdoor track seasons, dating to the winter of 2024-25. The streak has only been matched once, by the Newton North boys’ program in 2004-05.

With another cross-country title this fall, Lexington would become the first to win six straight and complete a two-year cycle on top.

“That would be crazy,” said star junior Janie Conrad. “That’s definitely the main goal.”

The opening of fall practice at Hastings Park this week marked the end of a short offseason for Lexington’s top runners, all of whom participated on the outdoor track team. Expectations picked up right where they left off in June.

The Minutemen return their top five finishers from last year’s Division 1 championship, and added two high-level track runners who previously played soccer in the fall.

“The message has been to keep pushing ourselves, and you can’t get comfortable with where you are,” said Rebecca Trachsel, who coaches all three seasons. “The girls had an incredible run with their three championship titles [in the 2025-26 school year], but you know there’s always teams out there that we are striving to compete with.”

Lexington’s lineup is headlined by Conrad, who has been the team’s No. 1 runner since her freshman season and who finished third at the Division 1 championship last November.

After placing 29th in the 2-mile (10:38.76) at New Balance Nationals in June, Conrad took two weeks off before beginning her cross-country buildup. She began at 30 miles per week in early July before gradually climbing to 45-50.

“That was definitely a big reset moment, definitely a big recovery time,” said Conrad. “But then I felt really fresh and really good coming back into summer training and now into the fall.”



TAYLOR COESTER FOR THE GLOBE

Lexington runners continued preparations for their shot at history at Hastings Park.

Head injury concerns loom over high school football

►CONCUSSIONS
Continued from Page C1

with a ball carrier being tackled to the ground. The cumulative effect of those bodies crashing into each other, research shows, can lead to alarming rates of cognitive decline.

The 17,000-plus high school players in Massachusetts received another grim reminder of that Tuesday, when a new study showed that approximately one in four brains of recently deceased NFL players had the neurodegenerative disease known as CTE.

Football is not the only sport that exposes young athletes to potential head trauma, but it has the highest rate of concussions, followed by girls’ soccer, boys’ lacrosse, hockey, and wrestling, according to the Center for Disease Control and Prevention. Tackling is responsible for nearly two-thirds of concussions in high school football.

“It’s the practices you’re worried about,” Fornaro said, echoing the words of several of his colleagues. “But when we practice, quite often there isn’t any live tackling at all. It’s a rarity when a boy brings another to the ground.”

The MIAA limits player-on-player contact during the first week of practices, which began Monday. Players cannot tackle each other until the fifth day of workouts. Grueling two-a-day practices, the old preseason standard, have been extremely limited.

“The game has changed drastically in the last 10 years with how everyone practices,” said Milton coach Steve Dembowski, the coaching representative for the MIAA football committee.

Dembowski’s team doesn’t go “live” — as in, tackling to the ground — in practices. Some teams, he added, use “thud” tackling — the drill stops after an initial collision.

One significant issue persists. While most teams staff an athletic trainer at football practices, some teams, particularly smaller schools in lower MIAA divisions, do not. That means some players are not properly evaluated in the days after a hit, when they are at risk for more damage.

“If I could wave my magic wand, the thing I would ask for the most would be to have a full-time athletic trainer in every public high school in Massachusetts,” said Dr. Lee Mancini, chair of the MIAA Sports Medicine Committee and

Lexington’s other returners — seniors Erin Ehmann, Alycia Charest, and Callie Glenn, and junior Ella Tyson — followed a similar path, taking offseason breaks before ramping up their mileage.

“For them to get where they want to be, the work has to be done in the summer. And they know that,” said Trachsel. “So they put in a ton of time in the summer to build that mileage base, so that when we hit the ground this fall, we can get right into workouts. We don’t have to spend that time getting the mileage up.”

The team’s depth is further strengthened by Amelia Whorton and Natalie Bielat, who opted to run cross-country in lieu of soccer, along with sophomore Emma Kosnik, who impressed as a freshman but was sidelined with an injury for the Meet of Champions.

Whorton, one of the state’s premier mile runners, gives Lexington another potential star. This spring, she finished second in the mile at the outdoor Meet of Champions (4:47.88) and 13th at New Balance Nationals (4:45.55).

After running 30-35 miles per week during spring track season, Whorton spent the summer building up to 50 in preparation for the added distance.

“I think it’ll be really good for me to have more of a base going into indoor [track] and for the rest of track season,” said Whorton. “And I’m also really excited for this cross-country season to test my limits in terms of distance.”

As another season begins with a proven lineup and high hopes, the team recognizes just how special the history-making opportunity in front of it is.

“I think [the key is] just reminding everyone that this is not a normal thing to experience and that being able to have that in our reach is really lucky,” said Tyson. “But we do really work hard for it . . . and just stay focused on the goal that we have.”

Matty Wasserman can be reached at matty.wasserman@globe.com.

Baseball

INTERNATIONAL LEAGUE				
EAST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Rochester	31	21	.596	—
Durham	30	21	.588	1½
Scranton/W-B	28	21	.571	1½
Buffalo	28	23	.549	2½
Worcester	28	23	.549	2½
Lehigh Valley	26	24	.520	4
Syracuse	26	25	.510	4½
Charlotte	26	26	.500	5
Jacksonville	21	30	.412	9½
Norfolk	18	31	.367	11½

WEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Indianapolis	32	20	.615	—
St. Paul	31	21	.596	1
Nashville	26	25	.510	5½
Columbus	25	25	.500	6
Omaha	25	25	.500	6
Gwinnett	25	27	.481	7
Toledo	24	28	.462	8
Iowa	22	30	.423	10
Memphis	22	30	.423	10
Louisville	18	34	.346	14

WEDNESDAY’S RESULTS
Scranton/W-B 7.....at Worcester 1
At Rochester 6.....Buffalo 3
At Iowa 7.....Omaha 3
At Indianapolis 4.....Columbus 3
Memphis 2.....at Charlotte 0
Gwinnett 5.....at Louisville 2
Syracuse 11.....at Lehigh Valley 1
Norfolk 7.....Durham 6
At Jacksonville 6.....Nashville 1
Toledo 4.....at St. Paul 2

THURSDAY’S GAMES
Scranton/W-B at Worcester.....6:05
Columbus at Indianapolis.....6:35
Gwinnett at Louisville.....6:35
Syracuse at Lehigh Valley.....6:45
Buffalo at Rochester.....6:45
Norfolk at Durham.....6:45
Memphis at Charlotte.....7:04
Nashville at Jacksonville.....7:05
Omaha at Iowa.....7:38
Toledo at St. Paul.....8:07

Scranton/W-B, 7-1

At Polar Park, Worcester										
SCR./W-B	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
Volpe 2b	4	1	1	1	1	0	.221			
Dominguez rf	4	1	1	0	1	2	.263			
Garver dh	5	1	2	0	0	1	.200			
Escarra c	5	0	1	0	0	.281				
Luciano lf	5	1	2	1	0	2	.286			
Schuerman 3b	5	0	1	0	0	1	.254			
Cabrera ss	3	1	1	1	0	.289				
Hartman 1b	4	0	0	0	1	.220				
Corona cf	4	1	2	3	0	.260				
Totals	39	7	13	7	3	8				

Scr./W-B	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Merda	2	1	0	0	1	4	8.5
Cohen	2	1	1	0	0	2	7.5
Morgan	2	1	0	0	1	2	1.2
Kean	2	1	0	0	1	2	6.5
Gil	$\frac{2}{3}$	1	0	0	1	1	3.0
Messinger	$\frac{1}{3}$	0	0	0	0	1	3.8

Scr./W-B.....	.042	000	001	—	7	13	2
Worcester.....	.001	000	000	—	1	5	0
LOB—Scranton/W-B 8, Worcester 7.							
2B—Dominguez, Corona, HR—Corona.							
Volpe, SB—Corona, Volpe, Ward, Falefa, CS—Castro, DP—Scranton/W-B 1; Worcester 1.							

Scr./W-B	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Merda	2	1	0	0	4	8	5.00
Cohen	2	1	1	0	0	2	7.52
Morgan	2	1	0	0	1	2	1.21
Kean	2	1	0	0	1	2	6.52
Gil	1	0	0	1	1	3	3.00
Messinger	½	0	0	0	0	1	3.86

Worcester	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Ziehl	3	9	6	6	1	6	11.11
Song	3	2	0	0	0	4	5.65
Samaniego	1	0	0	0	0	0	3.77
Sweet	1	0	0	0	0	2	5.03
McWilliams	1	2	1	1	1	1	5.89
T—2:39, A—6,859.							

EASTERN LEAGUE				
NORTHEAST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Reading	30	21	.588	—
Somerset	28	24	.538	2½
Binghamton	27	25	.519	3½
Portland	25	27	.481	5½
New Hampshire	20	32	.385	10½
Hartford	13	33	.365	11½

SOUTHWEST				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Erie	35	17	.673	—
Chesapeake	28	23	.549	1½
Richmond	28	23	.549	1½
Harrisburg	25	25	.500	9
Akron	23	27	.460	11
Altoona	20	31	.392	14½

WEDNESDAY’S RESULTS
Portland 5.....at Richmond 4
At Altoona 6.....Erie 1
At New Hampshire 5.....Hartford 4
At Harrisburg 5.....Chesapeake 4
Akron 7.....at Somerset 5
At Reading 6.....Binghamton 2

THURSDAY’S GAMES
Portland at Richmond.....7:05
Erie at Altoona.....7:05
Hartford at New Hampshire.....6:03
Chesapeake at Harrisburg.....6:30
Akron at Somerset.....6:35
Binghamton at Reading.....6:45

Portland, 5-4

At The Diamond, Richmond										
PORTLAND	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.			
McDonough lf	5	0	0	0	0	2	.208			
Turner cf	6	1	0	0	0	2	.186			
Brannon 1b	5	0	1	0	0	0	.281			
Rosario c	5	1	1	1	0	1	.190			
Godbout of	3	0	0	1	1	1	.190			
White ss	2	0	0	1	1	1	.202			
Rose ss-3b	2	1	1	1	0	0	.219			
Ferguson 3b	5	1	1	1	0	2	.252			
Céspedes 2b	5	1	2	0	1	1	.160			
Taylor rf	5	0	0	0	0	1	.185			
Lyndor p	1	0	0	0	0	0	.234			
Totals	44	5	6	5	2	11				

Portland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Mullins	5½	4	0	0	1	5	4.33
Carlson	2½	1	0	0	1	4	4.40
Sena	2	1	1	0	3	1	4.50
Wu-Yelland	2	3	1	0	2	1	8.75
Liendo	1	0	2	0	1	0	7.75
Richmond	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA

Port.....	.000	000	000	101	3	—	5	6	5
Rich.....	.000	000	000	000	18	28	0	0	0
LOB—Portland 8, Richmond 18, 28.									
Rosario, Ferguson, Astudillo, HR—Céspedes, SB—Liendo, Astudillo, Diaz, S—Godbout, Diaz, DP—Portland 2.									

Portland	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Mullins	5½	6	0	0	5	4	3.35
Carlson	2½	1	0	0	1	4	4.48
Sena	2	1	1	0	3	1	4.54
Wu-Yelland	2	3	1	0	2	1	8.76
Liendo	1	0	2	0	1	0	7.71

Richmond	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Rademacher	3½	2	1	0	3	4	2.22
Vincio	3½	0	0	0	1	3	4.00
Vanderhei	2	0	0	0	0	1	2.36
Vogel	2	0	1	0	0	2	3.00
Johnson	2	3	2	0	0	1	4.86

HBP —by John J. **WP** —Mullins, Liendo, T—3:40, A—7,051.

SOUTH ATLANTIC LEAGUE				
NORTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Frederick	32	21	.606	—
Greensboro	33	22	.600	—
Hudson Valley	32	23	.582	1
Wilmington	29	26	.527	4
Brooklyn	28	26	.519	4½
Jersey Shore	26	33	.443	14½

SOUTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Bowling Green	29	25	.537	—
Winston-Salem	29	25	.537	—
Greenville	28	27	.509	1½
Asheville	24	30	.444	5
Rome	24	30	.444	5
Hill City	20	34	.370	13½
Hub City	19	36	.345	15½

WEDNESDAY’S RESULTS
Rome 5.....at Greenville 1
Hub City 10.....at Greensboro 3
Bowling Green 8.....at Winston-Salem 3
Wilmington 11.....at Hudson Valley 5
At Frederick 3.....Asheville 2

THURSDAY’S GAMES
Rome at Greenville.....6:45
Hub City at Greensboro.....6:30
Bowling Green at Winston-Salem.....6:30
Brooklyn at Hudson Valley.....6:35
Asheville at Frederick.....7:05
Wilmington at Jersey Shore.....7:05

CAROLINA LEAGUE				
NORTH				
	W	L	Pct.	GB
Fayetteville	33	20	.623	—
Winston	28	25	.527	6½
Salem	27	26	.509	7½
Fredericksburg	25	29	.463	8½
Hill City	20	34	.370	13½
Delmarva	19	36	.345	15½

BY CITY AND TOWN

BOSTON REMEIKA, Francis E	COHASSET BUCKLEY, Albert Paten Sr.	LITTLETON CASTAGNETO, Lawrence A. Jr.	NEWTON BEITCH, Laurie Greenbaum	ROSLINDALE McCLUSKEY, J. Corby	WEST ROXBURY McCLUSKEY, J. Corby	OUT OF STATE
BROOKLINE BEITCH, Laurie Greenbaum	HINGHAM GROSSO, Mary E. (Mackin)	MANSFIELD McCLUSKEY, J. Corby	NORWELL GROSSO, Mary E. (Mackin)	SOUTH BOSTON NEE, Robert Coleman	WEYMOUTH McCLUSKEY, J. Corby	FLORIDA
CAMBRIDGE REMEIKA, Francis E	KINGSTON SHEA, Leah M. (Walsh)	MARBLEHEAD REMEIKA, Francis E	QUINCY SHEA, Leah M. (Walsh)	WATERTOWN ABADJIAN-ZONA, Elizabeth		CROWLEY , John J. Jr.

ABADJIAN-ZONA, Elizabeth
“Betty”

With heavy hearts, we share the passing of dear Betty. Queenie Elizabeth Abadjian-Zona is survived by her daughter, Michelle Zona of Arlington, MA; granddaughter, Venice Mountain-Zona of Arlington, MA; and her lifelong devoted sister, MaryAnn Graham of Manhattan Beach, CA. She was preceded by her mother, Anna Abadjian and her father, Edward Abadjian; as well as her younger brother, George Abadjian; and her beloved son, Michael Zona, both men who passed much too young.

Betty will always be remembered for her striking Armenian beauty, her sensational style, and her sharp wit. She turned heads and lit up any room she entered. And we can't forget to mention Mew Mew, her sweet kitty, whom she loved dearly.

Betty lived September, 19, 1934 to August, 23, 2026.

Visiting Hours: Service will be held on Monday, August 31, at 2pm, at Green Hills Memorial Park, in Palos Verdes, CA.

BEITCH, Laurie Greenbaum

See Enhanced Listing

In Memoriam

In Loving Memory of
Patsy M. Duggan
1st Birthday in Heaven



Instead of a card, we send you our love. Instead of a gift, a prayer.

To Patsy, who we thought the world of and miss beyond compare.

Lovingly Remembered and Sadly Missed
By Your Family and Friends



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BUCKLEY, Albert Paten Sr.



+ Always known as “Al,” passed away peacefully, with his family by his side, on August 22, 2026, at his home in Cohasset, Massachusetts. Al was a cherished husband, father, grandfather, great-grandfather, brother and friend, whose presence will be deeply missed.

With Al, it was about his kindness. You always knew when you spoke with him that you were heard. Whether it was met with a quick retort or his genuine, sometimes mischievous, smile.

Al was the beloved husband of more than 70 years to Joan (Mulrooney) Buckley. Married at Sacred Heart Church in Roslindale, they settled in Cohasset to begin their family. Together, they built a life rooted in family, faith, friendship, and community. Joan was his constant companion and partner through every season of life, from raising their five children to welcoming generations of grandchildren and great-grandchildren. Their home in Cohasset was always open to family and friends and became a gathering place for generations.

He was the loving father of Albert, Jr. and his wife, Laura Giuliano, Mark Buckley and his wife, Nancy, Susan Mavilia and her husband, Ron, Cathleen Haggerty and her husband, Fran and Matthew Buckley and his wife, Karen. He is also survived by his brother, Paul and wife, Patricia of Cohasset.

Al was one of seven children born to Daniel Joseph (D.J.) and Florence (Paten) Buckley of Canton and Cohasset. He was predeceased by his brothers, Joseph, Raymond, George and Jack; and his sister, Marie Lucas.

He leaves behind 13 grandchildren, Emma, Ben, Victoria, Olivia, Sam, Jake, Elianna, Sarah, Caitlin, Sean, Bridget, Paul, and Nora; and eight great-grandchildren, Amabel, Tallulah, Lola, Brandon, Ava, Asher, Jackson, and Keelson.

Born in Milton, Al graduated from Canton High School in 1947 and spent his adult life in Cohasset. Alongside his brother Paul, he built numerous custom homes in North Cohasset through the D.J. Buckley Company. He later worked with his brothers at Buckley Iron Works, also known as Buckley Corporation.

He and Joan also became deeply connected to the Glastonbury Abbey community, where Al contributed his time for decades to support Father Bill's Place. Al believed in supporting groups like the Cohasset Swim Center and Cohasset Sailing Club, often working quietly behind the scenes with his hands-on approach.

The water was a lifelong part of Al's life. From swimming laps at Sandy Beach to navigating his Day Sailor by Bassing Beach, he always found his way back to the water. Even well into his 90s, swimming was a quiet routine that remained part of him throughout nearly every stage of his life.

Beyond family and faith, Al's great passion was the arts. He brought his natural talent for painting and craftsmanship to many creative pursuits and eventually tried his hand a sign carving. It didn't take long before he found his way to carving wildfowl creating pieces so lifelike, they often had to be touched to believe they were made of wood. His work was featured in carving shows and frequently recognized at the Ward World Championship Wildfowl Carving Competition in Ocean City, Maryland. He generously shared his knowledge, encouraged fellow carvers, and donated his work to charity auctions.

Perhaps his greatest artistic legacy is the creativity he passed to his family. His children and grandchildren grew up watching him paint, carve, design, and create with his hands. He taught them curiosity, craftsmanship, generosity, and the simple joy of making something.

Al will be remembered not only for the things he made, but for the life he built alongside Joan and the family and community he loved. He showed his love in quiet ways by listening, helping, making, and simply showing up. For those lucky enough to know him, there was comfort in knowing Al was always there, with advice, a quick remark, a helping hand, or that mischievous smile.

His absence will be deeply felt, but his presence remains in the family he loved, the town he called home, and the many things he made and passed on to those who came after him.

Visitation will be held Wednesday, September 2, 2026, from 4-7pm, at the McNamara-Sparrell Funeral Home, 1 Summer Street, COHASSET, MA 02025. Relatives and friends invited to attend.

A Funeral Mass will be held on Thursday, September 3, 2026, at 10am, at St. Anthony of Padua Church, 2 Summer Street, Cohasset, MA. Interment to follow at Woodside Cemetery, Cohasset.

In lieu of flowers, remembrances in Al's name be made to the Glastonbury Abbey, at www.glastonburyabbey.org

BEITCH, Laurie Greenbaum

Beloved Wife, Mother, and Artist

Aged 71, died peacefully on August 23, 2026, surrounded by friends and family who loved her, after facing a rare form of Bone Cancer called Dedifferentiated Chondrosarcoma.

Born on her mother's 26th birthday, December 1, 1954 in Brookline, Massachusetts. Laurie was raised by her parents Max and Jane Greenbaum, alongside her little sister, Abby in Newton, Massachusetts. They loved going on family vacations to Mexico, South Florida, and all over New England. They enjoyed golfing, playing tennis, and celebrating festive occasions at the Spring Valley Country Club in Sharon, Massachusetts, where she would later marry the love of her life, Douglas Beitch. From a very young age, Laurie and her sister enjoyed many summers at Camp Mataponi in Naples, Maine.

Art was an integral part of Laurie's identity since girlhood. Her Great Aunt Julia encouraged her artistic pursuits by providing art supplies, sponsoring lessons, and bringing her to the Museum of Fine Arts in Boston, where she would set up an easel in the galleries and have her work critiqued. Her encouragement helped drive a lifetime of creative expression.

Laurie graduated from Newton South High School in 1972, already certain that art would play a central role in her life, turning a childhood fascination into a genuine calling.

Laurie brought her dream and talents to Cornell University's Fine Arts program (Class of 1976), where she studied under Magical Realist, Zevi Blum. She cherished her years at Cornell, both artistically and socially. Laurie brought her dream and talents to Cornell University's Fine Arts program (Class of 1976), where she studied under Magical Realist, Zevi Blum. She cherished her years at Cornell, both artistically and socially. She was a Delta Gamma and served as the Art Editor of the Student Newspaper. In her final months, she attended her 50th college reunion.

After graduation, she moved back to Boston to work at Linvure Company, her father's packaging factory. In their 20 years joyously working together, Laurie worked in the art room, mastered ink mixing, implemented a

new quality program, and ultimately found her stride in sales. When her father suffered a massive heart attack, she helped oversee the factory during his recovery. In her free time, she would sell antiques and paint Plein Air as much as she possibly could. She was entrepreneurial, resourceful, and unafraid.

She met her devoted husband of 37 years, Douglas Beitch, at a Jewish singles event on a snowy winter night in 1990 in Marblehead, Massachusetts. Together, they moved to Schenectady, New York (not her choice) and lovingly raised their daughters, Mollie and Sarah, who she protected and advocated for fiercely. She loved creating art with her daughters and their friends, and bringing them to museums. To this day, they will carry her love for art and culture.

Art, family, and Judaism remained a constant throughout Laurie's life. Eventually her husband and biggest fan encouraged her to pursue art full-time. Working primarily with pastels, she was drawn to landscapes, changing light, and the quiet beauty of the natural world. Laurie preferred to paint on location, believing that being present allowed her to capture the true color, atmosphere, and feeling of the place. Over the course of her career, she created hundreds of original works, exhibited extensively across the northeast, and earned Signature Membership in the Pastel Society of America, recognizing the skill she spent a lifetime developing.

Laurie's life, art, and legacy carried her from Massachusetts, to upstate New York, to Palm Beach, Florida, and eventually, Wilmington, North Carolina. Wherever she lived, she continued painting, exhibiting, and building friendships within the local arts and Jewish communities. She found beauty in her surroundings and made those places part of her story.

Beyond her professional accomplishments, Laurie was defined by the relationships she built and maintained. She was deeply loyal to the people she loved, forming



friendships that endured across decades. She was opinionated, funny, tenacious, and unmistakably herself. Her friends were an extension of her family, and she remained surrounded by many of them until the very end.

In her final years, Laurie faced a rare, painful, and aggressive bone cancer with extraordinary resilience and courage. Her illness was only one chapter in a much larger life, defined by art, love, and the enduring ability to find beauty in the world around her.

Laurie is survived by her husband, Douglas Beitch; her daughters, Mollie and Sarah Beitch; her sister Abby Greenbaum; her adorable granddogs, Noodle and Mr. Chex; and a wide circle of extended family and friends whose lives she touched throughout the years. She was predeceased by her beloved parents, Max and Jane Greenbaum, as well as her cherished dogs, Scampi and Dante, who held a special place in her heart.

Those wishing to honor Laurie's memory are encouraged to support research at Duke Sarcoma Center, Memorial Sloan Kettering, and/or the Johnston Health Foundation Hospice Fund.

Funeral Services will be held at Sharon Memorial Park Chapel, 40 Dedham Street, Sharon, MA on Friday, August 28, 2026 at 1PM. Interment to immediately follow.

Following the Service, family and friends are invited to gather for shiva at 5pm, where they will continue to honor Laurie's life.

Levine Chapels, Brookline
617.277.8300
www.levinechapels.com

CASTAGNETO, Lawrence
A. Jr.



Age 87, of Littleton, MA, passed away peacefully, on August 18, 2026.

Please visit www.badgerfuneral.com to view the full obituary.

Arrangements are under the care of Badger Funeral Home, A Life Celebration Home, 347 King St., LITTLETON, MA. Complete notice to appear on Sunday, August 23, 2026.

Visiting Hours: The Visitation will be held on Sunday, August 30, 2026, at 3:00 pm until 6:00 pm, at the Badger Funeral Home, 347 King Street, Littleton, Massachusetts. The Funeral Mass will be held on Monday, August 31, 2026, at 10:00 am, at the Blessed Trinity Parish - St Anne Church, 75 King Street, Littleton, Massachusetts. Burial will be private for family.



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CROWLEY, John J.Jr.,

Age 87, of Palm Beach, Florida, passed away on August 9, 2026. He was born on July 23, 1939, in Charlestown, Massachusetts, and raised there. John was the son of the late John J. Crowley, Sr. and Anna Mae (Murphy) Crowley. He was predeceased by his beloved wife of 49 years, Margaret “Margie” Gardocki-Crowley, who passed away on July 4th. He is survived by his brother, David Crowley of Melrose, Massachusetts; and his sister, Mary Anne (Crowley) Cozza of Mashpee, Massachusetts. John graduated from Boston College High School in 1957 and from Boston College in 1963. He earned his law degree from Suffolk University and went on to spend decades practicing law, primarily as a criminal defense attorney. Never one to be defined by a single career, he later founded and served as CEO of Flagship Cinemas, building it into a premier, independently owned movie theatre circuit. He often said he was “in the popcorn business”. One of his greatest joys in business and in life was negotiating a good deal. Over many years, John and Margie made their home in both the Boston area and Key West, and they especially cherished time spent boating in the waters of Vineyard Sound and Nantucket Sound. A skilled sailor, he was as at home on the water as anywhere. A voracious reader and lifelong student of history, John was fascinated by the great ocean liners and built a collection of recovered items from them over the years. Whether out on the ocean, seated at a Bridge table, or sharing stories over a good meal, John had a gift for finding joy in life's simple pleasures. John will be deeply missed by all who knew him. Notes of comfort may be made to his family, at www.chapmanfuneral.com

GROSSO, Mary E. (Mackin)

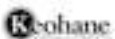


Of Norwell, formerly Hingham, passed away, August 24, 2026.

Mary was born and raised in New York. After meeting her husband, Daniel, they moved around during his medical residency, including living in Italy for five years, before settling in Hingham with their family. While raising her children, she volunteered for many organizations and was an advocate for those with intellectual disabilities and the elderly. Later in life, she went back to school and got her Master's degree in social work from Boston University and worked as a social worker for many years before retiring. Mary adored her family, especially being a Nana to her grandchildren. She enjoyed knitting, puzzles, gardening, reading, watching the Celtics, and time spent down the Cape. Mary will be remembered as graceful, determined, caring, and loving. She will be greatly missed by all who knew her.

Beloved wife of 46 years to the late Daniel L. Grosso, MD. Loving mother of Andrew Grosso and his wife, Tara Ann of Hull and Dan Grosso and his wife, Carrie of Knoxville, TN. Cherished sister of Margaret (Peggy) Adamo of Chappaqua, NY, Joseph Mackin and his wife, Deborah of Hawthorne, NY, and Patricia (Patty) Walsh of Norwalk, CT. Devoted Nana of Grace, Sophia, Will, and Daniel. Also survived by many nieces and nephews.

Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to greet the family during the Visiting Hours on Friday, August 28, 2026, from 4-8 PM, in the Pyne Keohane Funeral Home, 21 Emerald St. (off Central St.), HINGHAM. A Celebration of Life Service will be held in the funeral home at 9 AM, Saturday, August 29, 2026, prior to the Funeral Mass in St. Paul's Church, Hingham, at 10 AM. Burial in Hingham Cemetery, Hingham. In lieu of flowers, donations in memory of Mary may be made to the Parkinson's Foundation, 1350 Broadway, Ste. 1530, New York, NY 10018 or to Pat Roche Hospice Home, 86 Turkey Hill Lane, Hingham, MA 02043. See www.Keohane.com for directions and online condolences.



McCLUSKEY, J. Corby



 Of Roslindale, passed away on August 24, 2026. He was 89. Beloved husband of the late Antoinette M. “Toni” McCluskey (Sheehan). Loving father of Daniel J. McCluskey and his wife, Susan of Weymouth and Matthew S. McCluskey and his wife, Christine of Mansfield. Loving grandfather to Nolan C. McCluskey. Proud Veteran of the United States Marine Corps. Funeral from the William J. Gormley Funeral Home, 2055 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, on Tuesday, September 1, at 9am, followed by a Funeral Mass in St. John Chrysostom Church, 4750 Washington St., at 10am. Relatives and friends are kindly invited. Interment, MA National Cemetery, Bourne, at 1:30pm. In lieu of flowers, donations can be made to the Wounded Warrior Project, <https://support.woundedwarriorproject.org> For directions and guestbook, gormleyfuneral.com

William J. Gormley Funeral Service
617-323-8600

Funeral Services



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Remembered

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NEE, Robert Coleman “Coley”



 A lifelong resident of South Boston, passed away suddenly, on August 25, 2026, at Tufts Medical Center in Boston, with his family by his side. He was 84. Born on January 8, 1942, in Boston, Massachusetts, Coley was shaped by the city he loved and remained deeply connected to South Boston throughout his life.

Coley was educated in the Boston Public School system and went on to become a longtime pressman for The Boston Globe newspaper. He was also an Army Veteran of the Vietnam Era, a role that reflected his steady sense of duty and service. Those who knew him understood that he was a man of honesty and directness; you always knew where you stood with Coley. He loved catching up with friends, having a good time, and taking walks at Castle Island, simple pleasures that brought him happiness and kept him close to the people and places he cherished most.

Above all else, his family was his greatest accomplishment. He is survived by his daughter, Amanda Bausemer and her late husband, Daniel Bausemer; his son, Sean Nee and his wife, Katie. He was a proud and loving grandfather to Lila and Jack Bausemer, and to Thomas and Mary Nee. He is also survived by his sister, Peggy Doyle and her husband, Frank; as well as his sister-in-law, Susan Nee; and his brother-in-law, Joseph Casper. He also leaves behind many nieces, nephews, cousins, and friends who will remember him with affection and gratitude.

Coley was predeceased by his parents, Helen (Fitzgerald) and Joseph Nee, Sr.; brothers, William Nee, Joseph “DoDo” Nee, and James Nee; by William and his wife, Betty; and by his sister, Donna Casper. Their memories remained an important part of the family story he carried with him throughout his life.

Family and friends are invited to gather in remembrance during Visitation on Thursday, August 27, 2026, from 4:00 PM to 7:00 PM, at WM. F. Spencer Funeral Service, 575 E Broadway, SOUTH BOSTON, MA 02127. A Mass will be celebrated on Friday, August 28, 2026, from 10:00 AM to 11:00 AM, at Gate of Heaven Catholic Church, 615 E 4th St., Boston, MA 02127. Msgr. Kevin O’Leary officiating. Mass can be livestreamed at www.gateofheavenstrigid.org

Robert “Coley” Nee will be remembered for his loyalty to his family, his South Boston roots, his straightforward nature, and the easy companionship he shared with those around him. His presence will be deeply missed and warmly remembered by all who knew and loved him.

REMEIKA, Francis E



March 9, 1943 – August 22, 2026
Francis E. Remeika, 83, of Marblehead, Massachusetts, passed away peacefully, on August 22, 2026, at his home. Born in Cambridge, Massachusetts, on March 9, 1943, he was the son of the late Francis G. and Ida (née Wilcinski) Remeika.

Frank was a proud graduate of Cambridge High and Latin School and earned his bachelor’s degree from Boston College in Chestnut Hill, Massachusetts. An outstanding athlete in baseball and hockey at Cambridge High and Latin School, Frank later played varsity baseball at Boston College. He was inducted into the Cambridge Athletic Hall of Fame in 2012, as a member of the historic 1958 hockey team.

On July 27, 1979, Frank married Carole Ann Gallepeau. They shared 47 wonderful years of marriage together.

In 1991, Frank co-founded Mad River Management, a pioneering Boston-based fund of funds. Beyond his professional accomplishments, Frank was an avid skier who spent winters at Sugarbush, Vermont, with family and friends. A passionate private pilot, Frank found great joy in flying throughout New England. He was also a highly competitive golfer with his brothers and maintained a lifelong devotion to all things Boston sports.

He is survived by his wife, Carole; his son, Christopher (Julia) A. Remeika; his granddaughters, Isabelle F. and Sophia R. Remeika; his brothers, James (Ann) and John (Maureen) Remeika; his sister, Diane Lank (Remeika); and his sister-in-law, Claire Remeika. He was predeceased by his brother, Thomas Remeika. He also leaves behind numerous nieces, nephews, grandnieces, and grandnephews. He will be remembered for his unwavering love of his family.

A Mass of Christian Burial will take place at St. John the Evangelist, Massachusetts Avenue, Cambridge, on Saturday, August 29, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. Calling Hours will be held from 8:30 a.m. to 10:00 a.m., the same morning.

Interment will follow at Mount Auburn Cemetery, Cambridge. Relatives and friends are invited.



SHEA, Leah M. (Walsh)

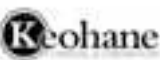


Of Quincy, passed away, August 24, 2026, surrounded by her loving family.

Leah was born in South Boston and spent summers in Rocky Nook Point in Kingston, where she met her husband, Larry. She was a devout Catholic and attended daily Mass. Leah and Larry walked the 500 miles for the Way of St. James (Camino) in Spain. She was a caring, compassionate, and a sweet woman with a beautiful smile and had many great friends. She will be deeply missed.

Beloved wife of 54 years to Lawrence M. Shea of Quincy. Devoted mother of Eva Shea of Quincy, Matthew Bailey Shea and his wife, Chelsea of Pittsford, NY, Gregory Shea and his wife, Ashley of North Andover, and the late Tessa Shea. Cherished sister of Joseph Walsh and his partner, Gayle of Punta Gorda, FL and the late Kit Walsh. Loving Granny of Kilian and Rory Bailey Shea and Kyler, Hannah, and Julie Shea. Also survived by many nieces and nephews.

Relatives and friends are respectfully invited to greet the family during the Visiting Hours on Thursday August 27, 2026, from 8:30-10 AM, in the Keohane Funeral Home, 785 Hancock St., QUINCY, followed by the Funeral Mass in Holy Trinity Parish at Our Lady of Good Counsel Church, Quincy, at 10:30 AM. Cremation will follow. Interment will be private. See www.Keohane.com full obituary, directions and online condolences.



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Obituaries



Mr. Curry (above center) originated the part of Dr. Frank-N-Furter in “The Rocky Horror Picture Show” on stage in 1973. He later played the same role in the 1975 screen adaptation. He also portrayed King Arthur in “Spamalot.”

Tim Curry, 80, actor best known for ‘Rocky Horror’ role

By Bruce Weber

NEW YORK TIMES

Tim Curry, the British-born actor whose gift for garish eccentricity lit up stage and screen, most notably as the outlandish, cross-dressing mad scientist in the midnight cult film “The Rocky Horror Picture Show,” died Tuesday at his home in Los Angeles. He was 80.

The death was confirmed by Marcia Hurwitz, his longtime manager. In 2012, Mr. Curry suffered a serious stroke, from which, he said last year, “I’ve been recovering for quite a long time.”

With a mischief-maker’s good looks, a casual athletic grace, and a supple and resonant voice, Mr. Curry was a favorite in roles calling for expressive villainy or general cartoonishness.

In the first screen version of “Annie” (1982), he brought more than a dollop of slime to the part of Rooster Hannigan, the con artist who concocts a plot to kidnap the plucky orphan of the title.

In “Clue” (1985), a suspense spoof derived from the popular board game, he played Wadsworth, a logorrheic butler who leads a cast full of murder suspects around a spooky mansion with the fast-talking fervor of a manic Sherlock Holmes.

In “Spamalot,” the stage musical based on the Monty Python troupe’s bottomlessly goofy retelling of the King Arthur legend, which opened on Broadway in 2005, he played Arthur himself and was nominated for a Tony Award. It was the most straight-faced role in the show, and yet, as Ben Brantley wrote in his review in The New York Times, he was “the best of the cast at translating classic Python style into a musical-comedy idiom.”

But no other role marked Mr. Curry’s career as emphatically as that of Dr. Frank-N-Furter, the “sweet transvestite from Transsexual, Transylvania,” as he proclaimed himself in “The Rocky Horror Picture Show.”

The 1975 screen adaptation of “The Rocky Horror Show” was based on the hit London stage musical that played for seven years in different theaters, and in which Mr. Curry originated the part in 1973. He also starred in the premiere American production in Los Angeles in 1974 and on Broadway in 1975, where it was a notable flop, closing after 45 performances.

A gleefully lurid send-up of the horror and science fiction genres, “Rocky Horror” tells the



EVAN AGOSTINI/GETTY IMAGES

story of a clean-cut couple with a flat tire on a rainy night that leaves them at the home of the good doctor, whose scientific work involves the creation of a monster with a muscular body and a handsome face as a sexy plaything for himself. The movie became a cult hit shown at midnight around the world for fans who dress in costume and sing along; it celebrated its 50th anniversary in 2025, and the stage show returned to Broadway earlier this year.

Mr. Curry’s performance opened many casting doors, and his Frank-N-Furter was the first of many threatening bad guys he played, finding a variety of hues — arch or giddy or resonantly mean — with which to color their evildoing.

They included Darkness, the embodiment of bass-voiced evil, in Ridley Scott’s 1985 horror fantasy “Legend”; Pennywise, a murderous demon posing as a clown, in the 1990 miniseries adapted from Stephen King’s mammoth horror novel “It”; and Cardinal Richelieu in “The Three Musketeers” (1993). As a greedy gazillionaire presumed to be the chief malefactor in “Charlie’s Angels,” the 2000 movie adaptation of the television series about three female detectives, Mr. Curry laid on the oily self-satisfaction until the moment he was killed by the real villain.

Appearing on Broadway in 1980 in “Amadeus,” Peter Shaffer’s portrayal of the rivalry between the Hapsburg court composer Antonio Salieri (Ian McKellen) and the upstart genius Mozart, Mr. Curry introduced American audiences to Shaffer’s shocking depiction of one of history’s most gifted composers as a vulgar libertine.

“It’s a marvelous role to play,” Mr. Curry told the Times. “It has such a terrific arc. Mozart starts out as an energetic little punk and ends up as a truly tragic figure. So you get to go from high

comedy to tragedy. This kind of role is a gift.”

The play won a Tony; Mr. Curry was nominated for best actor but lost to his castmate, McKellen.

His voice was perhaps the staunchest aspect of Mr. Curry’s talent. He may have been even more prolific as a disembodied performer — often giving voice to anthropomorphic animals — than he was in the flesh.

In “Valiant” (2005), an animated feature set during an ornithological version of World War II, he was the intimidating General Von Talon, a hook-billed hawk wearing an eye patch. He played a haughty gray cat named Fluffy with an imperious French accent in “A Turtle’s Tale: Sammy’s Adventures” (2010), and Terrence, a flamboyantly expressive toucan with a multihued beak, in “Ribbit” (2014), the story of an insecure tree frog.

Timothy James Curry was born April 19, 1946, in Grappenhall, England. His father, Jim, was a Methodist chaplain in the British navy; his mother, Maura Patricia (Langmead) Curry, was a secretary.

He was 12 when his father died. “By the time I was 15 or so, I knew that acting was what I wanted to do,” he told The Washington Post in 1988. “And then I spent a long time trying to talk myself out of it, because everybody else was trying to. Particularly my widowed mother, who didn’t have very much money. She would have preferred a secure profession for me, and quite rightly, I guess, from her point of view.”

He acted in school and attended the University of Birmingham, graduating in 1968, before moving to London, where he earned a place in a new musical, “Hair.” He appeared in other productions in London and Glasgow before being cast in “Rocky Horror.”

“I couldn’t make up my mind



NEW YORK TIMES/FILE 2025

whether to be a singer or an actor,” he told the Los Angeles Times in 1974. “Although in ‘Hair’ they never let me sing that much, because the score was fairly high and I didn’t have a high enough voice.”

He added: “I was offered things, recording contracts, offered to join groups. But as I thought about it, I got rather snippy. No, no, no, I decided, I want to be an actor.”

Mr. Curry leaves no immediate survivors. He never married and resolutely declined to discuss his private life.

“I guarantee you, if it matters, that I have experienced true love, true heartbreak and everything in between, including no small amount of wreckage,” he wrote in his 2025 memoir, “Vagabond.” “Which, naturally, helps inform who I am. I have loved and been loved and I hope you have, too. But I’m not interested in your romances.”

When Fox aired a new made-for-TV version of “The Rocky Horror Picture Show” in 2016, Mr. Curry had a small part as the narrator; Laverne Cox played Frank-N-Furter. Although the mad doctor would become Mr. Curry’s signature role, he initially had doubts about taking it.

“I was hesitant in that, if it worked, it might be a difficult image to shake off,” he said in a television interview in England just as “The Rocky Horror Picture Show” was opening in 1975. “But then, really, I’ve always thought it wasn’t worth doing unless you took a risk, really. So I just took the risk.”

Forty years later, when he received a lifetime achievement award from the Actors Fund, Los Angeles magazine asked him to reflect on his career-making role. How did he look at it in retrospect?

“With a sort of bemused tolerance,” he said. “It’s neither a blessing nor a curse. I was lucky to get it.”

Robert Skidelsky, 86, definitive biographer of Keynes

NEW YORK TIMES

Robert Skidelsky, a British economic historian and political maverick whose monumental three-volume biography of John Maynard Keynes restored the economist to the center of public debate after decades in which free-market ideas had eclipsed him, died on April 15. He was 86.

His death was confirmed by the University of Warwick, where Dr. Skidelsky began teaching in 1978 and became an emeritus professor of political economy in 2006. No further details were provided.

Born in Japanese-controlled Manchuria to a family of Rus-

sian origin, interned as a child during World War II, and educated at Oxford, Dr. Skidelsky ranged widely across the worlds of scholarship, journalism, politics, think tanks, and business, and over the years was affiliated with several political parties.

His independence could come across as principled, contrarian, or simply exasperating, depending on the observer and the issue. His first major biography, a sympathetic 1975 study of Oswald Mosley, the leader of Britain’s prewar fascist movement, nearly destroyed his academic career. Decades later, he was criticized for his ties to Russian companies

and wealthy Russians and for arguing that Western policies, including NATO’s expansion, had contributed to Russia’s hostility toward Ukraine.

But his reputation rested overwhelmingly on his biography of Keynes. Published in three volumes from 1983 to 2000, it was widely regarded as the definitive account of the economist’s life and one of the most important intellectual biographies of its time.

Dr. Skidelsky began the project just as Keynes, who played a key role in designing the postwar international financial system, was falling out of favor. The

inflation and stagnation of the 1970s had discredited Keynesian management, which called for active government intervention in the economy, in the eyes of many economists and political leaders. Margaret Thatcher, the prime minister of Britain, and President Reagan in the United States promoted deregulation, privatization, lower taxes, and faith in the self-correcting power of markets.

Dr. Skidelsky’s wife, the former Augusta Hope, whom he married in 1970, survives him, along with their children, Edward, William, and Juliet Skidelsky, and six grandchildren.

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TV CRITIC'S CORNER

BY MATT JUUL



JOHN RUSSELL/AP/FILE

Dolly Parton (pictured in 2005) died this week at age 80.

5 movies starring Dolly Parton you can stream now

Country music legend and acclaimed entertainer Dolly Parton died at the age of 80, her family announced on Tuesday. As fans of the late star look back on her impact and legacy, here are five films featuring Parton as an actress that are now available to stream.

‘9 to 5’

This 1980 comedy spawned one of Parton's most iconic roles as well as the equally iconic title song . “9 to 5” stars Parton along with Jane Fonda and Lily Tomlin as a trio of secretaries who want revenge on their bad boss. Directed by Colin Higgins, the film earned Parton an Oscar nomination for best original song for “9 to 5.” *Available on Philo*

‘Blue Valley Songbird’

Based on the song of the same name from her 1998 album “Hungry Again,” the 1999 TV movie “Blue Valley Songbird” stars Parton as a struggling country singer stuck with an overbearing manager and boyfriend. The film also stars John Terry, Billy Dean, and Beth Grant. *Available on Prime Video and Tubi*

‘Gnomeo & Juliet’

Parton has a small voice-acting cameo in the Shakespeare-inspired 2011 animated family flick “Gnomeo & Juliet.” The country singer and actress voices the appropriately named “Dolly Gnome.” *Available on Disney+*

‘Steel Magnolias’

Another Parton classic, 1989’s “Steel Magnolias,” stars the late icon as the beloved salon owner at the heart of the close-knit group of women featured in this small town tale. The film, which earned Julia Roberts a best supporting actress Oscar nomination, also starred Sally Field, Shirley MacLaine, and Daryl Hannah. *Available on Paramount+ and Pluto TV*

‘Unlikely Angel’

Parton plays a country singer who can’t enter heaven until she completes a good deed for Christmas in the 1996 holiday comedy “Unlikely Angel.” The film also starred Roddy McDowall and Brian Kerwin. *Available on Pluto TV and Tubi*

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

ASKING ERIC

Adult child of friends ruins parties

Q. We are an empty-nester couple in our 50s. We entertain often, and in one group is a couple who have an adult child, W, who lives with them. This couple frequently asks if W is invited too. We always say yes. The problem is that W tends to put a significant damper on gatherings. They never engage in conversation, literally zero other than to answer direct questions.

It might not be so obvious they weren’t engaging if it weren’t for the fact they always seem to choose a seat in the middle of things — middle of the table or the room or the couch, whatever — which makes it awkward, sometimes painfully so, to hold a conversation around them.

When I’m cooking in my too-small-for-more-than-one kitchen, W will absolutely reliably take the stool at the kitchen pass-through and turn their back to me to listen to those standing around outside the kitchen, which makes it difficult for others to easily engage with me.

I don’t think W intends any rudeness. I think they’re just taking whatever looks to them like the most appealing seat without thinking much about it.

I don’t know what to do. I want to be kind, but this has been going on for years and I find it draining and anticipate the request to include W with something increasingly approaching dread every time we entertain this group.

I think it's possible W is neurodivergent, although no one has ever told me that, which of course would call for even more kindness.

Is there any kind way to solve this? What possible way can you ask someone to sit somewhere less central without being unkind?

NOT ENJOYING THE PARTY

A. Try bringing this up with W's parents and ask if they can think of a way that W might be better integrated into gatherings. They're likely used to W's social habits and are, hopefully, adept at helping their child to move through the world.

You can also try putting out name cards at place settings the next time you entertain. This would allow you to mix and match people in whatever way you want. Not only could this enhance W's experience at the dinners, but it could give the rest of the guests a chance to engage with folks they otherwise might not.

Q. Forty-five years ago, I married a widow with two sons. They are now grown with children of their own. My wife and I have been supportive of them and their families.

When one son was depressed over early hair loss, we got him counseling and a hair trans-

plant. When he got colon cancer, I called often, giving him emotional support. I have been encouraging and offered guidance to his sons while they attended college. Upon their graduations, I sent them congratulatory cards with a substantial monetary gift.

I have provided my other son with thousands of dollars without expecting repayment when the IRS came calling because he hadn't filed taxes for eight years. Before his wife suffered an early death from brain cancer, over the months she was hospitalized, I called him frequently providing emotional support and took him out for lunch or dinner.

After my wife, their mother, suffered a stroke, she was confined to bed for nine years while I was her caretaker. The sons and grandchildren visited only on “obligatory” holidays like Mother’s Day or Christmas. They rarely offered me emotional support.

Since my wife passed, I’ve heard crickets from them. None of them calling, coming by, or inviting me to dinner to get out of my now lonely, empty house.

I am considering moving across the country, not even telling them, and —as they are not my blood — ceasing any relationship with them.

What do you think?

NO CALLS

A. Your family has gone through so much; I’m very sorry.

Your expectations of your stepsons aren’t unreasonable at all. When loved ones are ailing or in need, you show up, you call, you support.

It’s not clear from your letter whether you’ve ever had a conversation with them about your expectations or asked them to be more present. But even if you haven’t, there’s obviously a disconnect on your stepsons’ parts that’s not your responsibility to fix.

It may make the most sense to release this expectation and get support elsewhere. If you do so, however, consider closing this chapter with acceptance. This will help you move forward with less resentment.

Acknowledge that this is who your stepsons are, the relationships you have with them are not the relationships you want, you wish it was different, but you accept that it’s not.

You might even choose to tell them this in a letter. But mostly this is a practice for yourself and your peace.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Thursday August 27, 2026

Thursday August 27, 2026								Movies		Sports	
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News	R. Steves	This Old House Old House	POV "Brief Tender Light"			Bussing Legacy	Amanpour and Company (N)		
4	WBZ CBS	Game Day	Jeopardy!	Big Brother "Episode 25 -- 1000th Episode" (N) (Live)		Ghosts	Elsbeth "Foiled Again"	News (N)	(:35) Comics		
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Sports (Live)	NFL Football New England Patriots at Cleveland Browns From Huntington Bank Field in Cleveland. (Live)				NewsCenter 5	(:35) J. Kimmel		
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live		
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud	Family Feud	7 News at 9PM (N)		7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	(:35) Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Football New England Patriots at Cleveland Browns (Live)				News (N)	J.Kimmel		
10	NBC Boston	Boston News (N)	Hollywood (N)	Law & Order "Never Say Goodbye"		Law & Order: SVU "Old Friends"		Law & Order "Fate's Cruel Joke"	Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon	
10	WJAR NBC	News (N) (Live)	Extra (N)	Law & Order "Never Say Goodbye"		Law & Order: SVU "Old Friends"		Law & Order "Fate's Cruel Joke"	News (N) (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon	
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Life-Pangea	Windows	Granite State (N)	Call of the Canyon: Zion National Park		Southwestern Gems	Amanpour and Company (N)		
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel of Fortune	Jeopardy!	Big Brother "Episode 25 -- 1000th Episode" (N) (Live)		Ghosts	Elsbeth "Foiled Again"	12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics		
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	The 1% Club "Hot Wife"		Best Med "A Tale of Two Sister Cities"		Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (N) (Live)	(:35) News (N)	
27	WUNI	Rosa "Una flor marchita" (N)		Tan cerca de ti, nace el amor (N)		Guardián de mi vida (N)		Corazón "Secretos familiares" (N)	Noticias Univisión	SaborDe/ (:35) Noti..	
36	WSBE PBS	Cook's Country	Story-Public Sq	Women of World War II: The Untold Stories			Woody Guthrie at 100! Live at the Kennedy Center			PBS News Hour	
38	WSBK	Wheel of Fortune	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)		48 Hours (N)		Perfect	Perfect	Patriots Fifth Quarter	
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Shakespea		TURN: Washington "Men of Blood"		Astrid	PBS News Hour (N)		
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide		Homicide Hunt		Crime Stories	Unusual Suspects		
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Trivial Pursuit "House Rules"		Scrabble "Feeling Pumped"		7 News at 10PM on CW56	Modern Family	Modern Family	
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud	Family Feud	The 1% Club "Hot Wife"		Best Med "A Tale of Two Sister Cities"		12 News on Fox Pr	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	
68	WBXP ION	FBI "Redoubt"		FBI "Shelter"		FBI "Manhunt"		FBI "Unearth"	FBI "Hitched"		
PREMIUM CABLE											
Cinemax	(5:45) ★★★ X-Men: First Class '11)	(5:55) ★★ Rampage '18) Dwayne Johnson.			(4:55) ★★ The Transporter Refueled '15) Ed Skrein.			(2:20) ★★ Tomb Raider '18)			
Flix	(5:00) ★★★ The Godfather '72)	★★★ The Aviator '04) Cate Blanchett, Kate Beckinsale, Leonardo DiCaprio.				★★★ The Doors '91) Val Kilmer.					
HBO	(6:40) Conan O' Winkler, Bob Odenkirk.	(2:55) ★★ Normal '25) Henry Winkler, Bob Odenkirk.			Monsters of God (N)		(:55) Monsters	(5:50) Lanterns		(:45) Monsters	
HBO 2	(5:55) ★★ The Dark Knight Rises '12) Christian Bale.	(4:40) ★★ Amy '15) The life and career of singer/songwriter Amy Winehouse.			(5:50) Conan O'Brien Must Go		(3:55) Murder ...				
Paramount-Sho	(6:25) The Dutchman '25)	★★ You've Got Mail '98) Meg Ryan, Parker Posey, Tom Hanks.				You're Dating a Narcissist! '25) Marisa Tomei.			(3:55) The Friend		
Showtime 2	(5:45) ★★ The Lovely Bones '09)	★★★ Forrest Gump '94) Robin Wright, Sinise, Tom Hanks.			Gary Harris, Nicholas Hamilton.						
Starz!	(6:25) No Good De...)	(5:50) ★★ White House Down '13) Jamie Foxx, Maggie Gyllenhaal, Channing Tatum.					(4:05) Fightland		★★★ Flight '12) Denzel Washington.		
TMC	(5:55) ★★ Bridget Jones's Baby '16)	Not Without Hope '25) Josh Duhamel, Quentin Plair, Zachary Levi.				(4:05) ★★ Walking Out '17) Josh Wiggins, Matt Bomer.			(4:45) Shakesp...		
SPORTS											
CBSSN	(6:00) FIH	Women's Cup Semifinal: Teams TBA (N)			BIG3 Basketball Boston Ball Hogs at Dallas Power (N)			World Poker Tour			
ESPN	2026 Little League Baseball World Series Game 34: Teams TBA (N) (Live)				Football	CFB Studio	ESPN Films		SportsCenter (N) (Live)		
ESPN2	(6:00) Stars of the Open (N) (Live)				ESPN Documentales Shooting Stars (N)		ESPN .	30 for 30 Catholics vs. Convicts			
Fox Sports 1	MLB Baseball Los Angeles Dodgers at Atlanta Braves From Truist Park in Atlanta. (N) (Live)					Post-game (N)	SPEED With (N)	Kevin H Hour (N)	Travis		
Golf	2026 TOUR Championship First Round From East Lake Golf Club in Atlanta.										
NBA	To Be Announced			Top 50		Top 100 Dunks		Top 50	NBA Playback		
NBC Sports	Pregame Live (N) (Live)		Basketball - BSN Santeros de Aguada vs. Vaqueros de Bayamón Final, Game 7.			Boston Sports (N) (Live)		Boston Sports			
NESN	(6:00) Minor League Baseball			Chat (N)		Charlie Moore 30		Travel	New Eng.		
FAMILY											
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty	
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug	
Encore Family	(1:15) ★ Norbit '07) Eddie Murphy.				Finn on the Fly '08)			(4:45) Yellowbird '14)			
Nickelodeon	★★ Sing 2 '21) Matthew McConaughey.				Friends		Big Bang	BigBang	BigBang	BigBang	
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L Strong language; S Sexual activity; V Violence; HD High-Definition; (CC) Close-Captioned

	News		Specials								
	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30	
BASIC CABLE											
A&E	Accused: Guilty or Innocent?		Accused: Guilty or Innocent?		Accused: Guilty or Innocent? (N) (SF)		Accused: Guilty or Innocent?		(:05) Accused: Guilty or Innocent?		
AMC	(6:30) ★★ I, Robot '04)		Will Smith.		TNA iMPACT! (Live)				★★★ The Rock '96)		
Animal Planet	Pit Bulls-Parole "Freedom Fighters"		Pit Bulls-Parole "Buried Alive"		Pit Bulls "Storm on the Horizon"		Pit Bulls-Parole "A Family Affair"		Pit Bulls-Parole "Storm Surge"		
BBC America	★★ Major League '89) Tom Berenger. ★ Major League II '94) Charlie Sheen.										
BET	(6:40) Celebrity	(:50) Phil McGraw, Garry Marshall	★ Anaconda '97) Ice Cube, Jon Voight, Jennifer Lopez.						Martin	(:35) Martin	
Bravo	Housewives/OC "All Bets Are Off"		Housewives/OC (N)		The Real Housewives		Housewives/OC		The Real Housewives		
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls	
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360 (N)		The Source With (N)		CNN NewsNight (N)		Laura (Live)		
Comedy Central	The Office		(:35) The Office	(:10) The Office	(:45) The Office	(:20) The Office		(:55) The Office	The Office	Family Guy	
CSPAN	(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime			C-SPAN Primetime					
CSPAN2	POTUS	TBA	(05) Obama Pr. (N)		British /(:10) America		POTUS	(25) Sen. Lindsey Graham (N)			
Dest. America	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	
Discovery	Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		
Discovery Life	Crack Addicts		Take My Tumor		Take My Tumor		Take My Tumor		Take My Tumor		
E!	(6:00) ★★ Sex and the City '08)				★★ Sex and the City 2 '10) Kim Cattrall, Sarah Jessica Parker.						
Encore	(5:50) ★★ Shooter		★★ Jack Reacher '12) Tom Cruise.			(:15) ★★ Jack Reacher: Never Go Back					
Food	Beat Bobby	Beat Bobby	Restaurant Im. "A Taste of Peru" (N)			Secret Service "Dahlak" (N)		Kitchen Nightmares "Juicy Box"			
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (N) (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News (Live)		
Freeform	(:55) ★★ The Parent Trap '98)		Dennis Quaid, Lindsay Lohan.		Project Runway (N)		The 700 Club				
FUSE	Dolly Parton:		Deadly Love: Bobby & Whitney			Stevie Nicks: Wild at Heart			Cheaters Cheaters		
FX	(6:00) Guardians of the Galaxy Vol. 2				Adults	Adults	(:10) ★★ Venom '18)		Tom Hardy.		
FXM	(:05) Resident Evil: Welcome to Raccoon City				(15) ★★ Antlers '21)		Keri Russell.		Resident Evil: Welco...		
Hallmark	(6:00) Love on the SL...		Garage Sale "The Mask Murder"				Gold Girls Gold Girls		Gold Girls Gold Girls		
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Aurora		Aurora "A Game of Cat and Mouse"				Murder, She Wrote		Murder, She Wrote		
HGTV	(6:00) Totally	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House (N) Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	House Hunters	
History	Mysteries "Great Cities"		Engineering from Above "Fortresses"		Engineering from "For the Gods"		(:05) Engineerin "Superstars" (N)		(:05) Mysteries "Desert Mysteries"		
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	
HSN	MariaWynne (N)		Gotta See (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		The List (N) (Live)		Clarks (N) (Live)		
ID	Who Hired the "Dead Body Shop"		Married to Evil "A Deadly Dose"		A Killer "Murder Lasts Forever"		Game Day Murders "Last Chance High"		Murder-Friday "Dirty Little Lies"		
IFC	Two Men Two Men		Two Men Two Men		Two Men Two Men		Two Men Two Men		Two Men Two Men		
Lifetime	NCIS "Kill Ari"		NCIS "Mind Games"		NCIS "Silver War"		(:05) NCIS "Switch"		(:05) NCIS		
LMN	(6:00) Last Woman ...		Three Housewives and a Body '26)				Secret Lives of Suburban Housewives				
MAGN	Off the Grid		Insane Pools		Insane Pools		Insane Pools		Insane Pools		
MSNBC	The Weeknight (N)		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)		
MTV	Jersey Shore		Jersey Shore (N)		Jersey Shore		Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone				
National Geographic	Hidden Beneath the Cities		Hidden "Tunnels and Tombs"		Hidden Beneath the Cities		Hidden Beneath the Cities		Hidden Beneath the Cities		
NatGeoWild	Life Below Zero		Life Below Zero		Life Below Zero		Life Below Zero		Port Protection (N)		
NECN	News NBCYOU		Dateline		Dateline		Rescue OpenHou...		1st Look Rescue		
NewsNation	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		Jesse Web		
Ovation	Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		Doc Martin		
OWN	Videos		Videos		★★ Lean on Me '89) Morgan Freeman. (P)				First-Time		
Oxygen	Dateline "On a Dark, Deserted Highway"				Dateline: Unforgettable				Unforgettable		
Paramount	(6:00) ★★ ★ Top Gun: Maverick '22)				(:10) ★★ ★ Top Gun: Maverick '22) Miles Teller, Tom Cruise.						
QVC	H Reflect (N) (Live)		Your Fall (N) (Live)		Inside Q (Live)		Fall For Deals (N) (Live)				
Science	Greatest Myst.		Greatest Myst.		Greatest Myst.		Greatest Myst.		Greatest Myst.		
Sundance	Law & Order "Doped"		Law & Order "For the Defense"		Law & Order "Shotgun"		Law & Order "Fed"		Law & Order "Blackmail"		
SyFy	(6:00) ★★ ★ The Matrix '99)				★★★ The Matrix Reloaded '03) Keanu Reeves.						
TBS	Big Bang Big Bang		Big Bang Big Bang		Big Bang Big Bang		Jokers	Jokers	Jokes (N)	Jokers	
TCM	(6:00) Watch on the...		★★★★ All About Eve '50) Bette Davis.				★★★ The Cateder Affair '56)				
TLC	Last Resort		Last Resort (N)		1000-lb Roomies (N)		Baylen Out Loud (N)		Double Lives		
TNT	(5:00) Jurassic Worl...		Women's College Volleyball Spikes Under the Lights (Live)						Matrix Resurrections		
Travel	Alaska Haunting		Jack Osbourne's Night of Terror: UFOs				UFOs in Alaska				
TruTV	(5:30) Gridiron Gang		Women's College Volleyball Spikes Under the Lights (Live)						Dunkman Finals		
TV Land	Raymond Raymond		Raymond Raymond		(:20) Raymond		Raymond Raymond		King	King	
TV One	CosbySh... CosbySh...		Uncensored		Different Different		Different Different		Different Different		
USA	Law & Order: SVU "Venom"		★★ Fast X '23) Michelle Rodriguez, Tyrese Gibson, Vin Diesel.				★★ Fast X '23) Vin Diesel.				
VH-1	My Wife My Wife		★★ The Taking of Pelham 123 '09)				★ Anaconda '97)				
WE	NCIS		NCIS "Missing"		NCIS		NCIS		NCIS "Reveille"		

New Union Oyster House owners worldwide players

Texas family’s hospitality holdings include restaurants, casinos, dozens of brands

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

After nearly six decades under the same family’s ownership, Boston’s iconic Union Oyster House is about to become part of one of the country’s largest hospitality empires.

For two centuries, Union Oyster House has been quintessentially Bos-

ton; since 1970, it has been owned by North End native Joe Milano. Founded in 1826, the iconic establishment has long been a mainstay of Boston’s culinary scene, frequented by luminaries such as Daniel Webster and President John F. Kennedy.

The Fertitta family of Houston, Texas, is in the process of acquiring the

restaurant, according to a spokesperson. The family’s hospitality holdings include Landry’s, which is owned by hospitality and casino magnate Tilman Fertitta. It operates dozens of brands and hundreds of properties across the globe, including the NBA’s Houston Rockets and Golden Nugget Casinos. However, Patrick Fertitta, Tilman Fertitta’s son, is leading this transaction, according to a family spokesperson.

“This is a family acquisition. OYSTER HOUSE, Page D2



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/FILE 2025

The Fertitta family of Houston, Texas, is in the process of acquiring Boston’s iconic Union Oyster House.



PHOTOS BY JOE SINHAVONG/SEAMLESS PHOTOGRAPHY

The interior of Terrain, a new sprawling home and garden lifestyle store by the Anthropologie Group, in Wayland.

GARDEN CENTER? WEDDING VENUE? CAFE?

What exactly is Terrain?



The ceremony room inside Terrain’s event venue space. It is the Anthropologie-owned brand’s first Massachusetts location.

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

WAYLAND — You could go for a plant. You could also go for a latte, a woodsy-smelling candle, a wreath, a wedding, or to arrange for someone to come decorate your house for the holidays.

That’s the idea behind Terrain, a sprawling garden and home store owned by Anthropologie Group, which is opening its fifth stand-alone shop in the country in Wayland next month. It’s the brand’s first Massachusetts location.

Water trickles from a fountain, candles scent the air, and plants spill out in every corner of the store alongside piles of pottery, garden tools, decor, and items for elaborate tablescapes. The space, inside a former Whole Foods, is arranged like an artistic bohemian jungle that’s part nursery, part home store, part café, and part event venue, where the point is not just to attract shoppers, but to give them reasons to stay.

“Here’s a space where people are going to host their weddings, their most important life events,” said Candan Erenguc, Anthropologie’s chief operating officer. “The impetus is to create a beautiful space.”

While a core of Anthropologie’s business is women’s apparel and accessories, it has increasingly built its creative identity around art, home, wellness, and experiences. Executives talk about selling a lifestyle that’s

TERRAIN, Page D2

Kalshi bets on teaming up with the Red Sox

Prediction-market firm partnering with five MLB franchises

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

The walls of Fenway Park are getting a little crowded with sports gambling options, now that Kalshi has joined the fray and added its logo to stadium signs.

Except with Kalshi in mind, please don’t call it sports betting.

The New York-based company runs a prediction market, in which players bet against other players instead of the “house,” and it refers to bets on its platform as “trades.” These are important legal distinctions because prediction markets are currently regulated at the federal level, by the Commodity Futures Trading Commission, while traditional

‘We’re thrilled to be working with the Red Sox, [who have] an engaged fan base, particularly this year.’

ADAM BARRICK, *Kalshi official*

sports betting is under the purview of the states.

This distinction is being challenged in the courts, including in Massachusetts. In the meantime, big sports-betting players such as Boston-based DraftKings (also a Red Sox sponsor) and FanDuel have launched their own prediction markets to enter states that have not yet legalized traditional sports betting. Prediction markets also go beyond sporting events, to encompass bets on everything from world affairs to pop culture.

Adam Barrick, head of sports partnerships at Kalshi, said his company’s signs have been up at Fenway Park for a few weeks. However, Kalshi waited until Tuesday to announce its multi-year Red Sox partnership, to time it with announcements about similar partnerships with the Atlanta Braves, Los Angeles Dodgers, San Diego Padres, and San Francisco Giants. (Red Sox principal owner John Henry is also publisher and owner of The Boston Globe.)

“We’re thrilled to be working with

KALSHI, Page D4

Northeastern delays construction of athletic facility after asbestos found

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Memories apparently aren’t the only thing Matthews Arena left behind on the campus of Northeastern University.

Asbestos-containing materials found by crews tearing down the old arena have delayed construction of a new athletic center by about nine months, university officials wrote in an email Tuesday.

The school’s new Multipurpose Athletics and Recreation Facility is now set to be completed in the spring or summer of 2029, rather than the fall of

2028, according to Brett Sweet, senior vice president for finance and administration.

The construction delay was first reported by The Huntington News, Northeastern’s independent student newspaper.

Asbestos-containing material was discovered at the construction site upon excavation, prompting a suspension of work and a consultation with the state’s Department of Environmental Protection, Sweet wrote.

The material was likely left from the original construction of Matthews Arena in 1910.

The 115-year-old building once briefly served as the home of the Boston Celtics and Boston Bruins, and later became home to Northeastern men’s basketball and the men’s and women’s hockey teams.

The arena was recognized as the world’s oldest multipurpose athletic building and the oldest arena still in use for hockey. It was demolished in March.

“I want to assure you that we are taking every precaution to protect the health and safety of everyone on or near the site,” Sweet wrote, according

NORTHEASTERN, Page D4

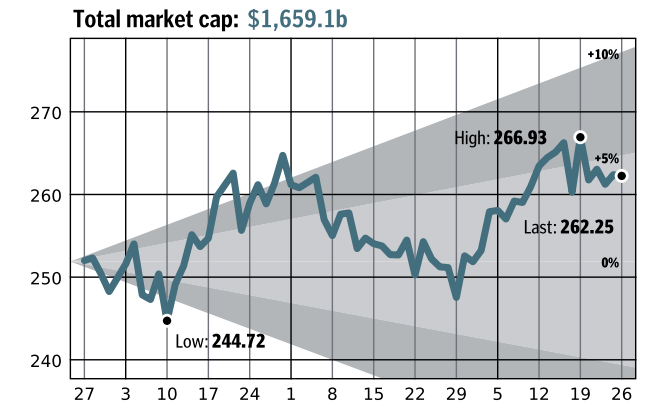


DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Demolition of the Matthews Arena, formerly Boston Arena. The asbestos-containing material was likely left from the original construction in 1910.



Globe 25 index



Yesterday 262.25 ▼ 0.15 ▼ 0.1% ▲ YTD 8.3%

	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	953.09	+26.36	+2.8	253.8
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	633.71	+5.56	+0.9	234.3
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	371.80	-1.86	-0.5	180.2
TJX COS INC (TJX)	136.83	-2.65	-1.9	151.2
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	547.29	-5.56	-1.0	138.7
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	175.73	-2.84	-1.6	81.9
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	48.17	-1.69	-3.4	69.8
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	149.66	-9.17	-5.8	59.7
TERADYNE INC (TER)	363.10	-3.33	-0.9	56.8
STATE ST CORP (STT)	193.62	+0.67	+0.3	53.2
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	32.20	+0.37	+1.1	43.8
WATERS CORP (WAT)	414.17	-0.27	-0.1	40.7
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	121.43	+0.53	+0.4	36.1
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	221.07	+0.30	+0.1	32.7
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	239.00	-1.08	-0.4	32.0
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	71.67	+0.64	+0.9	27.0
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	40.61	+0.20	+0.5	24.6
VERALTO CORP (VLTQ)	98.69	-0.08	-0.1	24.1
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	142.46	+3.59	+2.6	21.8
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	272.66	+6.39	+2.4	20.8
MKS INC (MKS)	271.75	+1.27	+0.5	18.4
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	313.67	+5.19	+1.7	16.6
PTC INC (PTC)	151.61	+0.47	+0.3	16.5
AKAMAI TECHNOLOG (AKAM)	108.06	+2.32	+2.2	15.5
VICOR CORP (VICR)	197.23	+2.61	+1.3	9.1

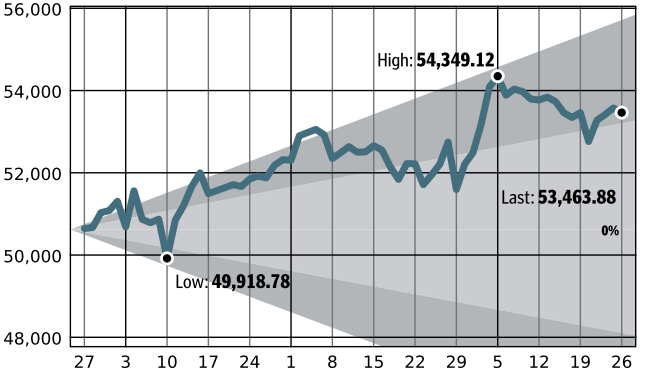
Markets

Quiet before the AI storm

The US stock market drifted through a quiet day of trading Wednesday after a report said inflation was a touch worse last month than economists expected. Yields in the bond market, home to some of Wall Street’s biggest recent worries, edged higher following the data. Stocks made relatively few big moves ahead of the latest earnings report from the market’s most influential company, Nvidia, which arrived after trading ended for the day. Expectations were high once again for the chip giant, whose tremendous growth in profit because of the AI boom has made it the largest stock by value in the US market. After soaring for years, AI stocks have become shakier on worries that their prices shot too high and that demand for chips may fizzle out if AI does not produce as much profit as hoped. Strong profit growth across US companies broadly has been the main reason the US stock market has run to records this year. Abercrombie & Fitch leaped 35.7 percent after reporting a stronger profit for the latest quarter than analysts expected. J.M. Smucker climbed 4.3 percent after likewise reporting of sweeter results than expected for the spring.

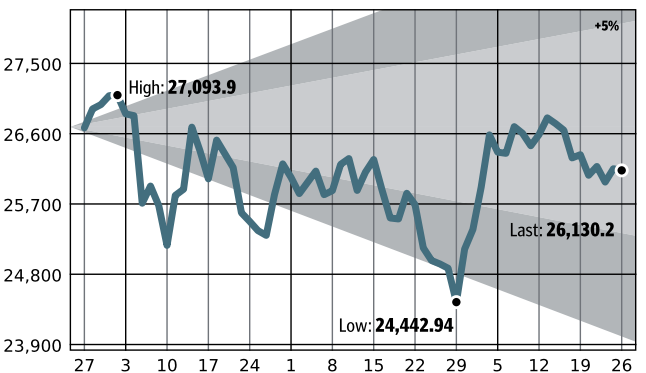
— ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average



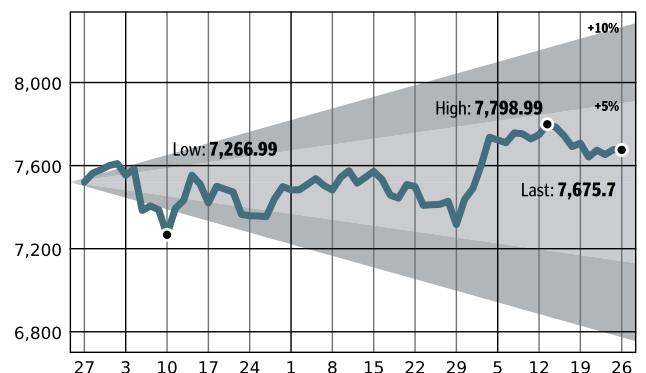
Yesterday 53,463.88 ▼ 113.52 ▼ 0.2% ▲ YTD 11.2%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 26,130.20 ▼ 21.10 ▼ 0.1% ▲ YTD 12.4%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,675.70 ▼ 1.58 ▼ 0.0% ▲ YTD 12.1%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Terrain bets big on lingering shoppers

►TERRAIN
Continued from Page D1

beyond the transactional world of retail. That’s also the philosophy that catapulted founder Richard “Dick” Hayne’s companies for decades, making them multibillion-dollar brands.

Hayne cofounded Urban Outfitters in the 1970s and launched Anthropologie in 1992 with the idea that retailers could become destinations. Terrain takes that concept further. It’s where customers could purchase a plant, then stay for coffee, book a wedding, hire someone to decorate their home, and even return for dinner. For Terrain, it also means giving customers more reasons to spend time — and money — within their orbit.

Artists literally design the store and even go foraging to incorporate wild plants into hanging suspensions and archways.

They sell a wide variety of hard-to-find plants: Grammatophyllum orchids, considered rare and exotic, that produce cascading spikes with yellow-green flowers and purplish-red spots. Dark, near-black foliage from Begonia varieties. Unique cacti and droopy-petaled echinaceas that are more common in prairies than in the Northeast. In the nursery, they sell their “Big Sur” collection, which they’ve dubbed “vacation resistant.” (If you would describe yourself as having a black thumb, start here.)

They offer design services for weddings and events, but specialists will also come to your home to decorate, design door-step or window boxes, or simply make a centerpiece for a Thanksgiving table.

But it’s not all about the flowers and foliage. During a walk-through earlier this week with a Globe reporter, executives pointed to Halloween decorations: black rattan witch hats and brooms, suspended from the ceiling and illuminated with twinkling lights. Cream-colored plates with icons of slithering snakes, a leaping



JOE SINTHAVONG/SEAMLESS PHOTOGRAPHY

The outside of Terrain, a new sprawling home and garden lifestyle store by the Anthropologie Group, in Wayland. It’s the brand’s first Massachusetts location.

toad, and a crow. During the holiday season, Christmas takes over with a fresh tree lot, wreaths, and all sorts of gifts for nature lovers.

“I’ve been in it my whole career. When I joined Terrain, the team kept telling me about the store at Christmas, and I was like, ‘I’m a jaded retailer. I’ve seen it all,’” said Beth Smith, Terrain’s managing director. “And when I walked in that first day after they set the floor, it was like nothing I’ve seen. It is pretty magical.”

The idea for Terrain began in 2008, when Hayne gathered a group of plant, home, and design enthusiasts who became the company’s first employees. They acquired the J. Franklin Styer’s nursery in Pennsylvania, an old-school horticultural institution that dates back to 1890, and transformed it into Terrain at Styer’s.

Not long after, customers began requesting to host weddings there, where couples could exchange vows beneath towering sycamore trees and surrounded by blooms. What

started as an offshoot has become a significant part of their business. Two days after opening, the Wayland store will host their first wedding.

“We started taking bookings in December,” said Brianna Alcorn, director of sales and marketing.

They blew out the walls of what used to be a windowless corner, and now natural light streams through large windows into the reception room, adorned with plant chandeliers and trees sprouting from the middle of the wood floors. It can fit up to 178 guests. Of the company’s five stores, Wayland’s is the first to offer an indoor ceremony room and private dual dressing suites. (An average 100-person wedding, dependent on a variety of factors, could cost about \$30,000, food included, said Alcorn.)

The venue is beside Terrain’s nursery and a 170-seat café with antique hutches from Belgium and France, and a 12-foot Ficus Amstel King tree in the center of the dining room. They serve brunch and dinner, source-

ing ingredients from New England’s farms and purveyors: specialty meats from Savenor’s Butchery, coffee from Jim’s Organic Coffee, green lettuce from Little Leaf Farms, and milk and butter from Arethusa Farm in Litchfield, Conn.

The company has long had its sights on Boston, a top market for Anthropologie customers. While many retailers are trying to make shopping faster and easier, Terrain is betting there’s still value in making people slow down.

“It’s about inspiring the customer, giving her an opportunity to explore,” said Lisa Burke, a regional director for the Anthropologie Group. “I’m always amazed by how long people spend in our stores.

“Even for us,” she added, while motioning to a group of executives surrounded by greenery, “As much as we know it, we’re still discovering as we move through the store to constantly find something new.”

Alexa Gagosz can be reached at alexa.gagosz@globe.com.

What to know about new Union Oyster House crew

►OYSTER HOUSE
Continued from Page D1

Tilman is not involved,” Katelyn Roche Gosslee, a family representative, told the Globe on Wednesday.

In a statement, Milano called the Fertitta family “a highly respected family that shares our deep commitment to preserving the restaurant’s rich heritage, cherished traditions, and historic significance.”

The incoming management group is registered to the same Texas address as Landry’s, the Houston-based hospitality company that Tilman Fertitta owns. Terms of the deal were not disclosed.

Here’s what you should know about the new owners.

The Fertittas are one of America’s biggest restaurant families (and already own places in Boston)

Tilman Fertitta built Landry’s, originally a handful of Houston-area seafood restaurants he acquired from two brothers, into a sprawling hospitality company with more than 600 properties, more than 60 restaurant concepts, and operations across more than 15 countries, according to the company. Their portfolio includes many restaurants that already exist in Boston, including Morton’s, Chart House, Del Frisco’s Double Eagle Steakhouse, and Palm. In 2012, Forbes dubbed Tilman Fertitta “the world’s richest restaurateur” at a net worth of more than \$10.8 billion.

Who is Patrick Fertitta, Tilman Fertitta’s son?

Patrick Fertitta, who is in his early 30s, is the director of Fertitta Entertainment, the holding company behind the family’s sprawling hospitality interests. In December, the Houston Chronicle reported he is a key decision-maker at the Rockets and oversees operations at the companies many properties, including Landry’s and the casinos, while his father serves as the US ambassador to Italy and San Marino.

Texas Governor Greg Abbott appointed Patrick Fertitta to the University of Houston System Board of Regents, which his father chaired until last year. He also serves as an alternate governor on the NBA board of governors, and was recognized in 2024 on The Athletic’s “NBA 40 Under 40” list as one of the league’s top emerging leaders.

It’s unclear whether the billionaire’s son has any ties to Union Oyster House or Bos-

ton. He earned his bachelor of business administration from the University of Southern California’s Marshall School of Business. He lives in Houston.

Landry’s historic strategy in acquisitions: Buy cheap, reorganize management

Tilman Fertitta is considered to have an eye for gobbling up poorly managed, out-of-date and distressed restaurants, hotels, and casinos that he can acquire cheaply. It’s unclear what the total sale price was for Union Oyster House.

In past transactions of chains, the Fertittas have been known to clean house by firing top executives, closing failing locations, revamping existing ones, and moving the company’s top management teams to Landry’s headquarters.

“When we buy somebody, we cut the head off,” Tilman Fertitta told Forbes in 2012.

Milano, Union Oyster House’s longtime owner, said in a statement that the Fertittas “have made it clear that their intention is to honor and protect what makes this restaurant so special.”

“They have assured me that they will not be making changes to our operations or traditions,” said Milano, who has served as the Honorary Consul General to Thailand in Boston since 2002. “Most importantly, they have expressed a strong commitment to retaining our current team and keeping everyone in place.”

Fertitta’s spokesperson said after the transaction closes, the Fertitta family will not make changes to staff or operations.

Elizabeth Pisano, an attorney representing the family, said during a city licensing board hearing on Wednesday that Kathleen Street will serve as the restaurant’s manager. She has worked for Union Oyster House for 30 years, said Pisano.

The Fertittas are on a buying spree

The family was already running a major hospitality empire, but it’s been getting a whole lot bigger. In May, Fertitta Entertainment, a conglomerate that holds companies and investments such as Landry’s Inc., the Houston Rockets, and the Golden Nuggets Hotel and Casino brand, agreed to acquire Caesars Entertainment for about \$17.6 billion. In the deal’s announcement, they also assumed approximately \$11.9 billion of Caesars’ outstanding debt.

Also in May, Tilman Fertitta paid \$300



GIANNI CIPRIANO/THE NEW YORK TIMES

American ambassador to Italy Tilman Fertitta (left) greeted Cefal, Sicily Mayor Daniele Tumminello last month.

million to the Mohegan Sun tribe for the WNBA’s Connecticut Sun. The Sun are now wrapping up their final season in Uncasville before the franchise relocates to Texas where they’ll be renamed the Houston Comets. That ruffled the feathers of some basketball fans in New England after Commissioner Cathy Engelbert and Co. declined to take former Celtics minority owner Steve Pagliuca up on his offer to buy the cash-strapped franchise for \$325 million.

Tilman Fertitta is a current ambassador, and has long had business ties to Trump

Tilman Fertitta, who is of Sicilian descent, is currently the US ambassador to Italy and San Marino. In December 2024, when then president-elect Trump announced the nomination of Fertitta, he referred to the businessman as his “twin.”

The Texan and his wife, Lauren Fertitta, have donated substantially to Trump in the past. During the 2024 election cycle, Tilman Fertitta donated \$1.4 million to Trump-aligned campaign committees. His wife donated \$924,600 to the Trump 47 Committee. He was also among the wealthy Republican supporters who helped host a reception around Trump’s 2025 inauguration, serving as a co-host alongside Mark Zuckerberg, Dallas Mavericks owner Miriam Adelson, and others.

His ties to the current president also go beyond politics. Tilman Fertitta purchased the Trump Marina Hotel Casino in Atlantic City in 2011 for \$38 million, about a tenth of what Trump Entertainment was offering the casino at the time. It was rebranded as the Golden Nugget.

Alexa Gagosz can be reached at alexa.gagosz@globe.com. Follow her @alexagagosz and on Instagram @AlexaGagosz.

TALKING POINTS

CYBERSECURITY

CYBERATTACK HITS BOSTON SCIENTIFIC; OPERATIONS AFFECTED

Boston Scientific said on Wednesday that a cybersecurity incident had disrupted global operations, including some information systems used to process and ship customer orders. The Marlborough-based medical device maker said it detected the incident on Tuesday and had activated incident-response procedures, working with third-party cybersecurity specialists to investigate and contain the threat. Shares of the company fell about 3.4 percent in Wednesday trading. The incident is the latest in a series of cyberattacks to hit the health care sector, with medical device makers Abbott Laboratories, Stryker, and Medtronic, health insurer Clover Health, drugmaker Novo Nordisk, and drug-delivery equipment supplier West Pharmaceutical Services among those recently hit. The attack is expected to continue affecting parts of the company’s business while recovery efforts are underway, Boston Scientific said. Boston Scientific said it has not determined whether the incident was reasonably likely to have a material impact on its business. An investigation is ongoing, but the full scope and nature of the incident have not yet been determined, the company said.

— REUTERS

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

GATES WARNS AI IS MORE DANGEROUS THAN BIG TECH WILL ADMIT



Bill Gates, the billionaire co-founder of Microsoft, is loudly warning that artificial intelligence poses a grave threat to jobs and human life, and that urgently addressing the risks should be “the world’s top priority.” In an hourlong interview with The New York Times last week, Gates said the tech industry was knowingly downplaying those threats because there was too much money on the line. “In private, people who understand how good this stuff is, and how much better it’s getting, they’re very worried,” he said. But few tech executives, Gates said, are willing to publicly admit that. “They’re now saying to each other:

‘Hey, man, don’t say that. It’s bad for us — the next trillion dollars we’re trying to raise.’” On Wednesday, Gates published a nearly 6,000-word essay on his personal website laying out his concerns about AI and offering solutions, such as new taxes and bans. He said he was motivated to speak now because recent improvements in AI had far surpassed his expectations and because the industry had ignored technology milestones — like AI’s escaping the control of its creators or making recipes for bioweapons — that it once said would warrant more caution. “They’re just full speed ahead and hoping that the good outweighs the bad,” he said.

— NEW YORK TIMES

GOVERNMENT

TRUMP WANTS BILLION-DOLLAR BUSINESSES TO QUALIFY AS ‘SMALL’



The Small Business Administration is seeking to vastly expand the definition of small businesses, aiming to give much larger companies access to government contracts, loans, and other assistance. The proposal, which the Trump administration says would allow businesses to continue to benefit from the agency’s programs as they grow, amounts to a sweeping overhaul of standards that have changed little in decades. Many business owners support some increase in the limits on revenue and employees that determine what qualifies as a small business. But the scale of the proposed increase would also place small businesses in direct competition with significantly larger rivals for contracts and loans, raising alarms that the agency could hamstring the very businesses it was created to help.

In some industries, such as financial investment services, companies could earn up to \$1 billion or employ more than 3,000 people, more than some publicly traded corporations. The highest current cap for most industries is annual revenue of up to \$47 million or fewer than 1,500 employees. Caitlin O’Dea, a spokesperson for the Small Business Administration, said the changes “would reward growth, strengthen domestic production, and rebuild key supply chains — which is essential to restoring American industrial dominance and national security.” The agency is soliciting public comments through Sept. 21, which O’Dea said it would review before issuing a final rule. By law, 23 percent of federal contracting dollars are supposed to go to business designated as “small.” The measure differs by industry. The SBA said in its proposal that the modified size standards would increase the number of businesses classified as small by roughly 114,500.

— NEW YORK TIMES

ECONOMY

INFLATION REMAINS ELEVATED AS ENERGY COSTS PUSH ON PRICES



The stubborn US inflation problem did not get much worse in July. It did not get any better, either. Consumer prices were up 3.7 percent in July from a year earlier, according to the Federal Reserve’s preferred measure of inflation, the personal consumption expenditure price index. That was the same rate as in June and still well above the Fed’s target of 2 percent annual inflation. Core prices, a measure that strips out the volatile food and energy categories, were up 3.3 percent from a year earlier, also unchanged from June. Policymakers often focus on the core measure because it can give a more reliable indication of how inflation will behave in the months ahead. On a monthly basis, overall prices were up 0.2 percent in July, reversing a slight decline in prices in June. Core prices also rose 0.2 percent. The data, released by the Bureau of Economic Analysis on Wednesday, highlighted the tricky position Fed policymakers face as they weigh whether to raise interest rates at their meeting next month. Inflation jumped this spring after President Trump led the United States into war with Iran, which pushed up energy prices around the world. It has eased somewhat since then, and there have been few signs that higher oil prices are filtering through to the economy more broadly, apart from some isolated categories such as fares.

— NEW YORK TIMES

FOOD

GENERAL MILLS DITCHES ARTIFICIAL COLORS AS LUCKY CHARMS, TRIX GO AU NATUREL

General Mills said Wednesday it has removed artificial colors from all its US cereals, including Lucky Charms and Trix. The Minneapolis company has shifted to fruit- and vegetable-based dyes as well as colors derived from spices like turmeric and paprika to give its cereals their customary bright colors. General Mills said 90 percent of its US retail products are now free of artificial dyes. Products that still contain artificial colors, like some Betty Crocker cake mixes and Fruit Roll-Ups, will transition to natural dyes by the end of 2027, the company said. General Mills is the second big cereal maker to announce a transition to natural dyes. WK Kellogg, which makes Froot Loops and Apple Jacks, said earlier this month that it will remove artificial colors from all its US cereals by the end of this year.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

MEDIA

FORBES, SHOOK RESEARCH SUSPEND RANKINGS AMID PROBE OF \$6M PAYMENT



Forbes and Shook Research, a major partner of the magazine, said on Tuesday that they would suspend the rankings and events they produced together as they dealt with the widening fallout from a \$6 million payment from the firm’s founder to the publication’s top editor. Forbes and Shook Research have worked together for years to publish rankings of the top wealth advisers in the United States. They have also produced an annual summit in Las Vegas, which was scheduled this year for mid-October and in the past drew executives from top financial firms, including Goldman Sachs, JPMorgan Chase, BlackRock, and Apollo. The New York Times reported this month that Forbes’s top editor, Randall Lane, had been fired after the publication learned that he had taken a \$6 million payment from RJ Shook, the founder of Shook Research. Shook said Monday that he had paid Lane for services that included helping to sell a controlling stake in Shook Research to a private equity firm, PPC Enterprises, last August. Lane has described the payment as a “gift” and said that failing to disclose it to Forbes was a “serious error in judgment.” Shook left Shook Research sometime after the sale. Forbes CEO Sherry Phillips said in a memo to employees Tuesday that the suspension of the magazine’s activities with Shook would last through the end of the year. “We remain confident in the integrity of the rankings, but we recognize that there is a need to restore trust with the adviser community, partners, and audiences,” Phillips said in a statement. Phillips also said in her statement that Forbes was “exploring all appropriate actions” to hold Lane “to full account.” On Monday, she told staff that it had hired counsel to conduct an independent review of the matter. Shook Research sent financial firms a joint message with Forbes on Tuesday explaining the decision to suspend its rankings, saying it was “the right next step, both for the strength of our research going forward and for the value our listings and events provide.”

— NEW YORK TIMES

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FDA approves drug for pancreatic cancer

By Adam Feuerstein and Angus Chen
STAT

The Food and Drug Administration on Wednesday approved a life-extending treatment for advanced pancreatic cancer — a medicine made by the biotech company Revolution Medicines that is the first to attack a genetic cause of the aggressive, highly lethal malignancy.

The drug, called daraxonrasib, will be sold under the brand name Rasonque. The FDA’s approval was supported by a practice-changing clinical trial that read out earlier this year. Patients with advanced pancreatic cancer who received Rasonque as a second-line treatment achieved a median overall survival of 13.2 months, compared to 6.7 months for patients offered standard chemotherapy.

“It will be transformative in the way we treat pancreas cancer. It’s the biggest development we’ve had in pancreas cancer in decades,” said Andrew Ko, a medical oncologist specializing in gastrointestinal cancers at the University of California San Francisco. “I’m so thankful for this as an advance for our patients.”

With the approval, pancreatic cancer patients will be able to receive the drug after at least one line of therapy, or if they are not candidates for initial chemotherapy, the FDA said.

“This is a monumental step forward for patients,” Revolution chief executive Mark Goldsmith told STAT in an interview ahead of the approval. In the past, he noted, physicians treating patients with pancreatic cancer no longer responsive to chemotherapy had few options. “More chemo. Something that wasn’t working. They gave you more of it,” he said.

In a statement, acting FDA Commissioner Kyle Diamantas said, “Today’s approval provides a critical new option for patients facing an extraordinarily difficult and historically hard-to-treat cancer. It is our fundamental duty to deliver more cures and meaningful treatments to patients as quickly as possible.”

The clinical success and approval of Rasonque has transformed Revolution into one of the biotech sector’s most richly

valued companies. More than 2,000 pancreatic cancer patients have already been prescribed the drug under an expanded access program — demand that is expected to convert quickly into blockbuster commercial sales.

Revolution has not yet disclosed Rasonque’s price.

The therapy has also established Revolution Medicines as a leader in targeted cancer drug development. Rasonque plus other treatments in the company’s research pipeline could have expanded benefits for patients with lung, colon, and other types of cancer.

“One thing that will happen as a consequence of this approval is it really cements RevMed and daraxonrasib as the standard by which everyone else will position themselves,” said Channing Der, a cancer researcher at the University of North Carolina Chapel Hill.

Pancreatic cancer has been one of the hardest cancers to treat, as new therapies have done little over the years to budge the 8 percent five-year survival rate.

Scientists had identified a mutation in a gene called KRAS as the cancer’s Achilles heel. Mutations in this gene, along with the other two RAS family genes, can drive the growth and development of cancers. KRAS mutations fuel over 90 percent of pancreatic cancers, and it had long been hypothesized that drugs targeting this mutation would throttle off the cancer.

But researchers had tried and failed to target the RAS proteins for decades, as the proteins’ surfaces were incredibly difficult to bind using small molecules. It was considered an undruggable “greasy ball.” One technology that defeated this challenge came from a scientist named Gregory Verdine.

Verdine used a concept found in nature called “molecular glues.” Here, a small molecule first binds to a different protein, reshaping it in a way that would cause it to stick to RAS and form a “tricomplex” of the drug and the two proteins.

That technology became the basis for daraxonrasib, which is able to target all the mutated and unmutated forms of RAS.

Judge blocks Trump’s HUD fund overhaul

By Nate Raymond
REUTERS

A federal judge on Wednesday blocked President Trump from restructuring a federal grant program to redirect money away from over 100 nonprofit organizations that had historically received funding to help prevent and investigate housing discrimination.

US District Judge Myong Joun in Boston ruled that the US Department of Housing and Urban Development had failed to provide a reasoned explanation for its decision to implement “sweeping changes” to a decades-old grant program run by the agency designed to combat housing discrimination.

HUD did not respond to a request for comment.

The judge, an appointee of President Biden, said that Congress had long recognized the need to provide funding for fair housing organizations to help support the work of HUD, which had funded them through multiyear grants.

Yet he said HUD in July upended that system of enforcing the Fair Housing Act by announcing it would not allocate any of its congressionally appropriated funding for the 2025 fiscal year to private enforcement initiatives or to multiyear grants issued through the Fair Housing Initiatives Program, or FHIP, which Congress created in 1987.

In the past, HUD would typically award more than 100 grants ranging from \$75,000 to \$425,000, according to lawyers for several fair housing groups, including the National Fair Housing Alliance that sued over the changes in July.

HUD instead planned to use \$46 million of the \$56 million that Congress had appropriated for five grants, \$25 million of which would go to a law school. The remaining \$10 million to a state or local agency.

“The effect of HUD’s restructuring effectively bars the very housing organizations that have been effectuating FHIP’s mission year after year since its enactment,” Joun said.

The Trump administration also sought to force grant recipients to sign onto unrelated conditions to receive funding, by imposing requirements that they not use any funding to support “gender ideology” or “illegal immigration.”

HUD had argued it had the discretion to impose those conditions and that the changes it was making to the grant program were part of a large-scale modernization effort designed to broaden participation.

But Joun said that “pithy description falls woefully short of the mark in both form and substance,” and that it was “hard to see how or where defendants relied on relevant data in crafting these changes.”

Ties between US, Canada extend deep in economies

By Rob Gillies
ASSOCIATED PRESS

TORONTO — President Trump says his country does not need Canada. But every day, roughly 4 million barrels of Canadian crude oil flow south, helping fuel American cars, trucks, and airplanes, and supply US industry.

And oil is only the beginning. Canada also supplies aluminum, potash to US farms, and parts for an auto industry built on both sides of the border. “WE DON’T NEED CANADA, THEY NEED US!” Trump posted this week, repeating his long-running claim. Yet Trump has imposed a 50 percent tariff on Canadian aluminum while acknowledging this week that the United States badly needs the metal.

“This country desperately needs aluminum,” Trump said. “We don’t have it. We get it all from Canada for the most part, and we need it badly.”

The contradiction underscores how deeply the two economies remain intertwined — and how much could be at stake if Trump’s trade war reaches more of the energy, materials, and supply chains that the US still relies on Canada to provide.

Canada is the United States’ second-largest trading partner after Mexico and energy is at the heart of that relationship.

The two countries exchanged about \$872 billion in goods and services last year. Canadian crude imports equal nearly 20 percent of total US petroleum consumption, according to the US Energy Information Administration, part of the Department of Energy.

Daniel Béland, a political science professor at McGill University, said Trump’s claim that the United States does not need Canada is “absolutely false,” citing US

reliance on Canadian oil and natural gas and deeply integrated industries such as autos.

Much of Canada’s crude flows to Midwest refineries built to process its heavy oil into gasoline, diesel, and jet fuel.

Energy also explains much of the US trade deficit with Canada, which Trump frequently cites as evidence of an unfair relationship.

The White House this week portrayed the relationship in starkly negative terms, saying Canada had taken roughly \$50 billion a year from the United States over the past decade. Much of that gap reflects US purchases of Canadian energy, which helps power the US economy. And Canada’s heavy crude typically trades at a discount to US benchmark oil, according to the US Energy Information Administration.

Energy more than accounted for last year’s \$48.3 billion goods deficit. Without energy, the United States would have run a trade surplus.

After trade talks collapsed last Friday, the US imposed 50 percent tariffs on about \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods. The measures cover only about 5 percent of Canadian exports to the United States and exclude energy.

For now, using oil as a weapon in trade negotiations remains a remote possibility. Alberta Premier Danielle Smith opposes restricting energy exports, arguing that doing so would hurt her province.

But former Alberta premier Jason Kenney said Canada should not rule out export taxes on oil, fuel, or potash if Trump escalates further.

Such retaliation “would affect Republicans who drive F-150s and lay fertilizer on their farm fields,” Kenney said.

“They should be mindful that if they really want to escalate, it will



GENE J. PUSKAR/ASSOCIATED PRESS

New 50 percent tariffs on \$20 billion in exports that President Trump levied against Canada have been reciprocated by the US’s northern neighbor, including on oil, aluminum, and potash.

not end well for the American economy two months before midterm elections,” he said.

Ontario Premier Doug Ford cited Canadian commodities as leverage, accusing Trump of “putting out fake news” about the United States not needing Canada. He called potash used by US farmers “one of the most powerful tools we have” and said Washington would have to turn to suppliers such as Russia if Canada redirected shipments.

Saskatchewan Premier Scott Moe rejected that approach, saying his province “cannot and will not support” export tariffs on resources.

He said Saskatchewan is on track to supply about half the world’s potash and warned that taxing exports could cost Canadian jobs, raise fertilizer prices, and push US buyers toward suppliers such as Belarus.

“This would be a tremendously

flawed policy on behalf of Canadians,” Moe said.

Moe has backed a more targeted retaliation, saying Saskatchewan will impose a 50 percent reciprocal charge on US alcohol beginning Sept. 8 after initially being one of only two provinces that kept American alcohol on store shelves.

Kenney stopped short of advocating an export tax on oil, and Béland said such a move would probably be “a very divisive issue politically in provinces like Alberta and Saskatchewan.”

That underscores the limits of Canada’s leverage: measures aimed at hurting US industries could also hurt Canadian producers and strain political unity at home.

Canada has long been the dominant foreign source of aluminum for the United States. Smelting the metal requires enormous amounts of electricity, giving hydro-rich Canada a major advantage.

Another new player at Fenway: Kalshi

► **KALSHI**
Continued from Page D1

the Red Sox, [who have] an engaged fan base, particularly this year, with them going on a playoff run,” Barrick said. “They’ve made quite a comeback this year.”

As the team’s “official prediction market partner,” Kalshi will be featured in digital signs throughout Fenway Park, along with static signs behind home plate, Barrick said, plus engagements with the Sox on social media platforms and on the WEEI radio station. Kalshi didn’t disclose terms of the deal.

The Green Monster wall already features the logos of BetMGM (the team’s “official sports betting partner”) and DraftKings (the “official fantasy sports partner”). A spokesperson for DraftK-

ings declined to comment, and BetMGM didn’t respond to a request for comment.

The Sox issued a brief statement saying the team is looking forward to working with Kalshi.

Kalshi said prediction-market “trades” involving baseball are up 36 percent on its platform this year, compared with the same time last year. The five partnerships are Kalshi’s first Major League Baseball sponsorships, though it does already have partnerships with several National Hockey League teams.

Barrick is well aware that state Attorney General Andrea Campbell won a federal court order in January, blocking Kalshi from offering sports-related contracts in Massachusetts. Campbell is among the state attorneys general



KALSHI

who argue Kalshi’s trades are a form of sports betting and should be regulated at the state level. Campbell’s order is on hold while the case is being appealed.

“We’re fully operational in the state,” Barrick said. “There’s obviously an active discourse in the state right now around our product but we didn’t have [any] hesitation in terms of working with the Red Sox with that going on.”

Jon Chesto can be reached at jon.chesto@globe.com. Follow him @jonchesto.

Kalshi’s signs have been up at Fenway Park for a few weeks, but the firm waited until this week to announce its multi-year Red Sox partnership, to time it with announcements about similar deals with four other MLB teams.

Northeastern delays new athletic facility due to asbestos

► **NORTHEASTERN**
Continued from Page D1

to The Huntington News. “Going forward, construction crews will be trained in additional safety procedures and will wear protective equipment throughout this phase of work. We are also monitoring air quality around the perimeter of the site and will continue to do so throughout the excavation and foundation phases of construction.”

The asbestos discovery confirms the results of testing conducted in 2024 by Haley & Aldrich, an environmental engineering firm. The firm reported concentrations of lead, asbestos, and other toxic chemicals within the soil after surveying the Matthews Arena lot.

The new facility, which Northeastern estimated will cost \$300 to \$350 million, will house North-

eastern’s men’s and women’s hockey and basketball teams and provide space for student recreation, club sports, and intramural programs, the university said.

The project also aims to become a national model for sustainable sports facilities.

The arena is designed to be fossil fuel-free, with amenities including a hybrid heating system, rooftop solar array, and a high-performance building facade to improve energy efficiency, the university said. It will also feature a 100,000-gallon cistern to collect rainwater for ice making and irrigation.

The development will also include improvements to surrounding streets and landscaping, according to the university.

Lauren Albano can be reached at lauren.albano@globe.com. Follow her on X @LaurenAlbano_.

Mass. retailers sue to halt ban on kratom sales before it takes effect

By Alison Kuznitz
STATE HOUSE NEWS SERVICE

Four Massachusetts retailers that sell kratom have filed a lawsuit seeking to block an emergency order from taking effect this Friday that would temporarily classify all products derived from the Southeast Asian plant as a Schedule I drug.

The complaint against the Department of Public Health and DPH Commissioner Robbie Goldstein contends that Goldstein lacked the authority to place kratom into Schedule I, failed to satisfy state requirements to justify the emergency order, and too broadly applied the order to all kratom products rather than synthetic derivatives that pose greater health risks.

The retailers filed the lawsuit in Suffolk County Superior Court last Friday. They include Rihaan Corporation, which does business as Jay’s Smoke Shop in Salem; Bhakti LLC in North Billerica; V & K Smoke Shop LLC in Quincy; and Ambreen & S Inc. in Bellingham. They’re represented by California- and Washington-based attorneys with Kilpatrick Townsend & Stockton.

State health officials had not yet filed a response as of Wednesday, and no hearing date has been scheduled.

Governor Maura Healey and Goldstein announced the emergency order concerning kratom sales Aug. 13, giving convenience stores, gas stations, and other commercial establishments about a two-week period to remove all forms of kratom products from their shelves.

“I’m doing this because I care a lot about people’s health and safety, particularly the health and safety of young



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Four Massachusetts retailers have sued Public Health Commissioner Robbie Goldstein claiming he doesn’t have the authority to ban kratom.

people,” Healey later told reporters. “And parents shouldn’t have to be afraid that their kids are going to walk into some gas station or a convenience store and buy something that looks harmless that later they ingest or use with other substances that leaves them in really bad shape, including death.”

A DPH spokesperson said Wednesday afternoon that the department had not been served with the lawsuit. It is unclear how the complaint may interfere with the order that’s supposed to take effect in two days. The plaintiffs are seeking a temporary restraining order, followed by a hearing and preliminary injunction that bars local authorities from enforcing the kratom order until a decision is made in the case.

“Residents across Massachusetts have raised serious concerns about dan-

gerous kratom products being sold in smoke shops, convenience stores, and gas stations, often in forms that are easily accessible to young people,” the DPH spokesperson said. “These products are not FDA-approved for medical use, are sold without consistent safety standards, and can vary widely in their ingredients and potency, leaving consumers with no reliable way to know what they are taking.”

In its press release, the Healey administration warned that unregulated kratom products can lead to physical dependence and withdrawal symptoms that are similar to opioid withdrawal. While derived from a leafy tropical plant, kratom can be mixed with “highly concentrated” and lab-modified compounds that “can have significantly stronger opioid-like effects,” the admin-

istration said.

Goldstein’s order calls kratom an “imminent hazard to the public safety.” The US Drug Enforcement Administration last month filed notices of intent to temporarily place the alkaloid 7-hydroxymitragynine, which is naturally occurring within the kratom plant, and three related substances into Schedule I of the Controlled Substances Act.

Beyond conforming with federal scheduling, state law outlines another pathway for the DPH commissioner to temporarily classify dangerous drugs. The commissioner needs to make three key findings: The substance has a “high potential for abuse,” it has “no currently accepted medical use in treatment in the United States,” and there’s a “lack of accepted safety for use of the substance under medical supervision,” according to the lawsuit.

In a core argument in the lawsuit, the plaintiffs say Goldstein did not sufficiently establish those findings, which makes his order “invalid.”

“Plaintiffs do not dispute that some kratom products raise genuine public-health concerns, that some products are marketed irresponsibly, or that the Commonwealth may lawfully regulate them—through labeling requirements, potency limits, age restrictions, testing requirements, or targeted scheduling of concentrated and synthetic derivatives,” the lawsuit says. “Plaintiffs’ claims concern whether the commissioner complied with the statutes that govern how the Commonwealth may declare a substance a Schedule I controlled substance, and whether the regulation he adopted is supported by the reasons he

gave.”

The DPH order delegates monitoring and enforcement responsibilities to municipalities. Local boards of health, inspection departments, and municipal governments are authorized to pursue “any enforcement action consistent with a finding of an imminent health hazard,” including a summary suspension of a business’s license or permit to operate.

The lawsuit says that enforcement mechanism could deprive the plaintiffs of their due process rights, contending the order “prescribes no notice, no pre-suspension opportunity to be heard, no post-suspension hearing within any specified period, no standards governing the exercise of that discretion, and no mechanism for prompt review.”

Come Friday, the plaintiffs say the DPH order will turn their store inventories into “contraband” and that removing kratom products will cause “immediate and substantial loss.” The plaintiffs add they will suffer “imminent and irreparable harm,” including losing customer relationships and facing “reputational consequences” from being designated an imminent health hazard.

Massachusetts has recorded more than 100 kratom-associated deaths since 2020, according to the order. The Massachusetts and Rhode Island Poison Center has reported about 130 kratom-related calls from January 2021 through July 29, 2026, and this year’s volume so far is nearly equal to all calls made in 2025.

The lawsuit says that public health data does not “describe a sudden emergency.



DOONESBURY by Garry Trudeau



DUSTIN by Steve Kelley & Jeff Parker



RED & ROVER by Brian Basset



ARCTIC CIRCLE by Alex Hallatt



FOR BETTER OR FOR WORSE by Lynn Johnston



CURTIS by Ray Billingsley



RHYMES WITH ORANGE by Hilary Price



ARLO & JANIS by Jimmy Johnson



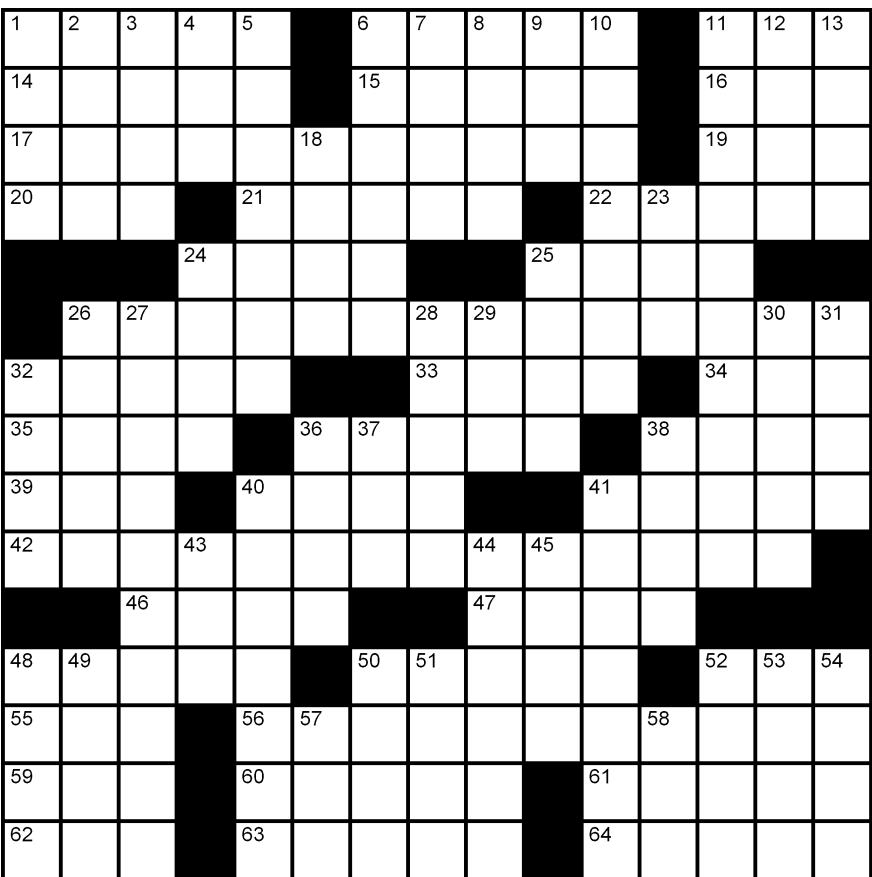
UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

PLAY IT BY EAR BY PRANAV DARYANANI | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

- ACROSS**
- 1 Sushi orders
 - 6 Lay eggs, like salmon
 - 11 “___-Hulk: Attorney at Law”
 - 14 Patiently expect
 - 15 Hummus or tahini
 - 16 Yank
 - 17 “The melody seems endless. How can I fix this?”
 - 19 In the past
 - 20 Mermaid habitat
 - 21 Peels, as a potato
 - 22 Designated areas
 - 24 Female animals that cluck
 - 25 Bitter beef?
 - 26 “The jingle feels grim. How do I improve it?”
 - 32 Pyramid scheme, e.g.
 - 33 Roughly
 - 34 Olive seed
 - 35 Take it easy
 - 36 Double-deckers and others
 - 38 Biological pouches
 - 39 Reaction to a heavy blow
 - 40 Cry of frustration
 - 41 In need of a scratch
 - 42 “I want the song to finish with a crescendo. What should I do?”
 - 46 Chooses
 - 47 Backside of a horse
 - 48 Work before “start” or “advertising”
 - 50 Like lizards
 - 52 “Pow!”

- 55 “How To Love” rapper ___ Wayne
- 56 Guidance that’s well-grounded ... or what
- 17-, 26- and 42-Across might be taken as?
- 59 Org. that approves toothpaste
- 60 Erase with “eye bleach”
- 61 Images in many copyright lawsuits
- 62 The “p” of mpg
- 63 Rats and roaches
- 64 Votes for the motion

- DOWN**
- 1 Tattered tees, perhaps
 - 2 Toddler’s “This hurts!”
 - 3 Flow from Mount Etna
 - 4 “I have read the terms and conditions,” often
 - 5 Intern’s pay
 - 6 Like a desert’s vegetation
 - 7 100%
 - 8 Mars, to the Greeks
 - 9 Director Anderson
 - 10 2050 carbon-neutral target
 - 11 Comedy club routine
 - 12 Massive
 - 13 They may be bruised in defeat
 - 18 Sharp flavor
 - 23 Openly gay
 - 24 Heist loot
 - 25 Much ado
 - 26 Sing like Sinatra
 - 27 Largest U.S. coin in circulation, by diameter



- 28 Mario’s dinosaur companion
- 29 Miner’s find
- 30 Not for the masses
- 31 Site for handicrafts
- 32 Arctic ice chunk
- 36 Some SKIMS undergarments
- 37 “Gross!”

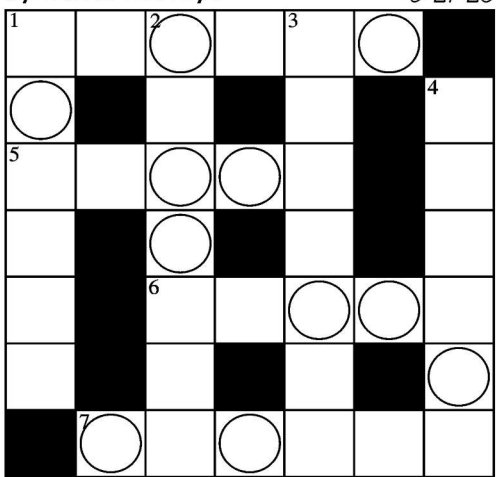
- 38 ___-and-go traffic
- 40 Chips in to the poker pot
- 41 “Back then ...”
- 43 Black ___ (covert missions)
- 44 A, B, C, D and F
- 45 Dance at a luau
- 48 Part of a tent

- 49 Political assistant
- 50 Figure (out)
- 51 Site for gadget reviews
- 52 Unfair preference
- 53 43,560 square feet
- 54 Citi Field team
- 57 The heart of a loner?
- 58 Contend

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt

8-27-26



CLUE

- 1. Picture ___
- 5. Narrow boat
- 6. Eighth Greek letter
- 7. Indifference

ACROSS

ANSWER

ONWWID
NAOEC
HAETT
PYHTAA

CLUE

- 1. ___ basket
- 2. ___ flight
- 3. Gorge
- 4. Heritage

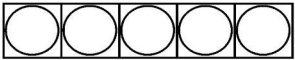
DOWN

ANSWER

KIERWC
NTOSNOP
RAEVETO
CGLYAE

CLUE: He was knighted by Queen Anne on April 16, 1705.

BONUS



How to play Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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